**On the Rocks**

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# On the Rocks

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Summary

Phainon goes to the club with his friends to celebrate finishing pilot school, where he is immediately berated by a stranger for his drink order. Somehow, they went from arguing with each other to making out within a span of 30 minutes, and the stranger writes his phone number down for Phainon when he is forced to leave. Of course, Phainon loses the man's number, but at least he remembers the man's name, right? Surely, he could find the guy online.

Turns out that guy he was arguing and making out with in the club was Mydeimos, a world-renowned rockstar?! So, how in hell was he supposed to contact him now?!

Rockstar!Mydei and Pilot!Phainon AU

Notes

I know we all went crazy for rockstar Mydei and pilot Phainon AU, so here is my take. Enjoy!

# Chapter 1: Phainon

“You're actually ordering that?”

“*Excuse me?”*

“That. You're willingly going to drink that?”

“Do I know you?!”

Phainon was flabbergasted that some random man was even ridiculing a drink that he ordered at the bar. It was loud, dark, and crowded in this club, yet some random man had managed to hear his order *and* decided to mock him for it? Didn't this guy have better things to do at the club other than stand here and judge everyone's drink orders?

“Does anyone know anyone else at this club?” The random man was situated at the very end of the bar, leaning against the counter with a glass set upon its surface. Phainon squinted at the cup to see what this guy had happened to order, since his taste in drinks was just so much more elite, apparently, but it was dark in the club with only blue lights blinking in and out to the beat of the music. All Phainon could see was that the drink was a dark red. He could barely even see the guy he was talking to either; all he could tell was that he was wearing all black, and his hair reached his shoulders.

“If you don't know anyone, then why judge what I'm drinking?” Phainon huffed as he tapped his credit card against the credit card terminal.

“I'm only judging because who the fuck orders an Old Fashioned at a club?”

“What's wrong with an Old Fashioned?!”

“It's bitter as Hell.”

“Then what the fuck are *you* drinking?!”

How was Phainon getting so heated over a man he had just met? He barely even knew what the guy looked like, and now here Phainon was arguing about his taste in alcohol with this random guy.

“It's definitely way better than an Old Fashioned.”

A smirk was thrown in Phainon's way as the man swooped up the glass into his hands and drank a sip of his crimson drink. Phainon narrowed his eyes as he watched the other man down the majority of his drink, while the other man never broke eye contact with Phainon. Even when the bartender had placed Phainon's drink onto the counter, Phainon could not tear his eyes away from the other man.

“Give that to me.” Phainon held out his hand.

The man raised his eyebrow and lowered his glass. “Why should I do that?”

“If you're not going to tell me what you're drinking, then let me try.” Phainon stepped forward and lunged toward the glass in the other man's hand, but the man quickly shot his hand away from Phainon’s grasp and narrowly saved his drink. Phainon, who was aiming for the glass that was no longer there, could barely stop himself in time from missing and threw out his hand, hitting the wall that was behind the other man.

The man's eyes widened at their sudden close proximity, but Phainon's eyes immediately dropped down to the rocks glass that was held between their chests.

“What is it?”

“Wouldn't you like to know?”

“That's why I'm asking.” Phainon's gaze shot up to look at the other man and almost stumbled backward at the glaringly bright, golden eyes that he was faced with. Even in the dark, with only the club's blue lighting, now that he was closer to this man, he could see just how handsome he was. Forget handsome–this guy was *hot,* and it was shocking how he was exactly

Phainon's type. Phainon almost couldn't believe he was arguing with the man of his dreams this entire time.

Phainon always knew he was attracted to men ever since he was young, and he was always attracted to men who were stunningly beautiful and stunningly intimidating at the same time. He was attracted to those who were so beautiful and intimidating that it would be hard to approach them at all, and if Phainon had seen this man walking down the street, there was zero chance Phainon would gather the courage to speak with him. Somehow, this man in front of him fit exactly that image, with long, golden hair dyed red at its ends; sharp, almost cat-like eyes; red lips; a sharp jawline; and a strong, muscular build that Phainon could clearly see under his sleeveless black tank that tightly hugged his torso.

He felt the breath in his lungs completely dissipate when he locked eyes with the man in front of him; Phainon had even forgotten why he had approached this man so closely in the first place. But now, Phainon didn't want to leave the man's side anymore. The only thing swirling in Phainon's mind was now the hope that this man in front of him was even slightly attracted to men. Even if he was just experimenting with his orientation, Phainon would gladly volunteer himself to help this beautiful man.

“Quit staring.”

Phainon was jolted out of his thoughts when he felt a rough shove against his shoulder, but it wasn't hard enough to actually push him away.

“Do you know me?” The man narrowed his eyes at Phainon, and Phainon furrowed his eyebrows at the question. Surely, if he had met a man who was just as hot as the guy in front of him, Phainon would absolutely remember him.

“Have we met before?” Phainon tilted his head to the side.

“Forget it then.” The man turned his head away and drank another sip from the rocks glass in his hand, and it was then that Phainon realized his main purpose.

“Give me that!” Phainon snatched the drink from the other man's hand while he was in the middle of drinking it, and it was the other man's turn to look flabbergasted as Phainon took a swig of the glass. Ignoring the man’s expression, Phainon turned his attention to the drink that was currently filling his senses. It was a sweet taste that easily went down his throat, with only a slight burn of alcohol. There was definitely vodka in it, but it was mixed with another fruit juice that Phainon was not expecting. Usually, a Cape Codder was made with vodka and cranberry juice, but this was definitely not the taste of cranberry.

“It's…” Phainon furrowed his eyebrows as he stared at the glass in his hand that was now almost empty. “Am I imagining things, or does this taste like pomegranate?”

The glass immediately left Phainon's hand as the other man had snatched it back with a glare. “Never tasted a pomegranate before?”

“I just didn't realize bars carried pomegranate juice.”

“Obviously, if you choose to drink an Old Fashioned.”

“Old Fashioneds are sweet!”

“You call anything with whiskey in it *sweet?*”

“Try it!” Phainon finally glanced at his drink on the counter before pushing it to the other man, but the other man immediately scowled.

“I'm not drinking that.”

“It's sweet!”

“It would ruin the taste of my drink.”

Phainon groaned at the other man's stubbornness. “If you're not going to try it, then don't judge it.”

“I've tasted enough whiskey to know how much I hate it.”

“Old Fashioneds are sweet!”

“Anything with whiskey is bitter, and it burns.”

Clicking his tongue, Phainon swept the glass into his hand and drank a mighty gulp from his glass. The drink ran along his tongue, with the sweetness and bitterness pleasantly mixing together, and the chill of the ice cube combined made for the perfect combination. Yes, this was exactly the drink that Phainon ordered.

With a satisfied sigh, Phainon handed it over to the man who still had his back against the wall. “I drank some of your drink, so you should drink some of mine.”

“I didn't ask you to take my drink.” Despite his words, the other man reached for his glass. The man turned the glass in his hand for some odd reason, and Phainon figured the man was trying to delay drinking by fiddling with the glass. It wasn't until the cup finally reached his lips that Phainon realized that he was drinking the glass from the exact spot that Phainon had.

Phainon wasn't sure if the alcohol was just starting to hit him or not, but he swore the pounding in his chest was louder than the music that was vibrating underneath his feet. He gulped, watching the man with wide eyes as he drank from his glass and lapped his tongue at the edge of the rim, almost as if he were teasing Phainon with drinking from the same place that he had. Out of every part of the glass the man could drink from, why did he choose the same spot as Phainon? He could have just taken the glass from Phainon’s hand and drank from the opposite side, but he took the time to turn the glass around in his hand. Nonetheless, Phainon's brain was too busy short-circuiting to think about the man's intentions.

“Still bitter.” The man winced with a cough, roughly setting the glass down on the cocktail napkin that it was served on. “And it still burns.”

Phainon snapped out of his daze when he heard the glass being set down, and his eyes focused upon the man who was trying to down the rest of his drink to wash away the taste of the Old Fashioned.

“It's really not that bad.” Phainon took another sip of his drink, carefully avoiding the spot that the man had drunk from, or else he would combust on the spot.

The man slammed his empty glass upon the counter, glaring in Phainon's way. “I can't believe you made me drink that.”

“It's not that bad!” Phainon retorted, setting the glass back down and resting his hand on the counter. “I don't know what you're tasting, but it's *definitely* not what I'm tasting.”

The man scoffed, rolling his eyes. “Then, let me taste what you're tasting.”

Phainon frowned in confusion. Did this man just forget what happened exactly two seconds ago? “I just did.”

With a low laugh, Phainon's body grew rigid when two strong arms wrapped around his neck, pulling him towards the other man. Even though Phainon's other hand was still pressed against the wall, Phainon had to shoot out his other hand to hold him up from crashing into the man, and he almost knocked over his own drink in the process as he stumbled over his own two feet.

“I meant from here.” The man lightly brushed his lips against Phainon's. Glistening golden eyes lowered, and Phainon's breath hitched in his throat at the obvious look the other man was giving him. The man inched even closer, with each syllable making his lips continue to brush against his as he murmured, “The best way to taste what you're tasting is right from here.”

Phainon swore he felt a shiver run down his spine from just the slightest touch of his soft lips against his. It only left his lips feeling cold as they yearned for his warmth, and Phainon's mind filled with the extreme need for this man's lips against his. Another dry swallow, and Phainon couldn't help his alcohol-filled brain from pushing the man deeper against the wall, pressing his lips roughly against the other man and shoving his tongue deep inside, swirling his tongue along the man's tongue that had been teasing him earlier. A moan resounded between them, but Phainon didn't know who it belonged to as he pushed his tongue deeper, running his tongue along every

inch and crevice inside the man's warm cavern. They exchanged breaths between gasps and moans in the messiest and most desperate kiss that Phainon had ever experienced in his life as the other man's tongue returned the enthusiasm and lapped against Phainon's.

The man was grabbing fistfuls of Phainon's shirt, tugging on Phainon's hair, and arching his back off the wall to slide his body against Phainon's. Phainon's eyes were squeezed shut, moaning at the stimulation of their bodies dragging against each other, and his hands snaked their way down to the man's waist that curved so deliciously and perfectly in the palms of Phainon's hands. Phainon squeezed the waist in his grasp, and the man against him gasped sharply, tilting his head and pushing his own tongue into Phainon’s mouth.

Phainon couldn't help another moan escape him when he felt the man’s tongue sliding against the roof of his mouth, and the pit of his stomach was swirling in arousal. He couldn't get enough of the taste of his vodka pomegranate concoction that still lingered on the other man's tongue, and he couldn't get enough of the electricity that ran down his body at every slide of their tongues and every slide of their bodies against each other. It was as if the club music had been drained away, and the vibrations that Phainon was feeling resounding underneath his feet were his own pounding heartbeats.

The alcohol and arousal were making him dizzy, and Phainon swore he was getting drunk just from the sweet taste of this man. His head was spinning, and he wasn't sure just how tightly he was grasping the other man, only that it wasn't enough. He wanted to *feel* more, to *taste* more, and to *touch* more of this man who currently had his tongue inside Phainon's mouth and was making his brain feel like mush.

He slid a knee in between the man's legs, and Phainon couldn’t believe that he actually began grinding himself against Phainon. His blood shot straight down to the stirring warmth between his legs when he felt the man’s crotch drag along his thigh, with desperate whimpers and moans filling the space between them, and it only solidified the thought that was now circulating in Phainon's head. He needed to get out of here, and not just out of here by himself. He *needed* to take this man with him because the things Phainon

wanted to do to this man would get him kicked out of the club. He wanted to part their lips and ask if the man wanted to get out of here with him, but he jumped instead when he heard someone calling his name.

“Phainon!”

The alcohol was making Phainon way more emotional than he should be feeling over getting interrupted, and he tore his lips away to turn in the direction of the familiar voice. He was almost mad he could hear his name even over the blaring music. With a deep sigh, Phainon tried to calm himself down over seeing how worried the woman looked in front of him. It must be important if she was trying to look for him.

“Did you need something, Castorice?” Phainon still had his hands glued to the man's side, as if he could resume making out with the man after addressing his friend's concern. Phainon had almost forgotten he had come to the club with his friends to celebrate finishing pilot school, and he had only separated from the group to grab a quick drink before being distracted by this man he had pinned against the wall.

“Cipher is… um…” Her eyes wavered as they found the man that Phainon had pushed against the wall.

“Cipher?” Even though Phainon didn't want to know, he just wanted to quickly finish the conversation so he could resume his previous activities.

Her eyes shot back to Phainon, a deep blush evident across her cheeks. “She… um… threw up outside the club and blacked out. She's with Aglaea right now, but no one can carry her except for you.”

Phainon could not believe what he was hearing.

“She *what?!*” Phainon cried but quickly recovered with a frown. “No, wait, that sounds exactly like something Cipher would do.”

“I'm really sorry.” Castorice's eyes darted back to the man before returning to Phainon. “But… would you be able to help bring her home?”

With a loud, deeply regrettable sigh, Phainon furrowed his eyebrows in exasperation. He really didn't want to leave the man in his arms right now, who just so perfectly happened to be his type and even approached him first, but he also couldn't just leave his friend outside the club. Well, it was just Cipher, right? He could definitely leave Cipher outside. If it were anyone else, he'd definitely help them home, but Cipher?

“Phainon.”

Phainon almost jumped at hearing the other man call his name. He must've remembered it from when Castorice said it earlier.

Turning his head, Phainon locked eyes with gold. “I–”

“Just go.” The man gestured in Castorice’s direction. “Help your friend.”

Seems that the man decided for Phainon that he should help Cipher. Another sigh escaped Phainon’s body as he stared pitifully at the other man. “Would I be able to see you again?”

“Do you have your phone? I'll give you my number.”

With wide eyes, Phainon quickly dug in his pockets. He could not believe that this hot man actually wanted to see him again, but he felt his stomach sink at the realization of his hands feeling empty pockets. He had left his phone in Aglaea’s purse before going to the bar because he thought he would just be gone for a quick second to get a drink.

“I…” A third sigh left his mouth. “I'm sorry. I left it with my friend.”

The man shook his head, digging into his own back pocket and producing a black permanent marker. “I don't have my phone with me either, but I can write it down for you.”

Phainon wanted to cheer, holler, throw his fists into the air, and clap his hands as he watched the man write his number down on the cocktail napkin his abandoned Old Fashioned sat upon. The pounding club music in the background was now fireworks going off in celebration. He couldn't even

believe he began tangling tongues with the man of his dreams simply because he ordered an Old Fashioned.

The man handed the napkin to him, and Phainon squinted at the number to read as best as he could in the dark. He had even written his name next to his number.

“Your name is… Mydei?” Phainon glanced up from the napkin for confirmation.

The man, whom Phainon knew was now named Mydei, nodded. “Text me later when you make it home.”

Phainon swore his heart skipped a beat at his words. He grinned with an enthusiastic nod before parting from Mydei and following Castorice out of the club. Staring one last time at the napkin with the man's handwriting, he shoved the napkin into his pocket before fighting the crowds of people in the club and emerging into the cool night air outside. With how many people were dancing and packing into the club, it was hot and humid inside, and the night breeze made for a refreshing air that immensely cooled him down.

There were even crowds outside, and Castorice and Phainon had to dodge them all before finally reaching a secluded corner around the block. In the dark, Phainon could see all the friends that he came with standing around Aglaea, who was seated on the floor with Cipher’s head resting in her lap. And with the smell that emanated from this corner, it was extremely clear that Castorice's retelling of the story was, unfortunately, accurate.

“Phainon!” Hyacine was relieved to see him. “I did the best I could to take care of her after she threw up, but she immediately passed out."

Phainon had never sighed so much in one night. “Thanks, Hyacine. I can take it from here.”

He bent down, muttering about how much Cipher owed him for cockblocking him, but he almost jumped back when the woman suddenly sat up from Aglaea's lap.

“You!” The clearly drunk woman pointed a finger in Phainon’s direction.

Phainon's eyes widened. “Me?”

“You… You…” Cipher brought a hand up to her head. “Huh?”

Phainon scoffed and grabbed the woman's arm. She was clearly not sober. “Let's go home, Cipher.”

“What?! NOOOO!”

She tore her arm from Phainon's grasp, and Phainon frowned, latching onto her arm once more. Cipher cried aloud and kicked upward at his stomach, and Phainon barely managed to block it.

“Let me go! Let me go!” Cipher slid her back against the dirty sidewalk and almost pulled Phainon down with her, but she succeeded in ripping her hand away from Phainon. “I don't want to go home!”

Phainon gritted his teeth and lunged for Cipher again. He was basically towering over her and trying to grab for any body part he could possibly grab on her body. “Cipher, you're drunk out of your mind. Let's go!”

“NOOOO!” She thrashed and pulled against Phainon, and Phainon felt as if he were wrestling a wild animal. He tried grabbing her wrists and her arms, but she was way too slippery and continued escaping his grasp. Even Phainon wasn't completely sober, but he was going to be now after how much she kept kicking and screaming at him.

“Can you get her in the car?” Phainon faintly heard Castorice's voice calling out to him.

In the midst of Cipher’s throwing limbs, Phainon glanced sideways to see a car was pulled up next to them. It seems they had already called for a car while Phainon was busy wrestling with Cipher. Everyone was beginning to pile into the car, and Phainon knew he didn't have much time left to throw Cipher into the car before the driver decided to leave without both of them. And there was no way Phainon wanted to be left alone with a drunk Cipher.

“I'll try!” Phainon grabbed at one of Cipher's ankles, and the woman howled under him.

“LET ME GO! NOOOO!” She stomped her feet against Phainon's hips and waist, and Phainon just had to accept all the bruises he was going to have tomorrow as he reached for another one of Cipher's limbs.

“Cipher, *please* stay still if you don't want to be left behind.”

“LEAVE ME BE! LEAVE ME ALONE!” Cipher launched her fists at Phainon's shoulders and chest, and he couldn't find a good opportunity to grab one of her wrists. If anyone were to walk by, anyone would think he was trying to kidnap his own friend.

With a roll of his eyes, Phainon dragged her by the one ankle he managed to grab, and through much tribulations, punches, and kicks, he practically threw her into the minivan before climbing into the passenger seat and slamming the car door shut. Suddenly, it was almost too quiet after everything that Phainon had been put through.

“Aglaea, you didn't want to help me at all?” He threw an exasperated look at the woman who was currently trying to soothe the wailing Cipher. Somehow, she had managed to actually get Cipher seated in the chair beside her. Phainon was sure she was going to continue throwing a fit on the floor of the car.

“She wouldn't even listen to me, even drunk.” Aglaea laughed lightly.

A scoff could be heard in the car. “Who would want to listen to you?”

“Anaxa!”

“Don't call me that, Hyacine.”

Phainon heaved another sigh that night, sinking into the passenger chair as the rush of adrenaline left his body over the fight he basically had with Cipher while he listened to his friends bicker amongst each other in the car seats behind him. The car pulled away from the curb and merged into

traffic, most likely on the way to Phainon's apartment, as he and his friends pregamed there before going to the club. And after everything that just happened, he just wanted to go home and pass out.

# Chapter 2: Phainon

Phainon could not believe he managed to carry himself back to his bed to fall asleep last night. The drive back home had made him sleepy, especially from how exhausted he was from everything he had gone through. He had his first argument with some stranger at the club, made out with said stranger, then fought his drunk friend in the car immediately after. It was truly a night for the books.

Eyes widening, he immediately sat up in bed. That reminded him; he never texted that man when he returned home. He had immediately collapsed in bed upon arriving at his apartment, and all of his friends went to find their own places to sleep somewhere around his apartment. Phainon glanced around his bedroom and realized that no one was in there, which meant they were all crowded in his living room.

He was still wearing the same clothes he was wearing at the club, which was kind of gross, but he was also way too tired to change out of them when he arrived home last night. Resolving himself to do his sheets later when his friends left, Phainon dug his hands into his pockets to find the number that Mydei left for him. Only to realize that his pockets were still empty–as empty as they were when he was trying to find his phone for Mydei.

Phainon's heart began to pound, and he felt his stomach drop as anxiety rushed through his entire being. His mind began to panic, and his hands started to feel clammy. Did he lose his number? There was no way; Phainon refused to believe it. He jumped up in bed, shoving his hands as deeply as he could into every single pocket that existed on his jeans, but to no avail. Every single pocket was empty, and there wasn't a single cocktail napkin in his grasp.

Perhaps, did he dream up the entirety of last night?!

Honestly, that made more sense than losing the guy's number. First of all, how did the napkin just suddenly disappear from his pockets? And second

of all, how did Phainon miraculously meet the man of his dreams just by existing in the club that day? But, how was Phainon supposed to prove that man was even real and not just a figment of Phainon's drunken dreams? Maybe he got so drunk off the Old Fashioned he just imagined making out with a man who was exactly his type?

Phainon ran a frustrated hand through his hair, taming his wild bedhead in the process. The taste of the vodka pomegranate cocktail was too clear to be a dream, and how was Phainon supposed to imagine a cocktail he had never tasted in his life? Fuck, Phainon was going to go crazy over a man who might not even be real at all. He groaned at the running thoughts in his head and decided to just leave his bedroom. Maybe he could just leave all his anxious thoughts away in that room too.

Pushing his bedroom door open, he was face-to-face with quite the crowded living room. His couch was pulled out to become a sofa bed, and Aglaea, Castorice, and Hyacine were squeezed onto it. Anaxa was sleeping on the floor near the foot of the sofa, and Cipher was, for some reason, lying on top of his dining table. That could not have been comfortable at all.

Aglaea and Hyacine were already awake; they were always the first ones to wake up out of the group. Surprisingly, Castorice was also awake with them. She was usually the late riser because she always stayed up late into the night reading and writing, but maybe sleeping in between Aglaea and Hyacine made her wake up with them.

“Good morning, Phainon.” Castorice nodded toward him once he had entered the living room.

Phainon glanced down at Anaxa at his feet, then turned his attention toward Cipher on his dining table. “Morning. Did you guys dump her there, or did she choose that place herself?”

“Anaxa dropped her there.” Hyacine giggled as she followed Phainon's line of sight toward the dining table. “After you had brought her up here and went to sleep, Anaxa barely managed to carry her to the dining table rather than leaving her at the front door.”

His eyes slightly widened at the recounted story. It made sense since his dining table was approximately three steps away from the front door, and Anaxa wasn't exactly known for having the strength to carry another human being. “Wait, did I leave her at the front door?”

“You unlocked the door, dropped Cipher, and went straight to your room.”

Phainon couldn't help but burst out into laughter, but he had to quickly shut himself up or else he would encounter Anaxa’s wrath for being woken up early. Phainon couldn't recall even doing that once they all arrived at his apartment building; he must've been extremely exhausted. He turned back to the three women on his sofa, and it was when he looked at Castorice once more that he remembered his previous anxiety.

“Castorice!” Phainon exclaimed, causing the poor woman to slightly jump in surprise. “You were there!”

“Phainon, I think we were all there,” Aglaea remarked in quite the gentle, mocking tone that was very signature to the woman. “Unless you were so drunk you forgot we were all there except for Castorice?”

He laughed at her words, running a tired hand down his face. “No, I-Sorry, that's not what I meant.” Breathing a deep breath, he locked eyes with Castorice once more, who still seemed rattled at suddenly being addressed. “Castorice, I was at the bar when you went to find me to carry Cipher, right?”

“Yes?” Castorice squeaked, unsure of where this conversation was going.

“Was there someone else with me?”

“Phainon, you were with someone?!” Hyacine had excitedly climbed to the edge of the sofa. “Who was it?!”

Instead of answering her question, Phainon kept his eyes trained on the woman with lavender hair. “If there was someone with me, do you remember what they looked like?”

“Um…” Castorice's face immediately bloomed red, much to Aglaea's and Hyacine's amusement.

“What? What?!” Hyacine eagerly clamped down on Castorice's shoulders. “Who were they?! Why are you turning red?!”

It was then that Phainon realized Castorice definitely witnessed him shoving his tongue down some stranger's throat and grinding his body against that stranger too, and he couldn't help but blush himself at recalling the dream. Was he really getting it on right at the bar in front of the club entrance? The bar was right where you walked into the club.

“Um… Yes…” Poor Castorice's voice was barely above a whisper, and there was no doubt in Phainon's mind that her face was burning hot even without touching her. “He was… um…” She furrowed her eyebrows in an attempt to recall the face of a stranger that she had seen in a dimly lit, crowded club. “Blonde hair that went to his shoulders? He was very well-built too.”

“So he was there?!” Phainon stepped over Anaxa's sleeping body to quickly approach the woman. “He was real?!”

“Real?” Castorice's eyes widened. “Didn't he write his number for you?”

“He gave you his number?!” Hyacine was practically squealing now. “Wait, Castorice, what was Phainon doing when you found him?! Tell me!”

“I don't have his number anymore!” Phainon cried. “I searched everywhere in my pockets, but it's not there!”

“Castorice, what was he doing?!”

“Castorice, do you remember his number?!”

Two people were wailing in the living room for two very different things, and Aglaea had to shut both of them up before Castorice became overwhelmed, which was already too late because it already seemed as if

Castorice's brain had become fried. This was probably the last time Castorice would ever wake up so early in the morning.

“Enough!”

All four people on the sofa bed froze at the sound of a new voice entering the conversation, and Phainon rigidly turned around to find Anaxa's sharp glare boring straight into him. He was now standing up from the floor, appearing both sleep-deprived and annoyed.

With a light, nervous chuckle, Phainon did his best to smile at him. “Good morning… Anaxa.”

“Do not call me that this early in the morning.” Anaxa harshly snapped. “The hell are you guys moaning and groaning about at nine in the damn morning? Were we not out until three last night?”

“Sorry, Anaxa.” Three voices rang in unison. Aglaea only chuckled in amusement.

“Shut up and answer my question.”

Phainon frowned. “How do I shut up and answer your question at the same time?”

“Do not get smart with me, Phainon.” Anaxa clicked his tongue. “Answer me, or you owe me for waking me up so early.”

Phainon was sure he already owed Anaxa for waking him up at nine in the morning, but he answered nonetheless. “I was asking Castorice if she remembered the man I was with at the club last night.”

“And?”

“And he gave me his number on a napkin, but I can't find it in my pockets anymore.”

Anaxa grunted and turned to Hyacine. “So, what are you grumbling about at nine in the morning?”

“I just wanted to know what Phainon was doing with this man.” Hyacine wilted under Anaxa's sharp glare.

With crossed arms, Anaxa turned to Phainon. “So, what were you doing with this stranger?”

“I was… uh…” Phainon's face, which had previously cooled down from earlier, began to heat up once more at the memory. “I was… making out with this guy at the bar.”

Aglaea's eyes widened, and Hyacine sharply gasped.

“Phainon!” Hyacine blushed herself. “You were making out with some random guy at the club?!”

“It wasn't on purpose!” Phainon cried, earning four very dubious stares. “Well… It was… Okay, yes, I *did* mean to make out with him, but it wasn't the plan for last night to make out with anyone!”

“Does anyone ever plan that?” Anaxa rolled his eye. Anaxa had, unfortunately, been in an accident that took both his older sister's life and one of his eyes. Because of that, he always wore an eyepatch on one side of his face. “So, you made out with this guy, he gave you his number, and you lost it.”

“I didn't lose it! I–” Phainon began desperately searching his pockets once more, but once again, to no avail.

“You lost it,” Anaxa repeated.

Phainon's shoulders slumped in defeat. “Yes… I lost it. I put it in my pocket, but it's not there anymore.”

“Which pocket?” Anaxa eyed Phainon's jeans as if trying to assess which pocket the cocktail napkin was in.

“I swear it was this one.” Phainon patted his right front pocket. “But, there's nothing there. There's nothing in any of my pockets.”

Anaxa fell deep into thought while Hyacine shoved her own hands into Phainon's pockets as if she couldn't believe the number had been lost as well. Phainon frowned but let Hyacine continue her ministrations, and she looked plenty defeated once she had searched all his front and back pockets.

“I want to meet this guy you were making out with.” Hyacine pouted. “What was his name? Or, were you too busy sucking each other's mouths to exchange names?”

“Mydei!” Phainon grew bright red. He couldn't believe Hyacine was talking like that. “His name was Mydei, and *no*, we were not too busy sucking each other's mouths!”

Castorice cleared her throat, drawing the attention of everyone sitting on the couch. “Phainon… I actually called you six times before you heard me.”

“*Six?!”* Phainon and Hyacine both cried.

“How long were you standing there?!” The blush on Phainon's face only continued to grow.

“I didn't mean to keep watching, but you didn't hear me!” Castorice quickly retorted, her own face turning bright red once more. “You were… just so into him.”

“Castorice!” Phainon covered his face, trying to hide from the sheer embarrassment of his own friend watching him get it on with some stranger in the club. Both Aglaea and Hyacine laughed, with Aglaea pitifully patting Phainon's shoulder, and it was then that it was Anaxa's turn to clear his throat.

“Wait, Cas!” Hyacine suddenly exclaimed and began shaking her friend’s shoulders, interrupting whatever Anaxa had been preparing to say. “You need to tell me *everything*. All the details! Everything that they were doing! Where were they?! What was their position?! What was the guy wearing?!”

Phainon shot his head back up. “Castorice, don't tell her!” He wailed.

Hyacine and Phainon began pestering Castorice, bickering with each other in an attempt to talk over the other person. Poor Castorice was overwhelmed as she tried to calm the two people in front of her while being violently shaken by Hyacine's hands, with only Aglaea watching and laughing at the scene before her. It wasn't until Anaxa's voice rang clearly above everyone else's was Castorice finally saved.

“Your right front pocket was kicked when you were trying to carry Cipher,” Anaxa plainly stated as if he was able to replay the entirety of last night in his mind. “Actually, your entire being was kicked and punched by Cipher last night. I wouldn't be surprised if she knocked it out of your pocket.”

Phainon's eyes widened as he turned toward the completely oblivious woman who was still knocked out on his table. “It was *Cipher?!*”

“That's the only logical reasoning.” Anaxa nonchalantly shrugged. “Unless some pickpocket took the napkin, which I doubt.”

It was official: Cipher definitely owed Phainon when she woke up. In fact, she would owe him for the rest of her life. One, for cockblocking him, and two, for making him lose the only contact he had with the man of his literal dreams.

“You remember his name, right?” Anaxa spoke once more. “If he has social media, you might be able to find him with some work.”

Phainon's gaze snapped back to Anaxa. “You're right! Holy–Aglaea, could you hand me my phone?”

Aglaea quickly reached for her purse, rummaging through and unearthing Phainon's phone. Surprisingly, it still had battery, and Phainon quickly pulled up the first social media app he could find on his phone. He had stared at the napkin for so long that he remembered exactly how his name was spelled; unfortunately, he could not remember the ten digits that were also written right next to his name.

With four heads leering over his shoulder, Phainon could only find an account with the username “Mydeimos”. The following social media

accounts were all some version of Mydeimos fan accounts, most likely for the first user showing up in the search results. The profile pictures were too small for anyone to accurately see who the person was in the photos.

“Mydeimos?” Phainon frowned. “That's not his name, though. How would I be able to search for just ‘Mydei’?”

“What if it is?” Anaxa remarked. “Just click on it.”

“But, why would he have fan accounts then?”

“Just fucking click on it.”

Phainon immediately clicked on it, and when the account loaded on his screen, a gasp resounded from Castorice right next to his head, and Phainon felt the air in his lungs completely still.

It was him.

This Mydeimos guy, who had loaded up on his phone screen, whose account basically consisted of concert recordings, interviews, magazine covers, professional photoshoots, and music video clips, was the guy that Phainon was arguing with, pushing against the wall, and making out with in the club last night. It finally clicked now, why Mydei had asked him if Phainon knew him last night. He was definitely used to people staring at him from being recognized as a rockstar, and he probably thought Phainon had recognized him too, after all the obvious staring Phainon was doing.

Three heads turned toward Castorice, who had gasped at the account, and she quickly shut her mouth that was agape.

“It's… That's him,” Castorice barely managed, swallowing dryly the more Phainon scrolled through the account. Even he was also in complete shock.

“*Him?!*” Hyacine practically screamed and whipped her head toward Phainon. “Phainon, you were making out with a celebrity?!”

“I–That's–” Phainon's mouth flapped open and closed, with no sound coming out of his throat. He kept scrolling through all the posts, but all he

could see was just how talented this, apparently, rockstar was. There was no way this was the guy he was with last night, right? Surely, it must be a doppelganger? The more he scrolled through the account, the more his disbelief continued to grow, but there was no denying that this Mydeimos was exactly the guy he met at the club.

“A celebrity?!”

Five heads turned toward this new individual who had somehow squeezed herself onto the couch at some point while they were looking over the social media account, and there Cipher was, looking as cheeky and smug as ever. “Phainon, you know someone famous?!”

“It's all your fault!” Phainon had to restrain himself from jumping the woman right then and there.

“What? What do you mean?”

“I lost his number because of you!”

“Phainon! How dare you lose a famous person’s number!”

“It was literally your fault!” Phainon groaned and buried his face in his hands once more, his phone now abandoned somewhere on the couch. “You knocked his number out of my pocket, Cipher.”

“How dare you accuse me of that?!” Cipher gasped dramatically. “Why would I cut my one and only contact to fame and fortune?!”

“Because you were drunk!” Phainon cried. “If only you just got into the damn car!”

“I cannot believe you were making out with a rockstar.” Hyacine was still in awe as she and Castorice continued to search the social media account on Phainon's phone. “Cas, you sure it's this guy?”

Castorice nodded. “It was him. I can't believe it either.”

“Phainon.” Anaxa sighed in resignation. “You're never going to get this guy's number again.”

“I know that! I *know!”* Phainon cried once more. Phainon was just getting more frustrated by the minute. “How the hell am I supposed to contact a fucking rockstar?!”

“Easy! Just call the number he gave you!”

Aglaea and Anaxa actually had to hold Phainon back from jumping Cipher this time, and Phainon slumped in their arms with a heavy sigh. “I'm never going to have the chance to talk to that guy again.”

“Aglaea, would you have any contacts who could reach this man?” Castorice turned to Aglaea, who immediately shook her head.

“I don't work for anyone who would have a close connection to a rockstar,” Aglaea explained while still holding onto one of Phainon's arms. She was quite the coveted fashion designer, and she has designed outfits for many high-profile guests. Although Castorice had a good idea, unfortunately, it wasn't enough.

“Phainon.” A sorrowful sigh came from Hyacine as she glanced up from his phone. “There's definitely a chance! You could definitely try to message him on here.”

Phainon immediately dismissed the idea. “There's no way a celebrity is going to respond to me on there.”

“He might not even be running the account,” Anaxa added. “It could be a manager or a publicity employee. With how many followers this guy has, it wouldn't come as a shock to me if someone else was running the account for him.”

Phainon heaved another sigh as Aglaea and Anaxa released him. “I'm never seeing him again.”

“Don't say that!” Hyacine chastised. “Let's go back to the club and try to find the napkin outside! And if not, you can make Cipher owe you!”

“Woah, woah, woah.” Cipher held up her hands in the air. “We don't need to be pointing fingers now.”

“It's all your fault!” Phainon and Hyacine both yelled together.

“Let's just go now,” Castorice suggested. “The sooner we go, the more likely the napkin will still be there, right? I mean, we're all still dressed.”

Everyone glanced around, and it was true. They were all still dressed in last night's attire. It seemed like everyone immediately collapsed upon returning to Phainon's apartment.

“Let's go! Let's go!” With Hyacine’s urging, they all quickly filed out of Phainon's apartment and headed to Aglaea's car in the parking lot. Since there were so many of them, they wouldn't fit in Phainon's car. Fortunately, Aglaea had quite the minivan that would fit them all, and they were soon on their way back to the club.

She parked the car at the curb, at the corner where Cipher had thrown up and blacked out the previous night. As this part of the city was only filled with clubs and bars, nothing was open, which made traffic much more lenient for them, and they arrived in record time. Jumping out of the car, they searched for about half an hour all over the sidewalk, but they all came up empty. All there was in this dirty corner was more irrelevant trash, and Cipher’s puke was, unfortunately, still there.

Phainon sighed heavily, running a tired hand through his hair. “It's not here, guys.”

“I told you I didn't kick it out!” Cipher complained. She was squatting on the floor and flicking the other trash that was around this corner. “*Ugh*, my head hurts, guys.”

Aglaea pinched the bridge of her nose. “No one told you to drink that much.”

“What's the point of going to the club if you don't black out?!” Cipher jumped to her feet and began wildly waving her arms. “Phainon over here was sucking tongues with some random stranger! *Ugh*, guys, stop talking so loud, my head hurts.” She clutched her head in an attempt to massage it.

“Why didn't your head hurt before?” Hyacine approached Cipher and also began to massage her temples.

“I was too excited over Phainon knowing a celebrity,” Cipher mumbled with a pout. “We could've all been rich!”

“Yeah, if you didn't knock the napkin out of my pocket.”

“I didn't do it! *Ow*, my *head*.”

“At this point, losing a celebrity's number is sounding worse than puking all over the floor and blacking out,” Anaxa murmured while Phainon and Cipher continued to bicker. He was still scanning the floor and trying to see if he could find anything, but all the napkins that were haphazardly thrown onto the sidewalk in this corner had already been looked through by them. Unfortunately, none of them contained the name and number they were looking for.

“Should we ask if the bartender knows him?” Castorice suggested. “If he was hanging out at the bar, maybe they are acquainted? Or, he could be friends with the owner of the club?”

“Cas! That's a good idea!” Tribbie, whom they called over earlier to join them to help search, nodded enthusiastically. She wasn't much of a clubber, so she only had dinner with them last night before parting from them while everyone else went to the club. “It's Saturday, so they will be open late today too.”

“If anything, that guy might be back too,” Anaxa stated. “But I'm not going here again, so find someone else.”

“Didn't like the drinks?” Castorice guessed.

“Too loud.”

Aglaea frowned, turning in Anaxa's direction. “That's literally what a club is.”

“I didn't ask for your opinion.”

She laughed. “When do you ever ask for opinions?”

Anaxa scowled at her words and crossed his arms. “I specifically don't want *your* opinion.”

It was Anaxa and Aglaea's turn to bicker with each other, and Phainon let out another sigh over their bickering. “Fine, okay, I'll try and come back tonight.”

“I want to come!” Hyacine shot her hand up, and Cipher winced right next to her.

“Stop being so *loud! Please!”* Cipher wailed once more, and Hyacine quickly began apologizing and massaging her temples once more.

“I can come too.” Castorice offered Phainon a small smile. “Since I've seen him in person as well, I could be a little bit more helpful.”

“I want to come,” Cipher grumbled.

“You're not going.” Aglaea immediately stopped her bickering to chastise Cipher.

“But *why?!* I want to meet a celebrity!”

“You're hungover, and you want to go to the club *again?”* It was Aglaea's turn to scowl.

“I'm not carrying you again if you black out.” Phainon joined in. “I might lose something else if I do.

“It wasn't me! The napkin’s not even here! There's no proof I did it!” Cipher cried and immediately grabbed her head once more. “Ow, ow, *ow!* Guys, can we go back? It's not here, and I want to lay down.”

Phainon heaved another sigh. “I agree. Let's go before I have to carry her again.”

They all dejectedly hopped into Phainon's car once more to return to his apartment. Anaxa, Aglaea, and Tribbie returned home, while Hyacine and Castorice stayed with Phainon to return to the club later that night. Cipher was forcefully dragged home by Aglaea. Even though she swore she wouldn't drink a single drop, she was soon thrown in Aglaea's minivan and was on her way, much to Phainon's relief. He couldn't promise not to jump Cipher the moment Aglaea was not there to protect her.

Phainon, Hyacine, and Castorice didn't do much while they waited for the club to open at 9 PM. They went out to grab some fast food for lunch before returning home, and while they were eating, Hyacine displayed her phone screen onto Phainon's television in the living room.

“I still cannot believe you caught a celebrity’s eye,” Hyacine murmured while scrolling through the social media account once more. Phainon noticed that she had already followed the account, for whatever reason. To his knowledge, Hyacine was not interested in rock music at all.

“I still cannot believe I lost his number.” Phainon released another heavy sigh, lounging on the couch while watching Hyacine click on random posts that caught her eye. She mostly clicked on music videos and concert clips, and damn, he was a good singer. He did sound lovely moaning in Phainon's ears last night, after all, so he wouldn't doubt his singing voice was also just as lovely. He even played guitar; was there anything this guy couldn't do?

“Do you remember, like, any digits at all from his phone number?” Hyacine clicked on a magazine cover, and Castorice's face bloomed red at the sight because Mydei was shirtless on the cover. It was for some luxury clothing brand, which was quite ironic since Mydei was half-naked in the photo.

“Even if I did, they wouldn't help me at all,” Phainon remarked. “What am I going to do? Call every single possible combination of numbers until he answers?”

It was Hyacine's turn to sigh. “I just wish this situation were more… salvageable. If the guy you met was anyone but a famous rockstar with millions of fans, we would have been able to message him on here with no problem.”

“It's whatever.” Phainon continued watching the television screen as flashes of this beautiful, dream man kept appearing. After looking at the social media account for so long, it just made the man he met last night feel more and more like just some drunken dream. Seeing the man performing on stage, starring in music videos, and appearing on magazine covers for high-end brands just made him feel so far away. Should he have even made out with that guy last night? Wouldn't he get in trouble for that as a celebrity? Phainon couldn't fathom what it was like being famous and living such a life.

“It's not just *whatever*!” Hyacine exclaimed, causing Phainon to jolt in his seat. “Don't you like this guy?! I know you're not the type to have one-night stands, Phainon!”

Phainon settled back down into his seat on the couch, staring back at the post that Hyacine had paused her scrolling on. It was a video of the man sitting on a stool on a stage, playing a slower song on the guitar.

“Of course I'm interested in him,” Phainon murmured, watching the rockstar strum the black guitar in his arms and listening to the microphone in front of him project his smooth singing voice. “But, what could I do? I lost his number, and if no one knows him at the club, then that's it. How else do you contact a celebrity?”

“You could stalk him.”

“Castorice, I'm not going to stalk him.”

“What if, instead of stalking him, you become a super mega fan, get his attention at a concert, and he recognizes you!” Hyacine excitedly squealed. “It'll be just like a movie!”

Phainon tried to imagine that outlandish scenario and frowned. “I doubt he would even remember me by then. And anyway, I don't have a job now that I'm done with pilot school, so I wouldn't be able to afford being a ‘super mega fan.’” With a groan at the reminder, he buried his face in his hands. “Fuck, I have to job hunt now.”

“Don't think about jobs right now! We're focused on this man right now.” Hyacine clicked on another post. It seemed to be some group interview of him and a few others, which Phainon found out from scrolling through his account that they were fellow band members.

“You can only say that because you actually have a job, Hyacine.” Phainon chuckled and glanced her way, but her attention was still focused on the group interview.

“As much as I love my job, Phainon, it's the weekend right now. Stop mentioning work,” Hyacine teasingly chastised him with a smile. Hyacine was a tour guide at the local zoo, and Phainon knew just how much she loved her job. She enjoyed teaching others, entertaining the kids, and spending her day with the other animals. And she was good at her job too, from the few times Phainon had visited her at work.

With a laugh, Phainon and Castorice continued to watch Hyacine scroll through the social media account. They only went out to buy more food for dinner, and then they were on their way back to the club.

There was no line into the club, most likely because it literally just opened its doors for the night, and because it was so early, there was no cover charge either. Phainon, Castorice, and Hyacine were able to quickly enter the club after security had checked Phainon. They darted straight for the bar, but the bartender who was working today wasn't the same as the one from last night. Phainon wasn't sure if there was any hope for him in this venture, but he asked the person working anyway since they had already made the trip to the city's downtown area.

“Mydeimos?” The bartender had to lean forward over the counter to hear what Phainon was saying to her over the thumping music. Thankfully, because the club just opened, they didn't have to yell over the crowds to hear each other like they did last night.

“Do you know him? Or does the owner of the club know him?”

“The rockstar, right? You a fan?” The bartender was cleaning a rocks glass with a towel, and it only served to remind Phainon of the crimson liquid that the man had been drinking from his own glass just the previous night.

“*Err*, not particularly.” Phainon furrowed his eyebrows. How was he supposed to describe this without sounding like an insane stalker-fan? “I met him last night, but I lost something that he gave me.”

The bartender hummed in acknowledgement, picking up another glass to languidly wipe down. “He does come here sometimes. Maybe you could catch him if you come here often enough. He is a regular here, and we only know him in case we have to step in and stop crazy fans from trying to bombard him. We don't have any means of contacting him, if that's what you were looking for.” She shrugged nonchalantly. “Even if we did, I wouldn't be able to give it to you.”

Phainon nodded. “I see. Thank you.”

“Yeah, good luck on finding him.”

With a nod, Phainon, Castorice, and Hyacine parted from the bar counter. All they were able to learn was that the rockstar was a regular at this club, but he only visited sometimes, which would mean Phainon would just have to randomly visit the club in hopes that he turned up again. It was looking quite bleak for them, but Hyacine and Castorice continued to convince Phainon to visit for the next few weeks in the hopes that he would find the celebrity again. Phainon, who was now accepting the fact that he would never run into him again, obliged nonetheless.

For the next few weeks, Phainon visited the club on Fridays, the same day that he had previously met the rockstar. Sometimes, he even ordered an Old

Fashioned just for the sake of it, and it even came to a point where the other bartenders began to recognize him, even referring to him as a regular now. Although it did feel nice having the bartenders ask if he wanted “the usual” for the day, it did not feel nice that the reason he kept visiting the club was just to find a certain individual. However, much to Phainon's luck, he would never run into that man at the club again, and soon, it finally came to a point where Phainon gave up and stopped visiting the club altogether.

# Chapter 3: Phainon

Phainon was in absolute misery. He had been job hunting for the past few months. His routine had been to job hunt and visit the club on Fridays, but now that he had stopped visiting the club a few months ago, he decided to try to forget about the man he met by pouring all his attention into job hunting.

It worked, as he started being offered more interviews over time, the longer he was job hunting and the more he got used to the whole job application process, but he was applying to so many jobs that it was hard to keep track of which jobs he was even applying to. Since he had been out of school for a few months now, he was just desperately applying to anything and everything he was even slightly qualified for. As a result, when he finally received a call back one day, he had no idea what job or company it was for.

Phainon was in the middle of job hunting, as was his daily routine, when his phone began vibrating upon his desk with another random number. It was just the norm for him now to answer calls from strangers in the hopes that it was regarding a job, and it was just another one of those days when he picked up his phone to answer.

“Hello, this is Phainon.” Phainon leaned back in his desk chair, hoping that he didn't just give his name to a spam caller.

“Hello, Phainon, this is Krateros from… Entertainment.”

Phainon furrowed his eyebrows. He did not catch the company name at all, but he tried to sound as excited as he could, nonetheless.

“Hi, Krateros!” If only the man were here to see just how beaming Phainon's work smile was. “How are you?”

The deep voice grunted over the phone. “Good, thank you. I am calling to offer you the position of private pilot for our high-profile client. As I am the client’s manager, I wanted to offer you my congratulations.”

Phainon froze. Woah, he was not expecting a job offer today.

He sat straight up in his chair, running a hand through his hair. Fuck, what was the company name again? Phainon desperately began pulling up his emails to try to find anything with the name “Krateros” in it.

“Wow, thank you so much, Krateros. I truly, sincerely appreciate the offer.” Phainon squinted at his desktop screen as his emails reflected against him. He didn't even have time to be excited as he was still trying to recall who this person was. “It would be great if I could review the details. Would it be possible to send the offer to me in writing so I can get back to you in a couple of days?”

“Of course. I will have the team send it over to you in a few minutes. Please look it over, and I hope to hear some good news from the team.”

With the shortest return offer call ending and with Phainon's heart now pounding in excitement from finally receiving a job offer after so many months of job hunting, Phainon opened up the search bar in his emails. Even though he couldn't even catch the full company name, he searched through his emails nonetheless, searching for “Entertainment” to see if some sort of confirmation email came up from when he submitted his job application. He did remember that the caller's name was “Krateros,” so if all else failed, he could search up that name too. Although there were a few entertainment companies that Phainon had applied to, the only email thread that matched “Entertainment” and “Krateros” was a company named “Kremnos Entertainment.” From the email thread, Phainon gathered that he had passed the initial resume screening, had an interview with their human resources department, had an interview with this man named Krateros, and then he was accepted.

Continuing to squint at his desktop, he tried to recall any possible memory, but to no avail. The email thread was from a few weeks ago, and Phainon could barely even remember what he even had for dinner just last night. He *did* remember visiting an entertainment company for an interview, and he *did* remember how awestruck he was at seeing such a grand skyscraper in the city. However, he couldn't really remember anything else.

Kremnos Entertainment? Phainon opened up a search engine in a separate tab and typed the name in. It immediately popped up, and a photo of the building appeared at the top of the search results. It was the exact same skyscraper that Phainon recalled from his memories, and he scrolled down to see if he could find some sort of website that could jog his memory on what his job was even going to be. He could only assume from the job position that he was flying a private jet. Was he flying a private jet for one of the company's celebrities? Maybe an executive? The man over the phone didn't reveal much at all, and Phainon could only assume that it was classified information until he actually accepted the job offer.

His finger, which was scrolling through the web page, immediately froze when an extremely familiar name was shown to him. Staring at the name, with his heart now pounding for an entirely different reason, he reread it over and over and over again, as if finally receiving a job offer had suddenly made him delusional.

"There's no way." Swallowing dryly and even with shaking fingers, Phainon clicked the link that was embedded in the name, and there was no denying the blonde man that appeared all over his screen.

*Mydeimos* was a part of Kremnos Entertainment.

It was a name he had been trying to forget for the past few months. A name that he had been trying to erase from his mind, but was pouring all of this attention and energy into job hunting instead. But here the name was again, as if it were haunting Phainon of his stupid mistake all those months ago. He could barely even remember what the guy sounded like anymore, and it was weird that he could just click on any video of him and hear his voice again.

It was then that he received an email. Phainon quickly clicked on the notification, and it was, indeed, from Kremnos Entertainment. It was an official offer letter with details of his job position, expectations, benefits, and salary. And holy fuck was the salary good. It was honestly a little *too* good. The benefits were also not bad at all either, and it even came with a hefty sign-on bonus. Phainon was about ready to accept any measly offer that came his way, but perhaps his luck was looking up for him again.

Maybe losing the celebrity's number was the cost he had to pay for receiving such a grand return offer. The only thing the offer letter didn't include, which Phainon would have been surprised if it even was included, was who this “high-profile client” Phainon would be flying around in their private jet.

It didn't matter to Phainon, as this offer was way too good to let down. And, if he managed to run into Mydeimos, that would be even better. In fact, that would be *ideal*. Even though he was just starting to get over the guy, it was only because he had absolutely zero means of contacting the man. But now, he had a chance again, and a new fire surged within Phainon as he continued rereading the offer letter over and over again and reviewing the benefits multiple times. Phainon wouldn't have expected to be accepted as a private pilot, since he had just recently received all the necessary certifications and pilot hours a few months ago, but he couldn't exactly complain about a job offer.

It was quite the sweet deal as a private pilot. The position promised a schedule a month ahead of time, which was atypical for a private pilot, and Phainon was quite amazed that he could even call out sick in the first place. The position details mentioned that, in the case he needed to call out for any sort of reason, they would call a backup pilot from the company. Which was… quite generous to say the least. And as his position was under the company of Kremnos Entertainment, he was also getting the benefits and job protection of any average employee working at their headquarters rather than an on-call, separate entity that just worked with the company’s clients. That also meant that Phainon could be called upon at any time to fill in for any other private pilots who called out within the company, but Phainon didn't really mind at all. There was only one thing left to do now.

Phainon was now employed.

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“Congratulations!”

With resounding cheers echoing across the table, everyone clinked their glasses together, laughing and hollering amongst each other. It was a few days after Phainon had accepted the job offer, and Phainon informed his

friends that he was finally employed. It was a Saturday night, and all his friends had gathered at a restaurant in the city to celebrate Phainon's employment over a nice evening dinner. Phainon didn't reveal much to his friends other than that he had accepted a job offer, as he wanted to reveal to them in person what the job was. He was also sure they were going to be flabbergasted at the company he was working for, and he wanted to see their reactions in person.

“You didn't tell us what job you accepted!” Hyacine leaned forward at their table toward Phainon. “I've been waiting all week to hear what job you have now! I was feeding the pandas at work and kept thinking about it all week.”

“We gotta see who gets paid the most now,” Cipher chimed in. “No one is beating Aglaea's fashion designer salary.”

“I only get paid a lot when my designs are used.” Aglaea took a sip of her wine with a light chuckle. “Otherwise, I am making patterns for nothing.”

“Aglaea, you get paid almost millions for your designs!” Cipher cried. “I *still* remember all the fashion shows you get invited to.”

“That's quite the exaggeration, but thank you, Cipher.” With a smile, she set a delicate hand on Cipher's shoulder to sit her back down, as the woman had jumped up from her seat from excitement at some point over Aglaea's salary.

“Tell us, Snowy! Tell us!” It was Tribbie's turn to jump up and down in her seat, and Phainon laughed at the enthusiasm over his own employment.

“I definitely don't get paid as much as Aglaea does.” With a chuckle, Phainon began pulling up the offer letter on his phone for them.

“Is it a lot though?” Of course, money was the only thing at the front of Cipher's mind.

Another laugh escaped Phainon as he finally located the offer letter in his emails. “It's definitely more than your police officer salary, Cipher.”

“No way!” Before Phainon could turn his phone around, Cipher had already stood up and snatched it from his hands across the table. He blinked blankly at his empty hand before turning to Cipher, who was already scrolling through his phone.

“Holy…” Cipher's eyes were as wide as the plates set in front of them as she continued scrolling through Phainon's phone in her hand. Everyone at the table only watched her with anticipation, waiting to hear what else Cipher had to say.

“So? What's the verdict, Cipher?” Hyacine leaned over the table to try and get a view of the screen, but because she was sitting across from Cipher, and because Cipher was still standing, she couldn't exactly see much.

“The verdict is that Phainon's paying for our dinner tonight!” Cipher threw her hands up into the air. “Phainon, I want three more cocktails! No, make it five! Six! Twelve!”

“I haven't even started yet! And you want *twelve* cocktails?! Does this place even serve twelve different kinds of cocktails?!”

“Oh, please.” Cipher waved Phainon's cries away. “The moment you get that sign-on bonus, you could pay for everyone’s meal a thousand times over. And, why do you think I'm not going to repeat the good alcohol?”

“You get a sign-on bonus?!” Hyacine exclaimed.

“It must be a big company,” Castorice added. “Where is it?”

They all stared back at Cipher, who still had Phainon's phone in her hands, and she quickly glanced back down at the offer letter. “It's… *uh.*.. Kremnos Entertainment?”

“Woah!” Hyacine jumped excitedly up and down in her seat, turning to Phainon, who was seated right beside her. “That's one of the biggest celebrity management companies!”

“Celebrity?!” Phainon swore he could see dollar signs in Cipher's eyes. “No wonder he gets paid so damn much! Maybe I should've gone to pilot school.”

“I would not trust you to drive my plane, Cipher.”

“*Aww*, Anaxa! I wouldn't want to drive you either!”

“Do not call me that.”

“I've honestly never heard of it before until now.” Phainon chuckled. “I only just looked it up when I received the offer.”

“Ooh, you're right!” Hyacine began digging for her own phone. “We should look up all the celebrities at Kremnos Entertainment.”

“Celebrities?!”

“Yes, Cipher, I work at a famous entertainment company now. You don't have to get excited about it again.”

“I feel like you weren't this excited when you heard about my clients,” Aglaea chimed in with a light laugh.

“Well, that's because that's expected of you, Aglaea!” Cipher truly was Aglaea's biggest fan. “See, I wouldn't expect *Phainon* to be working with famous people.”

“So why did you say my name like that?”

“You know exactly why I said your name like that.”

“Guys!” A sharp gasp pierced the air, and everyone's attention was now drawn to the pink-haired girl looking down at her phone. It was a dimly-lit restaurant, and the phone screen brightly illuminated Hyacine's shocked expression. “That guy… That–That guy!”

“That guy,” Anaxa deadpanned.

“The guy! The guy that… That guy! Phainon's guy!” Hyacine stammered, staring at everyone with wide eyes. “The… The blondie! The rockstar!”

Phainon only understood what she was saying because he already knew this information, and he was trying really hard not to laugh at how flabbergasted Hyacine was. But he was shocked when Castorice, who was sitting on his other side, gasped along with Hyacine.

“Is he under Kremnos Entertainment?” Castorice had brought a hand up to her mouth to cover her open mouth, and everyone’s eyes went wide when they finally understood what Hyacine was trying to convey.

“Yes! Mydeimos is under Kremnos Entertainment!” She exclaimed and turned her phone screen around. Under a list generated by the search engine that listed well-known names that were being managed by this company, one of them very clearly read “Mydeimos.”

“There's no way!” Cipher, who had just started to get settled in her seat, jumped up once more. “We're going to meet a celebrity! A celebrity!”

“Wait, wait.” Phainon had to raise his hand before she started getting ahead of herself. “I don't know who I'm a private pilot for. It could just be for some executive at the company and no one famous.”

“*Aww*.” Cipher sank back down to her chair with a pout, and Aglaea laughed, patting her shoulder comfortingly.

“They didn't tell you when you accepted the offer?” Anaxa frowned.

“They told me I would meet them on my first day.

“That's… suspicious.” Anaxa crossed his arms and leaned back in his chair. “They should've told you when you signed the offer letter. Are you sure this place is real?”

“I definitely went there in person to interview,” Phainon explained while Cipher handed Phainon's phone over to Anaxa so that he could also review

the offer letter. “I also thought they would tell me after I signed the offer letter, but they just said I would meet them on my first day.”

Anaxa hummed as the phone screen illuminated his face this time. “You really do get paid a lot.”

“Right?!” Cipher jumped up once more, but was quickly pulled down again by Aglaea. “That's why I want twelve cocktails!”

“With this bonus, Phainon could pay for way more than twelve.”

“You really think so, Anaxa?!” Cipher's eyes were glowing even under the dim restaurant lighting.

“I told you to stop calling me that.”

“I'm not buying you twelve cocktails, Cipher!” Phainon sharply cut in.

“But Anaxa said you could buy even more than twelve! If you're not buying me twelve, can you buy me thirty-three?”

“Where the *fuck* did you get such an exact number from?! And when did you ever agree with Anaxa?!”

“When he said you could buy me more than twelve cocktails!”

“So where did the number *thirty-three* come from?!”

“It just spoke to me!” Cipher raised the menu sideways and began flapping the cover, imitating a talking mouth. “‘Cipher, order thirty-three cocktails. Phainon will pay for it all.’”

Castorice giggled. “Why does the menu have such a deep voice?”

“That's the sound of me after thirty-three cocktails.” Cipher nodded enthusiastically.

“Why would I get you thirty-three cocktails so your voice could change?” Despite the exasperating situation, Phainon couldn't help but be amused by

her antics.

Cipher batted her eyelashes from across the table. “Don't you want me to sound more like your love, Mydeimos?”

“That's–*What?!”* Phainon's face burned red at the sudden mention of the rockstar. If Phainon was in the middle of drinking anything upon hearing her words, he was positive he would have spit it all over the table. “Why would I want you to sound like him?!”

“*Aww,* Phainon, I'm sure you miss his voice!” Cipher cooed.

Phainon was sure his red face could be seen even in this darkened restaurant. “Even so, I don't want you to *sound* like him!”

“Wait.” Cipher suddenly grew rigid. “You think if I actually sounded like him after thirty-three cocktails, I could get signed by Kremnos Entertainment and become the next biggest rockstar?”

“Why are you imagining thirty-three cocktails already?!” Phainon wailed.

“There's only one way to find out!” Tribbie exclaimed, and Phainon couldn't even believe he was watching Cipher and Tribbie high-five each other over Aglaea's head, as Aglaea was sitting in the middle between the two of them.

“Cipher,” Castorice cut in, and Phainon really thought he was saved. That was, until he heard her next words: “That's a great idea for a story.”

Phainon tiredly buried his face in his hands while Cipher began exclaiming, “Right? Right?! You gotta start taking notes and make it the next script you write!”

Cipher and Castorice somehow began brainstorming for this wild story, and Phainon sincerely hoped a new theatrical play wasn't about to be released under Castorice’s name. In the midst of them adding a gay romance into the mix when the main character, whose voice changed after thirty-three

cocktails, made out with a suspiciously familiar new graduate at a suspiciously familiar club, Hyacine turned toward Phainon.

“Did you know Mydeimos was under Kremnos Entertainment?” On her phone screen, she still had the list of celebrities open.

Phainon laughed at her question, rereading the man's name on her phone. “I wanted to see everyone’s reactions once you found out. I only found out myself when I received the offer and looked up the company.”

“It's certainly surprising.” Somehow, Aglaea was communicating just fine next to Cipher, who was at some part of the story where the new graduate was begging on their knees for the celebrity to stay by their side. “Will you speak with him if you cross paths with him?”

Determined, Phainon nodded. “I could only hope he gives me the time to explain myself.”

Resting her chin in the palm of her hand, Aglaea tilted her head to the side. “Still, he may not be interested in you anymore. Will you still try to talk to him?”

“Even then, I still want to explain myself. I just want to sort out any misunderstanding about me that he may have had on his end.”

“Even if he doesn't want to speak to you?”

“Even if…” Phainon trailed off. He didn't even think about that. He was so intent on speaking to the rockstar that he hadn't even considered the slightest possibility that he might not even want to see Phainon at all. What did Mydeimos even think of him? Phainon could only hope it was nothing negative, but with the way Phainon had basically ghosted the guy, he was sure there were no positive thoughts about him left in Mydeimos’s head.

“Aglaea!” Hyacine cut in. “Don't say that! We should be rooting for Phainon right now!”

She shrugged. “It's something worth considering. Will you beg for him on your knees to listen to you like what their story is saying?” Aglaea waved a hand toward Cipher, who was still droning on about the story with Castorice.

With a light laugh, Phainon really tried to imagine the hypothetical situation. “If he really didn't want to see me… I think I would try as hard as I could to get him to listen to me, no matter what. He doesn't… have to agree with what I say or start anything with me; I don't have those expectations at all. But, I just hope he will listen to me, even if it's selfish of me to ask for.”

Hyacine pouted. “Phainon, you should be hoping he still wants to date you.”

“Date?!” Phainon immediately blushed once more. “I don't even know if the guy wanted to date me all those months ago!”

“Well, he gave you his number because he was at least interested in you, right?” Hyacine remarked. “Surely, he considered the idea of dating you.”

“I'm sure he did before I practically ghosted the guy.” Phainon sighed.

“It wasn't on purpose!” Hyacine patted Phainon's wilted shoulders. “I'm sure he'd understand.”

Phainon frowned. He really didn't think that hot-tempered guy, who was starting an argument over a stranger’s literal drink order, would peacefully listen to him, but Hyacine had never met the guy to know what he was like. Now that he was thinking back on his temper, he started feeling more and more nervous. There was absolutely *no* way he wasn't furious with Phainon, right?

Well, Phainon didn't have to worry about that unless he actually met Mydeimos, and surely a rockstar such as him would be busy and booked the entire day, right? Maybe they would never even cross paths at all, even if they were working at the same company.

“It's nice to see you again, Phainon.”

Phainon nodded and shook the hand that was held out in front of him. Now that he was seeing Krateros in person, he definitely remembered the guy. With his dark brown hair, graying bangs that matched his thick mustache and beard, and a scar down one side of his face, Phainon clearly remembered thinking how cool this guy looked. The guy looked like he, himself, was a rockstar.

“It's nice to be here.” Phainon smiled at the older man. Phainon had just come from Kremnos Entertainment’s headquarters to complete onboarding paperwork and orientation, and it was the afternoon by the time Phainon arrived at the city's airport. The human resources team instructed Phainon to meet Krateros there, and true to their word, he was waiting outside the private jet that Phainon would be flying. It was an extremely sleek beauty, this Dassault Falcon 8X, and Phainon could tell the private jet cost a very pretty penny just from looking at it–a pretty penny as in millions of dollars.

“The individual I manage and your co-pilot are already in the jet.” Krateros gestured towards the door. “I'd like for you to inspect the aircraft and anything else you would need to do before we set off for the day. Once you’re finished, I can introduce you to them. The flight attendant will be arriving soon, and I can take your luggage in for you. You received the flight schedule, correct?”

Phainon nodded once more, and Krateros bid him a brief farewell before disappearing into the aircraft. He had received the flight schedule the night before, and he was quite surprised at how many places they were going to. He was basically flying them across the country, hitting every major city along the way, before returning back to their starting point. He couldn't even begin to imagine who he was possibly flying for still.

With the sheer size of this private jet, Phainon wasn't the least bit surprised he had a co-pilot; in fact, he probably would've been more nervous if he *didn't* have a co-pilot. As Phainon had never flown this specific jet before, he really wanted to do a careful inspection of both the exterior and interior before setting off. Considering how beautiful and almost pristine the

condition of the private jet in front of him was, Phainon was sure there wouldn't be much to attend to.

With a sigh, Phainon began his inspection. Like his previous thoughts were saying, there really wasn't much he had to do. Actually, the more he inspected the aircraft, the more it seemed like it was brand new. There were absolutely zero signs of wear, and every single part that Phainon checked over was basically the newest model. Even when he climbed inside the cockpit, it just made Phainon all the more nervous. Was this private jet really brand new? How rich was this company to just afford a brand new jet? He originally thought he was just replacing a private pilot who left a vacancy, but now Phainon was realizing that the company had posted a whole new position.

Everything was basically in top shape, and even the co-pilot had already recorded the predicted weather during their route, so there wasn't much left for Phainon to do. Exiting the cockpit, he found Krateros sitting at the conference table in one of the plush seats to the right side of the aircraft. Considering that the main area was empty, he could only assume that the co-pilot and the person he was flying were all the way in the back of the plane, where the divan was. It was where people on private jets usually slept, since the divan could be converted into a bed.

As he approached Krateros, the man glanced up from his laptop. “Done?”

“Everything looks great. In fact, everything looks really new.” Phainon chuckled as Krateros pushed himself up from his seat.

“Good. It should, since we just bought this plane.”

Phainon’s eyes widened in shock while Krateros began to walk towards the back of the plane. So the aircraft actually was brand new?! He couldn't even comprehend the sheer amount of money this company had, and it still didn't completely settle with him, even while approaching the back of the plane to follow Krateros.

It was quite the swanky private jet with plush seating facing each other right when you exit the kitchen that was in front of the cockpit, more of the same

seating to the right, but with a conference table, and a credenza to the left that was also padded on the top so anyone could comfortably use it as a seating bench as well. Toward the back of the plane, which could be accessed through an arched doorway, Phainon could only assume the sleeping area was there, along with the bathroom and storage for their luggage.

Before Krateros could open the door leading to the back of the plane, the entrance to the jet burst open, jolting both Phainon and Krateros.

“I'm here!”

Phainon whirled around towards the source of the loud voice, and there a woman stood in the classic flight attendant uniform, with a button-up, collared dress shirt adorned in a black waistcoat and flared, black dress pants. She must be the flight attendant that Krateros mentioned earlier.

“Empousa,” Krateros’s voice sounded behind Phainon, “this is the new pilot.”

“Oh, hi!” The woman, Empousa, began wheeling her luggage over to their direction. “Yes, Krateros mentioned you before. It's nice to finally meet you.”

With a smile, Phainon laughed at the grand entrance. “It's nice to meet you too. I look forward to working with you.”

“Oh, don't be so formal.” Empousa waved her hand in the air. “We're all friends here, just trying to get to our destination. Has he met everyone yet?”

“We were just about to before you busted into the plane,” Krateros tiredly answered. It seemed that they had already worked together long enough for Krateros to become used to Empousa’s antics.

“Oops!” Empousa laughed. “Sorry, sorry! Let's go then! You're Phainon, right?” She began pushing Phainon with one hand over to the closed door while pulling her luggage behind her. “Our boss is *super* generous. I'm sure you'll get along with him, no problem!”

“Could you tell me a bit about him?” Phainon stumbled over his feet when he suddenly started getting pushed down the aisle, and he eventually caught himself when they arrived at the door.

“He's quite famous, you know! Maybe you already know about him?”

“I don't even know his name,” Phainon chuckled sheepishly.

“Oh! Krateros didn't tell you yet?” Empousa leered over Phainon's shoulder at the older manager, who only rolled his eyes in response. “If you're into rock music, don't freak out too much.”

“Rock… music?” Phainon swore he felt the pit of his stomach sinking, and his feet would've been rooted to the floor if Empousa hadn't hurriedly pushed him through the door that Krateros had finally opened. There was no way, right? There was genuinely, absolutely, no way it was who he was thinking of, right? He was sure there was more than one rock singer under Kremnos Entertainment, right? One that was much more famous and popular than the man whom Phainon was currently thinking of?

As he stumbled through the door, he was too busy trying to catch himself to properly look at everyone in the room, but he didn't have to.

“Mydei!” Empousa exclaimed, pushing Phainon over by his shoulders. “Come meet the new pilot!”

Wide golden eyes met Phainon’s blue ones, and Phainon froze under his gaze. His entire body grew tense, and he couldn't even breathe, let alone make a single sound. It was only a few months ago, yet it felt like an eternity since he saw that golden head of hair, sharp, cat-like eyes, and chiseled jawline. He was just as intimidatingly attractive as Phainon remembered, and even more attractive than the posts of the man Phainon had seen all over his social media account. It was the same person that had been filling Phainon's mind for months, and it was the same person Phainon could no longer reach to the point where he just had to give up and move on.

That was, until now.

# Chapter 4: Mydei

Mydei had been existing in bed for the past week. He would scroll through his phone, throw it across his bed, and then continue scrolling through his phone for hours and days with no end in sight. He didn't want to do anything, and he didn't want to think about anything at all. Mydei just felt like an empty husk that existed in this bed forever and ever.

It had been a week since he had voluntarily quit his own band. It was a band that was formed when he was young and stupid in school, and it was formed with five of his equally stupid friends. They had grown together as a band from the ground up, playing in janky garages and overcrowded clubs. They had spent days and weeks crowding in each other’s rooms and overstuffed closets, writing music, and recording songs before eventually landing their first official contract with Kremnoan Entertainment when they were offered a business card at one of their many lousy concerts in some underground club. They went from an old garage to an official recording studio, but all they wanted was to just play music together. That was the only plan that they had; no one had ever expected to make a full-time career out of it, let alone face all the pressure that came from being a celebrity.

He had a disagreement with his bandmates. Mydei wanted to make new music. They had been writing the same old stuff for so many years, and Mydei wanted to try something new. He wanted to push the band into a new direction, and he wanted to foster growth within the band, their music, and themselves. Mydei wanted to explore new things, to try new things, and to put the band out of its comfort zone. He thought it would be good for everyone, and he still believed that even now. His bandmates, however, wanted to stay true to their roots. It was something that Mydei could understand, as that was where they came from and how they got to where they were now. Although Mydei did care about their fans, he cared more about his passion for music, and even if there was a possibility their fans wouldn't like their new stuff, Mydei still wanted to go for it. Nonetheless, his bandmates overruled him, so Mydei could do nothing but continue in the same direction as before.

Their disagreement got in the way of everything. It got in the way of Mydei's singing to the point that even news outlets were reporting on his voice. It affected his songwriting, and even interviewers were urging them with answers as to why their lyrics were not the same anymore. It affected their stage performance, and fans wondered why Mydei didn't have nearly as much energy on stage anymore. Social media was a poison, and it constantly speculated what happened to him; injuries that didn't exist, family problems, even though Mydei was now estranged from his parents, overworking even though Mydei was well-rested, and mismanagement that didn't exist in Kremnos Entertainment. Everything and anything that was on camera was heavily scrutinized, and fans and media outlets were making up reason after reason for Mydei’s shift in behavior.

His bandmates kept urging him, but Mydei couldn't truly change how he felt. They knew how many eyes were on them and how much pressure the public was pushing onto them, but Mydei still couldn't help his emotions. It left him stressed and destroyed, and he couldn't even be a good lover to Hephaestion, the drummer of their band. They got into so many arguments over the band, over Mydei’s performance, and over themselves. It ruined Mydei's heart to continue staying with the band, and even after trying so hard, Mydei made the decision to leave. He knew best how he felt, and he was the harshest critic of himself and hated his performance the most. Despite his bandmates wanting him to stay, their differences in the band's direction would eventually tear them all apart, so Mydei decided to leave first. He broke up with Hephaestion, broke up with the band, and left for good. He had even tried to leave Kremnos Entertainment altogether about a week ago, but the CEO had a different idea for Mydei: To go solo.

Mydei had never considered the idea of going solo at all. He only came this far because he just wanted to make music with his friends; he couldn't ever imagine doing it all by himself. It had been a week since the idea was proposed to him, and he was still tossing and turning in bed. The news of his leaving the band, The Detachment, hadn't been made public yet, but Mydei couldn't help but continually search through social media to see if anyone had caught on. The entertainment company’s public relations department was truly an expert, because even after a week, no news had escaped at all.

With a loud sigh and another throw of his phone, Mydei pushed himself off from his bed. He needed to get out of this Hellhole before his brain exploded. He had been cooped up in his room for the entire week thinking about the band, his old friends and bandmates, his ex-boyfriend, and going solo. Mydei wanted to forget about it all and think about literally anything else. And where was the best place to go to forget all about your problems? There was obviously only one place to go, and Mydei pulled a simple outfit over his body before venturing out of his door.

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Mydei thanked the bartender over the pounding music, taking a mighty sip of his pomegranate cocktail. He had left his phone at home, not only to forget about his problems, but also so that his manager wouldn't find him sneaking out to the club when Mydei was supposed to be lying low from the public. His manager, Krateros, was the manager for the entire band, and they had put their activities on pause while Mydei’s exit from the band was finalized. Because of that, they were inactive on every platform, and the public was wondering what happened to them. Krateros had instructed him to lie low, but Mydei was going to lose his mind if he did that. So here he was, at a club that he hadn't been to in quite a long time, sipping on a cocktail in hopes of forgetting all about his problems.

He used to come here quite often with his bandmates, but once they had become so well-renowned, they hadn't come here to avoid attracting attention. It was nice seeing that basically nothing had changed since all those years ago when he and his friends would get blackout drunk and do only God knows what.

Mydei clicked his tongue in annoyance. He came here specifically to forget about everything and everyone. His plan was to get so blasted that he would even forget his name. Mydei wanted to drink the night away, dance the night away, and hear Krateros’s scolding tomorrow while he was hungover. That was the night's plan, and Mydei was on his third cocktail when someone next to him had ordered an Old Fashioned.

Mydei scowled. Who the Hell is ordering whiskey at a club?

“You're actually ordering that?” Mydei almost wanted to believe the guy was ordering it as a joke, and he was even waiting for the man to change his drink order

“*Excuse me?”* The stranger glared in his direction. Oh fuck; the guy had actually heard him over the music and people? Mydei couldn't help his tipsy brain from verbalizing his thoughts, but he didn't think it would be a problem since it was so deafeningly loud in the club.

“That. You're willingly going to drink that?”

“Do I know you?!”

Obviously not, but Mydei still found it amusing that the man was even entertaining this conversation with a stranger. If someone had mocked his order, he would've just left. Mydei was surprised the guy was even still talking to him.

“Does anyone know anyone else at this club?”

“If you don't know anyone, then why judge what I'm drinking?”

Mydei wanted to laugh at the situation. He hadn't meant to actually be heard by the guy, yet here he was, getting into an argument with some stranger at the club. Would Krateros have to pull him out of a fistfight tonight? Krateros was never going to let Mydei out of his sight ever again if “laying low” somehow became “get into an argument with some stranger at the club over his weird drink choice and eventually start throwing fists.”

“I'm only judging because who the fuck orders an Old Fashioned at a club?”

“What's wrong with an Old Fashioned?!”

Was this guy seriously asking that question? Did this man just burn all his taste buds away from drinking so much whiskey? “It's bitter as Hell.”

“Then what the fuck are you drinking?!”

His question suddenly reminded him of the actually good drink in front of him. With a smirk, Mydei lifted the glass from the counter. “It's definitely way better than an Old Fashioned.”

While locking eyes with the stranger, he downed the majority of his drink, reveling in that sweet taste of pomegranate that washed over his entire being. It was a taste that he would never get tired of, and it definitely beat out any drink with whiskey in it. It seemed that even the stranger was intrigued, as he didn't move a muscle even when the bartender had placed his Old Fashioned on the counter next to them.

“Give that to me.” The man held out his hand.

Mydei raised his eyebrow at his sudden command and lowered the glass from his lips. “Why should I do that?”

“If you're not going to tell me what you're drinking, then let me try.”

Mydei wanted to scoff and tell the guy to go order his own drink instead of taking his, but he barely managed to dodge the man's hand that had suddenly shot out at him. With wide eyes, Mydei moved his glass away before it could be knocked out of his hand, but his breath was knocked out of his chest instead when he felt his back hit the wall behind him. Somehow, he had become pinned between the wall and this stranger in front of him, and Mydei wasn't sure if he should shove the man off of him or not. Would that start a physical fight? Would that count as Mydei throwing the first hit? Glaring up at the man’s face, which he could now see since they were so close together, Mydei's alcohol-riddled brain immediately paused.

Okay, maybe he shouldn't do that.

The man was *fucking hot*. Mydei couldn't believe this was the same guy who decided to order a cursed Old Fashioned. Mydei was always attracted to men who were carefree, loyal, affectionate, yet also fucking stupid at the exact same time. This guy, with his sparkling, blue eyes swirling with mischief and the slight smirk that danced across his perfect lips while trying to steal Mydei's drink, attracted Mydei way more than he would have liked. It really didn't help that the guy was also just conventionally attractive, with

his naturally smiling eyes, sharp jawline, curved lips, and… extremely well-built body. Mydei worked out himself, but this man's physique even rivaled his own. It was hard for his tipsy brain not to stare and gawk at his entire body.

The man didn't seem to notice their proximity at all as he lowered his eyes to stare at the glass that was still in Mydei's hand. “What is it?”

Mydei swallowed dryly, feigning confidence. “Wouldn't you like to know?”

“That's why I'm asking.”

Blue eyes stared directly into Mydei's golden ones, and the stranger’s eyes widened like saucers. Confused, Mydei furrowed his eyebrows. Was he surprised at seeing Mydei? Oh, wait, was he being recognized right now? During the exact moment when he was supposed to be lying low? Was the headline, “Rockstar Mydeimos Picks Fight with a Hot Fan at the Club Over Awful Drink Choice,” going to be all over the news tomorrow? Krateros seriously wasn't going to let him hear the end of it.

“Quit staring.” Mydei shoved a hand against the man's shoulder just enough to wake him from his daze. He needed to confirm whether this man recognized him or not. “Do you know me?”

“Have we met before?” The man adorably tilted his head to the side.

Mydei let out an internal breath of relief. He wasn't sure why the man was staring at him with such surprise, but he didn't care so long as he wasn't recognized.

“Forget it then.” Thank fuck, or else he was going to have to make a call to their public relations team. At even the slightest thought of that, Mydei brought his glass back up to his lips to take another sip. He was clearly not drunk enough if he could still think about work.

“Give me that!”

Before Mydei could even respond, which he didn't plan to, the drink was whisked away from his hand. As he was literally in the middle of drinking from the glass, some of it spilled all over himself and the floor when the man had taken it, and Mydei stared at him with an expression of complete and utter bewilderment, exasperation, disbelief, and anger. But the man ignored him and continued drinking from the cup.

“It's…” He furrowed his eyebrows as he stared at the glass in his hand that was now almost empty. Did this guy really drink that much of his glass? Well, Mydei was sure it beat out an Old Fashioned any day, so he couldn't blame the guy. “Am I imagining things, or does this taste like pomegranate?”

“Never tasted a pomegranate before?”

“I just didn't realize bars carried pomegranate juice.”

“Obviously, if you choose to drink an Old Fashioned.”

“Old Fashioneds are sweet!”

Mydei scowled. “You call anything with whiskey in it sweet?”

“Try it!” The man pushed the drink along the counter in Mydei's direction, who had zero inclination to pick up the glass.

“I'm not drinking that.”

“It's sweet!”

“It would ruin the taste of my drink.”

The man groaned tiredly. “If you're not going to try it, then don't judge it.”

“I've tasted enough whiskey to know how much I hate it.”

“Old Fashioneds are sweet!”

“Anything with whiskey is bitter, and it burns.” Seriously, has this man never tasted whiskey before?

As if the man could read Mydei’s thoughts, he swept the glass into his hand and downed a part of his drink. And, much to Mydei’s surprise, the man actually looked like he was enjoying such an awful drink. It was to a point where Mydei couldn't even look at the man anymore as he watched the liquid slip past his lips through the glass. Yet, at the same time, did this man's lips just look really good, or was the alcohol just hitting him really hard? His lips were being wetted by the drink, and it only served to shine and glisten under the dim club lighting that was blinking in and out to the beat of the music. As much as Mydei really wanted to press his lips against his, he also didn't want to taste whiskey. But the man made the drink look so good.

Suddenly, the man lowered the glass and held it out for Mydei. “I drank some of your drink, so you should drink some of mine.”

With a click of his tongue, Mydei snapped, “I didn't ask you to take my drink.”

Even with those words hanging in the air, Mydei's hand still reached up to take the cup from his hand. Staring at the shimmering glass, he couldn't stop himself from the tempting thought of drinking from the same place those plump, wet lips had earlier. And with a dry swallow, he brought the glass to his own lips, letting the lava slide down his throat.

He could feel the man's eyes boring straight through him, but he tried to ignore it as he really attempted to enjoy the drink. It was to no avail, however, and Mydei couldn't stop himself from physically wincing from the attack of the drink. It clogged up his senses, burned his throat, and Mydei swore his eyes were brimming with tears. It didn't even taste good for the pain to be worth it; why would anyone voluntarily pay for this?

“Still bitter.” Mydei couldn't help a cough escape him, but it did little to soothe his throat or his sinuses. “And it still burns.”

Mydei desperately grabbed his glass and drank what little was left of the pomegranate cocktail in an attempt to soothe his throat and his nose. Thankfully, it was enough to at least cool him down, which was ironic considering the amount of alcohol he now had in his body was making him hot.

“It's really not that bad.” The man took another sip of his drink, and Mydei almost laughed at how he so obviously avoided the spot they had both drunk from previously. Was it the alcohol, or was this man's face burning red? He doubted someone who, presumably, regularly drank whiskey wouldn't react so quickly to it. Then the other possible reason, especially since he had so carefully avoided drinking from the same spot that they had before, made Mydei's heart pound in his chest. It almost made him want to go for it. He didn't know anything about this man, only that he was loud, pouty, whiny, very expressive, and had bad taste in alcohol.

And that he was really, really fucking hot.

Slamming down his now-empty glass, Mydei shot the man a glare and muttered, “I can't believe you made me drink that.”

“It's not that bad!” The man retorted as he set down his own glass. “I don't know what you're tasting, but it's definitely not what I'm tasting.”

Mydei scoffed, rolling his eyes. It was official; the alcohol was hitting him *hard*. What was the alcohol content of that damn whiskey? That, combined with the three pomegranate cocktails he had earlier, Mydei was definitely no longer sober. His limbs were feeling sluggish, and he couldn't think of anything else except for this man in front of him. His heart was pounding right into his ears, and his own chest was getting rattled from his heartbeats the more he kept eyeing the man in front of him. Strong arms to hold him, big hands to grab him, broad shoulders to wrap his own arms around, a slim waist to wrap his own legs around–

“Then, let me taste what you're tasting.”

The man frowned. “I just did?”

Mydei was seeing red. The club lighting was blue, but it was completely out of his sight now that he had wrapped his arms around the man's shoulders and pulled him over. The stranger stumbled and barely caught himself against the wall behind Mydei's back, and Mydei was pinned in a way that left his stomach swirling in anticipation. If this man wasn't attracted to women, he wouldn't be pinning Mydei to a wall with wide eyes, flushed cheeks, and gawking at Mydei’s lips, right?

It was so hard for Mydei to keep still. He just wanted to jump the guy as if he were in heat, pin him down, and do whatever he wanted with the man. Was this a good idea? Definitely not. “Lying low” did not include “making out with the first person you speak to with a dick at the club.” Mydei also just broke up with his boyfriend, quite literally a week ago, and he should definitely be taking a break from other people. But with the way the man didn't move from his grasp, staring at him with his adorably wide blue eyes as if he didn't know what to do with Mydei right in front of him, Mydei almost wanted to laugh at how cute he was.

He wanted this man deep inside of him.

Leaning forward, Mydei brushed his lips against the other man, and he felt his body shiver under his arms. Thank fuck this man was attracted to men, because Mydei's brain had already resolved to not leave without him tonight. He wouldn't know what he would feel like if the man suddenly revealed he wasn't attracted to men.

“I meant from here,” Mydei whispered against the man's lips. And his initial thoughts were correct; they were so soft and smooth, and his body couldn't wait another second to press them against him, suck him, bite him, lick him. “The best way to taste what you're tasting is right from here.”

The man's breath hitched in his throat, his blue eyes darting between Mydei's lips and his eyes, and within one swift motion, Mydei was pressed back against the wall with soft lips roughly pushing into him.

Mydei moaned at the feeling of those lips finally moving against his, at the feeling of the man's tongue swirling deep inside his mouth. His eyes rolled into the back of his head when the stranger's tongue slid against his. Maybe

the man was right; maybe whiskey tasted sweet after all, because Mydei couldn't get enough of the taste that danced along the man's tongue. He could barely even breathe with the way they were shoving their tongues down each other's throats, lapping at the taste of the other man through messy pants and kisses, but Mydei wasn't going to have it any other way. It almost filled him with a sense of pride that this man was just as desperate for him as Mydei was.

He was clawing at the man's shirt, pulling at the man's hair, and hearing the man’s deep moans and sighs vibrating along his lips and filling his eardrums. He was desperate to feel more of this man within his hands and to have this man fill all five of his senses. He only wanted to see this man in front of him, have his moans and pants fill his eardrums, breathe in his scent, taste and lick and suck every delectable inch of his skin, and feel only him all along his entire body. Mydei's pants were straining against his erection, and his legs were trembling to keep him up the more the man continued to shove him into the wall and rub his tongue along every part of his mouth. The roof of Mydei’s mouth was tingling, and the inside of Mydei was itching to be teased.

With an arch of his back, Mydei dragged his body along the stranger's, and moans emitted from both of their throats at the friction. Two hands snaked down to grasp at Mydei's waist, and he couldn't stop the whimper that slipped past his lips from how tightly the man was grasping him. He couldn't even begin to imagine how tightly the man would hold him if Mydei could have his way with him, and it only made the pit of Mydei's stomach thrum in arousal. It was as if he could feel the blood shooting down to his lower half, and his dick hurt from how much it tried to escape the confines of his jeans.

It didn't even feel like they were in a crowded club anymore, getting pushed and shoved by the other people trying to order a drink. Mydei couldn't even hear the music anymore; all his ears could pick up were the sounds of this man's pants and moans against him, and it only urged Mydei to hear even more of him. Their sloppy kiss, their snaking tongues, their desperate pants, and their tugging and grasping and pulling. Everything was filling up in both of Mydei's heads, both the one on his shoulders and the one below his

waist, and Mydei had the visceral need to pull this man over to his place and have his way with this stranger. He *needed* this random man to destroy his insides. Would Krateros mind seeing a random guy in his place? Fuck, why would he even think of his manager right now?

The manager was completely lost from his mind when a knee had slotted in between Mydei's legs, and a wanton moan left Mydei's lips at the sensation of his hard dick finally receiving the friction it craved. His body quivered in delight, and he couldn't stop his hips from thrusting sharply against the man's large thighs and feeling his waist being dragged up and down by the man's large hands. Pleasure shot through his body like electricity with each thrust, and Mydei couldn't get enough of the stimulation. With each thrust and slide against the man’s thighs, Mydei felt as if he were right on the edge, and he really had to try and keep himself from exploding within his own jeans. He could barely even hold himself up on his own trembling two legs, and Mydei was practically straddling the man's leg at this point.

He kept pulling and tugging this stranger as close to his body as possible, feeling his chiseled muscles through his thin shirt, but it wasn't enough. He needed this man closer. He needed this man's body against Mydei’s, to feel him filling him up, blacking out his senses, and pulsing inside of him with the greatest ecstasy Mydei would ever feel in his entire life. This man, Mydei knew it immediately from the first thrust of his own body against the other man, was *big*, and he needed him pounding so hard inside that Mydei wouldn't even be able to breathe.

As much as he didn't want to let go of the stranger's lips, he also wouldn't be able to ask him if they wanted to get out of the club. But before Mydei could resolve this conflict in his mind, cool air brushed against his lips, and Mydei opened his eyes to see the man looking slightly annoyed at something at the side. Actually, erase that thought; the man appeared *extremely* annoyed.

Turning his head to follow the man's line of sight, he stared straight at this woman with lightly colored hair. It was hard to see with the blue lighting of the club, but was it lavender? With the way the stranger's hands were still rooted to Mydei's hips, and his thigh still slotted between Mydei's legs, he

could safely assume that the man wasn't being caught having an affair, at least.

“Did you need something, Castorice?” The stranger's voice was husky, and even the tone of his voice shot straight down to Mydei’s dick.

“Cipher is… um…” The woman’s eyes wavered at the position her friend was in with Mydei against the wall, and her face beamed a bright, crimson red. He was sure this was quite the position to find your friend in.

Mydei dug through his memory trying to remember if he could hear anything while having the best make-out session of his entire life, and he faintly recalled her voice calling out the name “Phainon.” In fact, her voice had called this name multiple times, but he ignored it as he wasn't sure who “Phainon” was and only assumed some poor woman was trying to find her friend in the crowded club. Little did he know, he was making out with said Phainon.

“Cipher?”

Castorice's eyes shot back to the man, a deep blush evident across her cheeks. “She… um… threw up outside the club and blacked out. She's with Aglaea right now, but no one can carry her except for you.”

“She *what?!*” The man, Phainon, cried but quickly recovered with a frown. “No, wait, that sounds exactly like something Cipher would do.”

“I'm really sorry.” Castorice's eyes darted back to Mydei before returning to Phainon. “But… would you be able to help bring her home?”

With a loud, deeply regrettable sigh, Phainon furrowed his eyebrows in exasperation. Mydei stared at the man, but he didn't seem the least intent on leaving Mydei's side at all with the way Phainon's hands tightened around Mydei's waist. As much as Mydei didn't want him to leave either, he should probably go help his blasted friend.

Mydei opened his mouth to make the second most difficult decision of his life, with the first being leaving his band. “Phainon.”

The man jumped and whirled his head to stare at Mydei with wide eyes. He probably wasn't expecting to hear his name from Mydei’s mouth.

“I–”

“Just go. Help your friend,” Mydei cut him off before Phainon could fit in another word. If Phainon so much had even the slightest counterargument, even if it was the least convincing argument he would ever hear, Mydei would cave immediately. It wasn't as if he wanted Phainon to leave either, and it wasn't as if his dick wanted to leave without Phainon's touch either.

With a sorrowful and regrettable sigh, Phainon gave him the most adorable, teary-eyed pout that almost made Mydei tell him to forget about what he said and to forget about his friend altogether. “Would I be able to see you again?”

Mydei sank deep into thought. Shoot, he didn't bring his phone. “Do you have your phone? I'll give you my number.”

With wide eyes, Phainon quickly dug into his pockets, but it seemed that the man didn't have his phone either.

“I…” Another sigh left Phainon's mouth. “I'm sorry. I left it with my friend.”

Mydei shook his head and dug into his back pocket, bringing out a black permanent marker. He always brought one around in case he ran into a fan asking for an autograph. “I don't have my phone with me either, but I can write it down for you.”

Scanning around the two of them, Mydei opted to write his number down on the cocktail napkin on which Phainon's Old Fashioned was served. Writing his number, he decided to write his name as “Mydei” instead. While his full name was “Mydeimos,” it was the name he, ultimately, debuted with, and now he associated his full name too much with his work. It was why he slowly adapted to the name “Mydei” and asked his close acquaintances to call him that as well, switching his full name to be treated more as a stage name.

Handing the napkin over to Phainon, the man squinted in the dark to make sure he could actually read Mydei's handwriting.

“Your name is… Mydei?” Phainon glanced up from the napkin with a quizzical expression, which further confirmed that this man in front of him did not know who “Mydeimos” was. Thank goodness.

Mydei nodded in response. “Text me later when you make it home.”

He thought it was quite a simple ask, but the man’s face bloomed red at his words. Mydei couldn't help the light chuckle that escaped him while Phainon finally untangled his limbs from Mydei and departed from the club with his friend. Was Phainon just really innocent or extremely easy to please? Either way, Mydei was looking forward to hearing from him again. As a celebrity, he could never really give his personal phone number out so easily, but he truly, full-heartedly, wanted to see Phainon again.

# Chapter 5: Mydei

Twelve times. This was the twelfth day Mydei had woken up in a hot sweat. The twelfth day that Mydei had woken up sticky and haunted by his dreams. The twelfth day that he had seen sparkling blue eyes and an adorable pout lit up by blue lighting, even while Mydei was sleeping. The twelfth day his brain couldn't stop thinking about plump lips pressing against him, large hands grasping his waist, and broad shoulders pinning him down. And it was the twelfth time Mydei had to get himself off in the morning because he woke up with an erection in his pants. Every single morning since that day, he got off on that silver hair and those teasing eyes and those pouty lips, and every single morning, Mydei felt a hole in his chest without fail after every single orgasm.

*Twelve* days had gone by without a single word from that man he met at the club. *Twelve* days Mydei spent waiting and waiting to no avail. Mydei couldn't even believe that the first time he had ever offered his number to a man, he would be ghosted immediately. He truly thought that stranger were attracted to him too, that it wasn't just him who was so deeply interested in the other person. But maybe he was wrong. Maybe that man woke up the next day, sober, rethinking the entire night and his entire time with Mydei. Maybe he even regretted it and decided it was easier to just never reach out to Mydei, as it would be rare if they ever met again.

Mydei's body shook, a whimper escaping his throat as he pulled his fingers out from behind him, leaving him empty. They were soaked in lube, with cum running down every single inch of his body. Mydei was still trying to overcome his high, his chest rising and falling with every breath, and his pounding heart rattling his ribcage. His vision slowly returned to him, and bright blue eyes disappeared from his mind.

He had gotten used to sleeping on a towel so he didn't stain his bed sheets, but now this towel was in complete ruin. Still catching his breath, he forced himself up from the cum-stained towel, tearing his clothes off and throwing them elsewhere in his room to join the other cum-filled clothes that littered his floor. He replaced the towel with another one after quickly washing off

his body, as he was sure this routine was going to continue for a while, and he pulled some fresh new clothes over his body and returned back to the blanket fort he had set up on his bed.

Mydei thought about going back to the club. He thought about sneaking out when Krateros wasn't looking again to go find that man. But, he wasn't sure if he would even be there anymore, and even if he was, he wasn't sure if the man wanted to see Mydei again. He didn't want to pop back up into the guy's life when the guy was trying to ghost him, so Mydei opted to never go back to the club. And since Krateros had cracked down on him ever since he found Mydei blackout drunk the day after the club, it would've been difficult for Mydei to sneak out even if he wanted to.

He still hadn't given a response to his company. It had been almost three weeks since they offered him a solo debut, and Mydei couldn't believe that he was now too busy lamenting his time with a man he had met for approximately thirty minutes at the club. Mydei was barely even thinking about his job or his friends or his band anymore. All that swirled in his mind was Phainon, and even if he tried to really sit down and think about a solo career, all he could think about was what Phainon was doing, what he was thinking, and why he didn't just message Mydei that he was no longer interested so Mydei could stop having these dreams about him. Mydei just wanted to stop waiting for Phainon, and he despised himself for how much he yearned for that man.

Mydei went from scrolling his phone for any sort of celebrity news or news about The Detachment to scrolling through Phainon's social media account, which he was able to find quite easily. Mydei couldn't get enough of his puppy-like grin, shining blue eyes, and silver hair that was all over his account. He learned the man had just graduated from school, loved dogs, loved museums, and loved working out. He learned the man loved reading and spending time with his friends, and he was quite the loyal friend.

Was that weird? Yeah, it was definitely fucking weird. But Mydei genuinely could not think of anything else except for this man. He had thought that maybe he would stop wondering about him if he just found out more about him, but the more he learned about Phainon, the more the man was exactly like his ideal type. And Mydei fucking hated him for it.

Mydei's brain kept imagining going on museum dates with him, visiting the library with him, visiting the gym with him, and even meeting the many friends that were posted on his account. He hated how much his mind kept pushing him into different scenarios with the other man, and Mydei almost wished they had met under different circumstances where he had a better chance of accidentally running into the guy just to see him again. But alas, Mydei was a celebrity, and he couldn't be as carefree as this man and his friends in all of these social media posts.

His ears faintly picked up the beeping of his front door lock, but he didn't move a muscle. He was watching a video of Phainon playing with the dogs at the dog park, and all the dogs were tackling the guy to the floor. Even his laugh was music to Mydei's ears–better than any song he had ever written.

“Mydei!”

Mydei jolted in bed when a hand slammed against his door frame, and he peeked over his phone to see his manager, Krateros, leering at him from the entrance to his room.

“You're here,” was all Mydei said.

“Yes, I am,” Krateros grumbled and threw a bag of food toward Mydei's direction. “Did you even get up today?”

Mydei furrowed his eyebrows as he attempted to recall. He really only got up to change his clothes after getting cum all over them this morning, as has been his usual routine for the past twelve days. What time was it again?

A heavy sigh resounded from the door, and he watched Krateros pull up a chair to sit by Mydei's bed, cracking open a can of soda. “It's been almost three weeks now. Did you even think about the proposal at all?”

Mydei stayed silent. No, he hasn't. He knew he should be, and he knew he wasn't the type of man to get easily distracted either. Mydei was quite dedicated to his work, and he was proud of the things he had accomplished in his career. Yet here he was, watching Phainon repeatedly get tackled by

dogs in the grass. Mydei almost wished he were also one of the dogs to give the man in the video a piece of his mind.

“Mydei!” Krateros barked impatiently, and Mydei tore his gaze away from his phone again. The manager sighed, pinching the bridge of his nose. “You've been laying here wrapped up in your sheets for *weeks*. And you still haven't come to a decision at all?”

Instead of answering his manager at all, Mydei asked him something else instead: “How is everyone?”

Krateros was the manager for The Detachment. Since Mydei hadn't officially, on paper, left the band yet, Krateros was running around trying to deal with both The Detachment and Mydei separately. Although they were lying low while Mydei's drop was being sorted out, three weeks have already passed, and Mydei was sure the company was pressuring Krateros to resolve this feud, especially since all The Detachment’s activities were put on pause for this. Mydei knew the company and his bandmates wanted to resolve their differences and rejoin the band before the public found out, but this wasn't anything Mydei could easily sweep under the rug. It was why the company offered him a solo debut in the case that Mydei refused to rejoin The Detachment, but Mydei didn't have the space in his mind to consider the deal.

Another sigh escaped Krateros. “Fine. They definitely want you back, Mydei, but I know you've already made up your mind. I keep telling them that, and they're adjusting to continuing the band without you.”

“They'll definitely need a new singer.” Mydei let out a weak laugh. “Peucesta was my backup. Maybe he can finally have his chance to shine. And, I'm sure Ptolemy will have no trouble writing songs without me.”

Krateros nodded and took a swig of his soda. “That's what I suggested to them as well, and they seem to be heading in that direction. It seems that Hephaestion will be the new leader.”

Mydei didn't even feel anything anymore after hearing his ex-boyfriend’s name, and he knew Krateros was gauging his reaction to that name,

considering that he knew they were in a relationship. Instead, he stared back at his phone screen, which was still replaying Phainon at the dog park.

“You really didn't think about it at all?” Krateros grumbled. “Not a single thought in that head of yours went to consider a solo debut? The Hell were you thinking about while cooped up in your room? I know you haven't been anywhere since that time at the club.”

At the mention of that day, Mydei physically winced in bed, and it certainly did not escape Krateros's attention.

With narrowed eyes, Krateros slowly pronounced, “What happened at the club.”

Mydei equally narrowed his eyes back at his manager. “Nothing.”

“Don't fucking lie to me. What happened.”

“Nothing to concern yourself with.”

“I'm not asking, Mydei.”

“I don't think it's any of your concern.”

With another loud, exasperated sigh, Krateros learned back in the desk chair and took another mighty sip of his soda. Mydei was sure Krateros wished it were a beer. “Just eat. I know you haven't gotten up since you woke up, and it's 5 PM now.”

At hearing the time of day, Mydei resignedly shed the blankets that he had tightly bound around his body, and he reached for the food that Krateros had thrown at him earlier. But faster than he could react, an arm reached out underneath Mydei, and it was then that he realized he was being tricked.

“Hey!” Mydei cursed to himself, swiping a hand over to Krateros’s direction, but the manager deftly dodged him. For an old man, he was frustratingly nimble.

“This is the new man of your eyes?” Krateros scoffed, staring at Mydei's phone that he had stolen. “You disappeared for one day–not even a day, a *night*–and already found someone else?”

“That's not true at all.”

“Then tell me.” Krateros flipped the phone around. It was a new picture of Phainon at some amusement park, and even in the situation Mydei was in, he still found Phainon cute with the animal ears headband that adorned his head. Of course, he was wearing puppy ears. “Were you or were you not thinking of this man ever since that night at the club?”

Mydei could not answer his question.

With a click of his tongue, Krateros learned back in his chair once more, scrolling through Mydei's phone. “I can't help but agree this man is exactly your type.”

Mydei scowled. He didn't want to be talking about his taste in men with his manager, of all people.  “You have no idea what my type is.”

Krateros raised a challenging eyebrow. “How long do you think I've known you for? You think I don't know every damn little thing there is to know about you? It's my job to know.”

Mydei fell silent.

With yet another long sigh, Krateros threw the phone onto the bed, landing right in front of Mydei. “So, how long have you guys been talking? Since that night, or did you know each other earlier? I have to know in case this man pops up all over the media in pictures with you one day.”

“We're not talking.”

“You're still going to lie to me?”

“I'm being serious.” Before Krateros could let out another sigh, Mydei threw his phone over to Krateros, and it hit the man right in the chest. “Just look if you don't believe me.”

Narrowed eyes scanned his phone screen after unlocking Mydei's phone, and he watched Krateros clicking through various downloaded applications. It was a few minutes later that his manager hummed and locked the phone once more.

“You told me the truth.”

“That's what I said.”

Krateros threw the phone back onto Mydei's mattress. “I'm surprised.”

“Surprised about what?” A dry laugh left Mydei's lips. “That I'm taking my career seriously?”

A loud scoff escaped Krateros, and he took a huge gulp of his soda. “As much as you care about your work, you still do whatever the fuck you want. So what happened? You obviously like the guy if you keep sitting here and stalking him.”

“It's not stalking.”

“The Hell do you call this, then? Scrolling endlessly on this man's account, who you don't even talk to?”

Mydei could not answer his question.

“So what happened?” Krateros repeated.

It was as if the entire night replayed in Mydei's mind, and his eyes wavered at the thought of Phainon once more. “Nothing happened. That's the whole problem.”

Krateros fell silent, staring at Mydei as if he were mentally receiving an entire recount of Mydei's life, starting with his night at the club, which Mydei really hoped Krateros couldn't actually see. All he did was pick a fight with a stranger, make out with said stranger, and finger himself to that stranger for the past twelve days.

“So he ghosted you.”

That made Mydei pause. Did he actually just see a recount of Mydei's past two weeks? He really fucking hoped not.

At Mydei's silence, Krateros ran a tired hand through his dark brown hair. “How surprising. That guy didn't give me that impression.”

“Yeah, well.” Mydei could only shrug. “Men.”

Krateros heartily laughed, raising his can of soda to that before downing the rest of his drink. Krateros was definitely a very straight man, but even he appreciated a good joke with a good drink.

With that laugh, Mydei began indulging in the food that Krateros had brought for him. It was seasoned chicken wings that were lavished in a rich and creamy sauce, and they were surprisingly still somewhat warm. Taking a bite into the tangy sauce that drenched the meat made Mydei realize just how starving he was.

“So now what? You going to sit here mourning the man of your dreams?” Krateros set the empty can down onto the floor and learned right back into the chair, kicking his feet upon Mydei's bed. “Or are you going to pour all of that into your work instead?”

Mydei scoffed at that, ripping another tender piece of the chicken. “What do you think, Krateros, of me going solo?”

“I think you would be great at it,” Krateros answered, stealing a chicken wing. Was it really stealing if Krateros paid for it? “I was relieved when the company told me they made you that offer. I thought it would be a waste for someone of your talents to leave, and I figure the company thinks that as well. Out of The Detachment, you're the member with the most fans. You'll do just fine without your bandmates, and the band can adjust without you.”

Flashes of old memories with the band ran through Mydei’s mind, and he smiled solemnly, tearing his teeth back into his food. “That means I'll have to get a new manager.”

Krateros paused in his bite. “What are you talking about?”

Mydei appeared equally as confused. “Because you're the manager for the band?” Mydei thought this was obvious knowledge. “You can't manage two talents at once.”

“I'm leaving.”

The bite of food lodged in Mydei's throat, and he choked on his food. With a laugh, Krateros reached down and cracked open another can of soda, handing it over to Mydei, who downed the carbonated drink. Where was Krateros pulling all this soda from?

Gasping for breath, Mydei finally readjusted with Krateros patting his back.

“You're *what?”*

“I'm leaving The Detachment.”

Mydei narrowed his eyes, gripping tightly onto the can in his hand. “For what? Just because I'm leaving doesn't mean you have to.”

Krateros laughed, withdrawing his hand from Mydei's back. “What difference does it make, whether I manage you or The Detachment?”

“Then you can just stay with The Detachment. Why bother going through the trouble of leaving?”

“I enjoy managing you more than I enjoy managing The Detachment.”

That truly made Mydei pause once more. Did his ears actually hear that, or was his mind just imagining nonsensical things now? That was the nicest thing Krateros had ever said to him in all these years of Krateros being his manager. Was he dying tomorrow?

He quickly gathered himself after getting over his initial daze. “So if I go solo, you're leaving The Detachment to be my manager?”

“That's right.”

Mydei couldn't help the laugh that slipped past his lips and took another sip of his soda. Damn, now *he* was wishing this was a beer. “So, you and I will both be leaving The Detachment?”

Krateros smirked and plucked another chicken wing from the open to-go container. “Only if you go solo.”

Returning the smirk, Mydei tossed the idea in his head. If both the company and his manager thought it was a good idea, then why shouldn't he? Why hesitate? Who needed Phainon anyway? He was rich and famous, and he should be enjoying a life all to himself, making music and performing in front of millions of people. Meeting new people, pouring his soul into music–that was his life. Why was he wasting his time away in bed, thinking about a man who wasn't going to give him the time of day?

“Fine. Schedule me a meeting with the executives.”

Mydei was going to show that bastard who ghosted him that he didn't need him at all. That stupid and handsome silver-haired bastard who was way too good at using his tongue, how dare he have the audacity to ghost Mydeimos, the biggest rockstar of the current century?

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A few weeks had passed since that conversation with his manager, and it was during that same week he had that conversation that Mydei spoke with the executives at his company. It was official: Mydeimos would be debuting as a solo artist, and Krateros would be his manager. The Detachment would be assigned a new manager. News of Mydei's drop from the band still hadn't been made public yet, and only circulated within the company, yet now that so many more people knew, it was clear that rumors were already circulating within the media. The company decided to drop the official news once Mydei was close to being ready to debut, which would be once a new debut album, complete with a new debut music video, was finalized.

Mydei had been spending the last few weeks holed up in his room, but it wasn't because of the band or that silver-haired bastard anymore. Guitars were strewn all over his bed, and sheet music littered the floors. He had been writing songs with extreme fervor, and after everything that he had

experienced a few weeks ago, he had *a lot* he wanted to say and *a lot* he wanted to express. There were songs with anger, songs with passion, and songs filled with remorse and regret. One particular song was made that was a lot different from what he usually wrote, and it was the song that the company wanted to choose to be at the top of the track list and made into a music video. They wanted to showcase that Mydeimos was different from The Detachment, and this song would signal his new rebirth.

It was a song of yearning, a song that was made when he reflected on those twelve days. He had officially named it Twelve Days, and although he didn't include the number of times he had masturbated during that period, he included everything else that he felt. He felt loved, and he felt betrayed. He felt anger, yet he felt okay. He felt stupid and dumb, but that's what it was like being young, and that's what he wrote about. The song came to him so easily, and he had never written a song quite like that before with so little effort on his end. Was it weird to be writing a song about a stranger who had ghosted him after only thirty minutes of knowing him? Probably, but it somehow became Mydei's best work.

Only he and Krateros understood what those twelve days truly meant to him, and Mydei still wanted to keep it that way. He left the song as vague in its details as possible, yet as filled with emotion as possible. And somehow, the executives loved it too. They said the vagueness made it relatable to everyone, and the raw emotion they felt from the song brought tears to their eyes. Mydei almost wanted to roll his eyes at how dramatic they were being, but all that really mattered was that they liked the song.

The next few months went by in a blur. Mydei and Krateros were the busiest they had ever felt in preparing for this new debut. Krateros was busy with the logistics: preparing the projected schedule, including scheduling media interviews; interviewing and hiring new staff to assist with supporting a new talent with the agency; buying required supplies and equipment; and coordinating with different studios for song recordings, photoshoots, and music videos, all the while keeping this new solo debut as classified information. Mydei truly, sincerely appreciated Krateros's hard work, and he knew the manager was just as anxious for this solo debut as Mydei was.

Meanwhile, Mydei was trying to churn out all of these songs, and he had to learn and adjust to how to make music without his bandmates. It was hard to get used to; he didn't have anyone to rely on except for the producers within the company who worked with all the talents under Kremnos Entertainment. Considering that his songs were so full of his own emotions, he didn't want to rely too heavily on paid staff employees, but he also didn't have his friends anymore that he could rely on. No one could help him develop a new beat of rhythm, no one could help him write the lyrics. It was all on him now, and it was something that he had to accept now that he was debuting as a solo artist. This was going to be his new life now.

It was later that year, when news of Mydeimos took the world by storm, that he had decided to leave The Detachment voluntarily to debut as a solo artist. Mydei watched the news in real time, seeing all the different theories as to why Mydei decided to leave. Fans referenced Mydei’s latest performances with The Detachment and mentioned how tired and exhausted he seemed; other people argued that he may have had a disagreement with the band. Some others theorized that Mydeimos never got along with his bandmates in the first place and was finally fed up with them. Other people wondered if Mydeimos's contract with The Detachment was finally coming to an end, and he left the moment the contract ended so he could make music on his own now. Because Mydeimos was staying with the company, the company was still held in quite a good standing since the rockstar decided to stay, but many were still angry that they didn't have good enough management to keep The Detachment together in the first place, and that it had to come to Mydeimos leaving for good.

After the news had dropped, there were only a few weeks left until the projected date of Mydeimos’s debut. The songs had already been finished and perfected in the recording studio, the music video was in the midst of finishing its final editing touches, and the photoshoots were already completed. Mydei was getting more and more nervous as the date quickly approached, and he wasn't sure how exactly the public was going to react to his new music. Would they hate his new sound? Mydei felt that it was the typical pattern for fans to hate the new music, as they had become fans due to their old sound. But Mydei wasn't worried too much about that; The

Detachment was still making their own music and carrying on their old sound. It just didn't have Mydei’s touch anymore.

Although Mydeimos was a huge rockstar well-renowned across the country, it was still hard to predict just how big his debut would be received. There were both angry fans and excited fans, but what would really be the deciding factor was how they received Mydeimos’s new music in the first place. The executives, although they promised to continue Mydei with his new solo career, no matter how well or poorly it was received, decided they would invest further money depending on the media’s opinion of his songs. This meant that further music videos could be put into production, more interviews could be scheduled, another album could start being written, and even a tour could happen, depending on the public's opinion of Mydeimos. They only invested enough for the basics for now: photoshoots, a music video, one album, and only a handful of interviews, so Mydei could promote his new debut. Everything else would have to wait until after his new album dropped.

There were only four people in his penthouse apartment when it came time for his debut, and Mydei was included in that count. The other people were Krateros, his manager; Empousa, his flight attendant; and Herklas, one of his pilots. They were part of the private jet that flew The Detachment around, and although they still assisted in those flights, they still wanted to come over during Mydei’s date of debut to support him. Mydei and his bandmates had become quite close to these two during the years of flying for their concerts and world tours, and he was plenty grateful that they had come to visit him to support his debut. He had originally thought it would just be him and Krateros in his apartment, watching public opinion spread once the album dropped.

Mydei was nervous, bouncing his leg and watching the countdown of his album's release on his television screen in the living room. He didn't really concern himself with public opinion all too much, but it felt like this was quite the turning point in his career, and whatever the media said about his new album felt like it would portray whether leaving The Detachment was even a good idea or not.

Empousa and Herklas had brought a massive amount of food and alcohol to watch the new music video once it dropped, as Mydei hadn't even seen the music video in its finalized form either, and they were all crowded upon Mydei's couch, indulging in the food and waiting for the music video to start. Mydei, however, was way too anxious to feel like eating, which didn't escape any of the other three's eyes.

"Mydei, *eat*." Empousa threw a container filled with fried chicken on the table, and it somehow landed with perfect accuracy right in front of where Mydei was sitting. "I know you're nervous, but at least fill your stomach with something while we wait."

"I will throw it up," Mydei blatantly replied, scrutinizing the fried chicken that glistened under the lights.

The woman sighed and picked at her own chicken drumstick in her hand. "What are you so nervous about? You already played your album to me, and I think it sounds great."

"She's right." Krateros's mouth was filled with chicken, and Mydei barely understood what he was saying. "Eat, Mydeimos, and worry after your stomach is filled with good food."

Mydei sighed and ran a tired hand down his face. It was basically almost midnight, and they were waiting for it to be midnight so that the debut album would drop. But after running around and working overtime for so many months to get everything ready in time for this specific date, he was about to collapse from exhaustion. He was already on his fourth beer, trying to stay awake, but of course, the alcohol was making him even more tired. He was feeling an extreme mix of both exhaustion and anxiety, and Mydei just wanted to fall asleep to not have to feel anything at all.

"*Eat!*"

The rockstar was jolted awake when a seasoned fried chicken wing was shoved against his mouth, and he had to throw out his arms to stop Empousa from pushing him down.

“The Hell?!”

“I'm not going to stop until you open your mouth!”

A piece of the chicken managed to slip past his parted mouth while he was speaking, and Empousa applauded while Mydei begrudgingly chewed on the meat.

Mydei gulped down the food; he had to admit that it was actually really good with the booze. “My manager is right there, you know.”

“And this was actually your manager's idea.” With a pleasant smile, Empousa sat right back down in her seat and continued to eat. Mydei shot a glare toward Krateros, who refused to lock eyes with the rockstar and kept his head low instead to nibble at his own food. She looked way too pleased with harassing Mydei.

It was then that a loud guitar strum echoed across the living room, and everyone’s attention shot up to the television screen that was now playing the music video. It was starting with a close-up shot of Mydeimos's fingers, playing the guitar to the opening beats of his debut song.

It was midnight.

# Chapter 6: Mydei

The debut was an overall success, much to Mydei's pleasant surprise. Although there was a good part of the media that couldn't get accustomed to Mydeimos's new sound and harshly critiqued his songs, the majority of the media was excited about where Mydeimos would head next. He could tell that promotions for his debut were off the charts, as the number of views on his music video and streams on music streaming services were record-breaking for him.

Mydei took pride in his debut; he had put a lot of effort into the songs and recordings, pushing that silver-haired bastard out of his mind and putting all his attention and energy into working for this debut. The music video came out great, the photoshoots came out nice, and the quality of the song recordings that were being streamed was of high quality, even to Mydei’s picky ears. The executives applauded him and even announced that they would like to do a tour, if Mydei was willing to have one.

Of course, he wanted to have one. What kind of question was that? The best part of being a rockstar, other than being able to create music, was to perform said music. Mydei happily accepted the offer for a tour, and the locations and dates were soon announced. They kept the locations within the country for now, but depending on ticket sales, they may expand to accommodate more dates and locations even outside the country.

Although The Detachment wasn't going on tour, Mydei figured that he would just be using the same private jet that they used to use; however, Krateros had somehow successfully argued with upper management to fund a brand new private jet just for Mydeimos. He was shocked that the approval actually went through, and Krateros had the human resources team quickly push through a new position for another pilot, as the private jet Krateros picked out was huge and required two co-pilots to drive the plane.

Krateros was hustling, and Mydei was plenty amused with the enthusiasm that he held for Mydeimos's solo debut. He worked out the concert venues, ticketing prices, and promotions with the other internal teams for the next

few weeks until finally, the tour had arrived. Although the first location of the tour was in the city he already resided in, he would have to fly to the next tour location. Krateros informed him that he and the team had already interviewed and hired a new pilot to work alongside Herklas, and Mydei wouldn't have to worry about a thing except for preparing for his debut tour. Mydei would meet him once they fly was all he was told about the new pilot.

The first day of the tour was a success. Mydei was surprised at how many people even showed up to the concert, and although it was plenty strange performing without his bandmates at his side, it wasn't too bad with all the practicing that Mydei had been putting into preparing for the concert. Considering the positive reception he was hearing after the concert had ended, both from staff, his manager, and social media, he figured he was doing a good enough job. He only had a single day to fly to his next location, and the next concert would immediately take place the day after.

As much as he wanted to collapse into his bed after the concert, he needed to pack since the flight was tomorrow. The styling team usually packed his stage outfits for him, so all he really needed to worry about in terms of clothes was just clothing to sleep in or clothing on the days he had a break. Mydei haphazardly threw in some random shirts, tanks, jeans, and sweatpants, making sure to also pack workout clothes in the case he had time on his rest days to fit in his usual workout routine. In a half-conscious daze, he finished packing the rest of his toiletries, accessories, and other random, miscellaneous items that he wanted to bring with him, as he wouldn’t return home until the tour was over. He also carefully packed his precious guitar, a black custom Fender guitar, with him for the tour. It was his signature guitar that he was always seen with, to the point that even the media itself associated black Fender guitars with the rockstar, Mydeimos.

The rest of the night and his morning were a blur. He finished packing everything, slept through the night, woke up in the morning, and prepared for his flight that was supposed to take up the majority of his day. Krateros picked him up and drove him to the airport, where the new private jet was already waiting for their arrival. They would fly out in the afternoon because the new pilot had to wrap up onboarding and orientation with the

company in the morning before heading straight to the airport to fly Mydei. Mydei couldn’t help but frown at that explanation Krateros had given him while they were heading for the airport. What a wild first day for a new hire.

They were waiting in the private jet, which Mydei had already taken the time to admire since it was so brand new, before resting in the back area of the plane with Herklas. Empousa had already messaged Krateros that she was on her way, but there was no rush since they couldn’t exactly leave without the new pilot anyway. Mydei had tried to ask Herklas for any information about the pilot, just to satisfy his own curiosity, but Herklas informed him that he had never met the new pilot either. The human resources team and Krateros were the only people who met the new pilot. Oh well, Mydei wasn’t going to concern himself so much with someone else. He only asked just because.

Krateros was busy working on his laptop in the main area of the private jet, and Herklas was in the back of the plane with Mydei keeping him company. They had already stored all of their belongings away, and Mydei was now relaxing, scrolling languidly through his phone while waiting for takeoff. This was probably the first time in such a long time that he was able to relax, as he was either rushing to finish songs, rushing to shooting locations and studios, or being riddled with anxiety over his debut. Today was a day when he could finally rest now that he knew everything was looking up for him, and he hoped that his luck would stay exactly like that.

Except for the part where Mydei spoke way too soon. The saying “the calm before the storm” rang terribly true for Mydei.

Mydei and Herklas jumped in place when the plane door slammed open. Because the area Herklas and Mydei were in was enclosed by a door, they couldn’t exactly see anything. They had only faintly heard Krateros talking through the closed door, and Mydei wasn’t sure if he was speaking to other people on the phone or if the new pilot had finally arrived. But now, with the door slammed open and a loud, female voice yelling away, Mydei could only assume that Empousa had arrived.

“Looks like Empousa is here,” Herklas muttered without even glancing up from his phone. Both of them were quite used to Empousa’s antics after working with her for so long now.

With a chuckle of agreement, Mydei resumed scrolling on his phone. It was typical Empousa behavior to be late and very loud about it. He wasn’t sure how Empousa managed being a flight attendant without missing a single flight.

He could hear voices talking from beyond the closed door: a mix of Empousa’s voice, Krateros’s voice, and a new male voice, which Mydei could only assume belonged to the new pilot. It meant that everyone was now here for the flight, which also meant they would be taking off soon. As it was early afternoon, it was exactly the time that they had planned on the schedule to depart from the airport. Good job for arriving barely on time, Empousa.

Loud footsteps could be heard in front of the door; what was Empousa doing to that poor new hire out there? But just a few moments later, the door was swung open, and Mydei glanced up and found Krateros.

Even though he couldn’t see Empousa, he could definitely hear her voice ringing from behind his manager: “Mydei! Come meet the new pilot!”

A man dressed in the typical pilot uniform of black slacks, black dress shoes, a white button-up dress shirt that was rolled up to his sleeves, and a black tie was roughly pushed into the area where Mydei and Herklas resided. Why did it feel like Empousa was hazing this new employee? It really wasn’t necessary to push the poor guy over here–

Wait, Mydei was going to immediately take back that previous statement.

The man raised his gaze from the floor after stumbling into the room, and both men widened their eyes at the person before them. Mydei’s shoulders immediately grew rigid at those familiar blue eyes that had haunted him in his sleep, that silver hair that he had pulled on before, and those same lips that Mydei had craved all those months ago.

It was this fucking bastard!

He almost wanted to stand up and just leave the room, but this was *his* private jet for *his* tour. Mydei couldn't even hire a new pilot even if he wanted to, or else he would be way behind schedule and miss a majority of his concert dates. Maybe Herklas could fly the plane himself? No, that was illegal.

"This is Phainon!" Empousa didn't notice either of the men's reactions upon laying eyes on each other. "He's going to be working with Herklas in the cockpit."

Herklas, who had clearly noticed how uncomfortable Mydei appeared, turned his attention toward Phainon and nodded. "It's nice to work with you."

"It's… nice to work with you too." It was a rough smile, but Phainon got over his stupor and turned his attention to Herklas. Mydei couldn't believe it was the same bastard who had ghosted him a few months ago; he was pretty much the only reason Mydei even had a successful debut in the first place.

Phainon glanced at Mydei and winced at Mydei's not-so-happy expression. "It's… um… nice to work with you as well, Mydeimos."

"Oh!" Empousa exclaimed, jumping up and down. "You already know him? You like his music?"

"I… guess so." A sheepish chuckle left Phainon's lips. Fuck, he still sounded just as pleasant as ever to Mydei's ears.

"Do your best," Mydei only said, and the pilot flinched once more.

"Mydeimos?" Phainon was shaking just like a little puppy. At least he knew he was in the wrong, which made Mydei feel slightly better about himself. "Could we talk?"

"Could you drive the plane now?"

A silence immediately followed Mydei's words. Even Empousa didn't know how to react, and her mouth dropped open in complete shock.

Mydei only crossed his arms and turned his head to the side. He wanted to talk *now?* After leaving him without a single word for all these months? If Phainon wanted him so bad, he should've reached out to Mydei while he still had the chance. "We have to leave now if we want to be on schedule."

"It'll be quick–"

"Maybe if you drive the plane fast enough, you can come talk to me."

Another silence followed Mydei's words. Krateros stared back and forth between the two men, confused as to why Mydei was treating this guy with such hostility, but his eyes suddenly widened in shock as the realization dawned on him. Yeah, he'd *better* fucking remember the pilot now. Seriously, Krateros interviewed the guy and didn't even recognize him?

"You a pilot now?" Mydei raised an eyebrow, his glare never ceasing.

"I… yes." Phainon awkwardly shifted in his spot.

"Great. Show me how well you can fly this thing."

As if getting the message, Phainon silently and dejectedly left the back of the plane. As much as Mydei felt bad at seeing how defeated the man looked, he still couldn't forget how abandoned and betrayed he felt waiting for the damn guy to contact him. Not even a single word from him, and here he was, begging to talk to him? As if Mydei was going to give him the time of day.

Three pairs of eyes immediately turned to Mydei.

"Mydei." Empousa furrowed his eyebrows. "Phainon is a nice guy! Why did you–"

Krateros held his hand in front of Empousa. "Start preparing the kitchen. We will begin takeoff soon."

Her eyes widened, but she gritted her teeth and stomped out of the room, calling after Phainon. Herklas, getting the silent message that was hanging in the room, nodded and left toward the cockpit to get ready for takeoff as well. He shut the door behind him, leaving both Krateros and Mydei alone to themselves.

“Mydei–”

“You don't have to explain yourself,” Mydei immediately cut him off. He knew Krateros well enough to know he wouldn't have hired him if he remembered that silver-haired man he had seen on his phone screen. “It was an honest mistake.”

“Do you want me to fire him?”

Mydei shook his head. “We won't make the tour in time if we fire him right now.”

“Do you want me to fire him after the tour is over?”

His heart throbbed in his chest, and he scowled. Seriously, even after all these months devoted to forgetting about this guy, his heart still craved him so badly?

Mydei opened his mouth before he could fully stop himself. “It's fine.”

“Mydei–”

“He probably…” Mydei clicked his tongue in frustration, and his eyes wavered. Anyone knew the job market sucked right now, and Mydei felt bad for kicking the guy to the curb after finally landing a job. Phainon probably didn't even know the client he was flying was Mydei in the first place. “You didn't tell him during the hiring process that he was flying for me, right?”

It was Krateros’s turn to shake his head. “I didn't tell him anything until he saw you just now.”

“I figured.” With a deep sigh, Mydei threw his head back, shutting his eyes. “Just keep him. I'll keep it professional moving forward.”

Krateros nodded. “If anything, just let me know.”

It was Krateros's turn to exit the room, and over the speakers, Herklas's voice came through: “It is 63 degrees Fahrenheit and 17 degrees Celsius with sparse clouds in… City. We will be flying for approximately five hours toward… arriving at seven in the evening. Thank you, and we will be taking off soon.”

The engines of the private jet roared as the plane came to life, and Mydei could feel the wheels rolling along the runway to get into position. Watching out the window next to him, Mydei couldn't help but wonder who was currently driving the plane at the moment. Was it Herklas who made the announcement, or did he leave the driving to Phainon? Was he currently watching Phainon at work at this very moment? Considering that he had called him “Mydeimos” rather than “Mydei,” which was the name he had written on his cocktail napkin, Mydei could only assume that Phainon figured out who he was.

Sitting in silence all to himself, with only the roaring engines to fill his ears, Mydei's mind swirled with curiosity, wondering what Phainon wanted to say to him. How was he going to explain himself? Was he finally about to tell Mydei that he was no longer interested? Or was there a certain emergency that had happened that prevented Phainon from ever reaching out to him? Mydei would only forgive him if there was truly some extremely extenuating circumstance that prevented Phainon from contacting him, and even then, Mydei wasn't sure if he could treat him the same as he did a few months ago. Why should he give Phainon the time to explain himself? It was just selfish of him to even want to talk to him after leaving Mydei without a word for so long.

After a few minutes, he felt the plane tilt upward as they all soared into the sky. Mydei watched the city disappear underneath them and be replaced with clouds, and in just a few moments of soaring in the vast open sky, the speakers in the plane went off once more:

“This is Herklas. You are free to get out of your seats now. We are on track toward our destination… Thank you.”

The door to Mydei’s humble room busted open, and Empousa stomped inside as if she were quite literally waiting outside for Herklas's announcement to go off.

Trailing the flight attendant with sharp golden eyes, he watched her mumble and grumble under her breath, slamming the door shut, pouring him his usual mocha coffee, and practically throwing it toward Mydei.

“So,” Empousa huffed and dropped down on the divan right next to Mydei. “What was that?”

“It's mocha coffee.”

“You–!” Empousa looked ready to tear her hair out of her own scalp, but Mydei continued drinking from the coffee cup. “Why did you react to Phainon like that? Do you know him?”

Mydei didn't want to answer that question, as the innocent question had such a messy answer, so he asked her a question instead. “What did he tell you when you chased after him?”

“Nothing!” Empousa threw her hands up into the air and almost knocked the cup right out of Mydei's hands. “Oh fuck, sorry. Phainon didn't tell me anything!”

He furrowed his eyebrows. “He just walked away?”

“He gave me the saddest, most pitiful eyes I had ever seen, smiled, and then sat down in his seat in the cockpit.” Empousa slapped her forehead against her knees. “The fuck did you do to him?! He looked ready to cry!”

“*I* didn't do anything,” Mydei snapped. “Why are you assuming it was *me* who did something to *him?*”

“You gonna make a new hire cry on his first day?!”

“Isn't that the norm for anyone's first day?”

“Mydei!”

Mydei continued to ignore Empousa’s exclamations, sipping his coffee instead while she sighed and groaned exasperatedly.

“Okay, fine, whatever.” She waved her hand in the air nonchalantly. “So what did Phainon do to you? I doubt that nice man did anything remotely bad enough to warrant how you treated him just now.”

He raised an eyebrow. “Why do you have zero faith in me?”

“Because Phainon is just a cute little boy on his first day at work!” Empousa jumped up to her feet. “What did he do to warrant such evil behavior from you?!”

“That *cute little boy* is old enough to drive an entire fucking plane and make a living out of it,” Mydei deadpanned. “I'm sure the company pays him more than enough to deal with a few harsh words.”

Empousa gawked at him. “Just a few? Mydei, tears were brimming in his eyes!”

“I thought you said he just *looked* like he was about to cry.”

“That's the same thing!”

Mydei rolled his eyes and took another sip of his coffee.

“*Mydei*,” Empousa whined and slumped back down into her seat. “What did he do to you? Do you really not want to tell me?”

He continued staring at the floor with images of their night at the club flashing through his mind once more. The argument over drink orders that really meant nothing in the long run, the blatant teasing and joking, and the kissing… He hadn't thought about Phainon in such a long time, even though his whole debut song centered around him.

“Nothing happened,” Mydei acquiesced to the stubborn woman. “I met him, gave him my number, and he ghosted me. That's it.”

“He *what?!”* Empousa jumped to her feet once more, but she began dramatically pinching the bridge of her nose. “Woah, woah, woah. Wait, wait, wait. Huh?!”

He frowned up at the standing woman. “What are you so confused about? My story was plenty clear.”

“You're gay?!”

Mydei fell silent.

“Actually?!” Her jaw dropped open, but she quickly covered it with her hands. “Wait… you're right.”

“I didn't even say anything.”

“Wait, so you and Hephaestion… Wait, Mydei, are you okay?”

Mydei didn't know whether he wanted to laugh or cry at her months-late concern, but he answered nonetheless. “Empousa, that was a long time ago. I'm fine.”

“I just… I just thought you guys were really close. I didn't realize… I'm so sorry.” She sank back into her chair, her shoulders wilting at the realization.

“What happened to your energy two seconds ago?” With a light laugh, he patted Empousa’s back. “Weren't you just defending Phainon to the death and roasting me just now?”

“How could he ghost you?!” She slammed her hands on the cushioned seating underneath them, making Mydei jump in place. Well, her energy definitely returned. “He doesn't… He wouldn't do that!”

“You seem awfully confident for someone who just met him twenty minutes ago.”

“He wouldn't do that!” Jumping to her feet, she rushed out of the room, shutting the door behind her as quickly as she had come in. Silence suddenly enveloped the room he was in, with only the dull thrumming of the plane engines filling his ears once more. It was as if Empousa were never even here, and with a sigh, he relaxed back into the divan, plucking up his phone to entertain himself for the rest of the ride. That was, until the speakers turned on again. Did Herklas have something else he wanted to say? Maybe their time of arrival was being delayed for whatever reason?

“I already told you.”

Mydei's body froze at the sound of Phainon's voice. What was he trying to say over the speaker? And who was he talking to? This wasn't a typical pilot announcement; it sounded more like someone accidentally hit the button to broadcast his voice.

“You didn't tell me!” Empousa's voice rang clearly over the intercom.

“You can go ask Mydeimos. I don't think he wants to talk to me.” A sigh came after Phainon’s statement. “And I don't think I'm in a position to say.”

“You're going to tell Herklas and not me?” Empousa cried. “Mydei isn't telling me anything!”

Mydei scoffed to himself. She literally just ran out of his room after finding out the truth, so why did she run over to Phainon now?

“I only told him because I work in the cockpit with him.” Phainon laughed weakly. “I just thought… I don't know… It'd be awkward since we sit in the same room for hours on end.”

“So if I sat in the cockpit with you, would you tell me?”

“Empousa, there aren't enough seats for you, too, in the cockpit.”

“Okay, fine.” A slight pause before Empousa's voice returned. “Herklas, get up.”

Phainon laughed loudly–it was probably the happiest Mydei had heard Phainon since he locked eyes with him earlier. “Empousa, he's helping me drive the plane!”

“It's on autopilot right now! You think I don't know what altitude we're at? Herklas, get up!”

“Herklas, no!” Phainon cried.

“Herklas, get your butt out of the damn chair!”

Bickering could be heard between the new pilot and the flight attendant over the intercom, along with the sounds of a rough tussle, and Mydei had to hold in his laughter. What the Hell were they doing up there? And he was surprised Krateros was even allowing this to happen. Maybe he also felt bad for Phainon too, after suggesting to fire him, and wanted to leave the poor pilot alone for now.

“Fine, fine, fine! Leave Herklas alone!” Phainon's voice rang through the speaker once more. “I lost his number, okay?!”

A silence followed his words, and they slowly crept into Mydei's mind. It was so quiet that Mydei was unsure if they had found out the intercom was projecting their conversation the whole time, and they had finally shut it off.

What did he just say?

“You… what?” Empousa's voice echoed through the plane once more.

A loud, exasperated sigh came from Phainon. “He wrote his number down, and I fucking lost it, okay? And how the Hell am I, an average citizen, supposed to contact a fucking *rockstar* without his phone number? Trick question, I *can't*.” Phainon clicked his tongue. “Look, I know it's my fault, and I understand why Mydeimos doesn't want to see me, talk to me, or perceive me even in the slightest. So just let me stay in this cockpit out of his sight, okay?”

The cockpit door was slammed open, making two out of three people crowded into the cockpit jump in place.

“Mydei?!”

“Mydeimos?!”

Mydei was standing there, holding the cockpit door open, with the nastiest glare he had ever sent in someone’s way.

“You,” he growled toward Phainon, who was trembling like a leaf in his seat at the mere sight of him, “get over here.”

# Chapter 7: Phainon

“H–Huh?” Phainon could barely manage an actual sound out of his mouth.

“Get–over–here.”

Phainon stood straight up as if possessed, rigidly dodging Empousa to stand right by Mydei’s side. What else was he supposed to do? Mydei was technically his boss.

“Mydei?” Empousa hesitantly reached a hand out. “What are you doing here?”

Phainon was wondering the same damn thing! Why was the rockstar up here in the cockpit?!

“What else would I be doing here?” Mydei impatiently snapped. “I'm taking this man with me, obviously.”

“But.. why?” Empousa furrowed her eyebrows. “Why did you come up here?”

“Do you think I'm stupid?” Mydei glared at the flight attendant. “Or did you think I didn't hear every word?

Phainon just wanted to collapse.

“Wha–*What?!”* Both Phainon and Empousa screeched in the cockpit, and Herklas had to bring a hand up to his ear as he winced in pain.

“What do you mean you heard every word?!” Empousa cried. “Were you up here the whole time?! I just saw you in your room!”

“Your voices were being projected over the intercom.” Mydei furrowed his eyebrows. “You didn't realize?”

Empousa's eyes widened, and Phainon's jaw went slack. What was he talking about? Phainon wasn't holding the call button down. If both Empousa and Phainon were lost, there was only one other person with them in the cockpit who could've been holding the button down. Eyes widening in horror, he whipped his head toward Herklas, who was leisurely leaning his chin in the palm of his hand, watching the dramatic scene in front of him unfold.

“Herklas?!”

The co-pilot languidly shrugged. “Yes?”

Was Herklas just broadcasting their entire conversation the whole time?! Since when did he push the button, and for how long?! How much had Mydei heard of their conversation?! And why was Herklas even doing such a thing?! Sure, he met the guy about twenty minutes ago and probably spoke less than ten lines of dialogue with him that weren't shown in this story because the last chapter was in Mydei’s point of view, but he didn't seem like the type of guy to project their private conversation to everyone on the plane!

Whipping his head back toward the glowering rockstar, Phainon attempted every possible method to try to soothe the man. “My–Mydeimos, it's really not what you think–”

“My room. *Now*.”

Phainon shut his mouth immediately and followed Mydei out of the cockpit as if he had his tail between his legs, leaving Herklas to deal with the responsibility of driving the plane for now. Empousa, with her mouth agape, could only watch Phainon hesitantly trail after the fuming rockstar, with the door to his room shutting with a loud *bang*, rattling the various items that Mydei had set up in his room, such as his cup of coffee, phone, and other random miscellaneous items.

Mydei sighed tiredly, running a hand through his golden hair that Phainon so clearly remembered being so soft to the touch. He, unfortunately, remembered everything about this man–how he felt, how he tasted, how he

acted, his facial expressions. Even though it had been so long ago, now that the rockstar was standing directly in front of him, it felt as if all his memories regarding this man returned to him all at once.

“Why are you calling me that?”

Phainon was jolted out of his thoughts upon hearing his beautifully smooth, deep voice. Yeah, Cipher's voice after thirty-three cocktails could *never* sound this good.

“Calling you what?”

“That name.” Mydei shapely pivoted on his feet, and Phainon almost hit the wall behind him to try and step out of his way. “I don't recall telling you that name.”

“Well… that's…” Phainon was too afraid to lock eyes with those glaringly golden ones. He just thought it was more professional, as a private pilot to his client, to call him by his given name. “Isn't that your name?”

“I didn't tell you that was my name,” Mydei retorted. “First of all, stop calling me that. It may be my full name, but I treat it as a stage name now. I don't like it when you call me that.”

“Yes, sir.”

“And look at me when you talk.”

“...Yes, sir.” Phainon slowly lifted his gaze from the floor, but Mydei's glare never ceased.

“Now, say it for me.”

“What?”

“My name.”

Phainon couldn't believe his face was heating up, even in this situation he was in. “...Mydei.”

Mydei laughed lightly; God, his smile looked so good on him. Phainon would do anything the man in front of him commanded him if he got to see that smile every time. “Good. Now tell me something.” Mydei crossed his arms, and Phainon was sad to see his smile disappear. “Did you even think about me at all?”

“Of course I did!” Phainon's eyes widened. Mydei just had *no* idea how often he thought about this rockstar standing in front of him. “I… I just really… didn't have any way to contact you.”

“Besides that number you lost.”

“Besides that number I lost.”

The rockstar ran another tired hand through his hair, exhaling deeply. “How the *fuck* did you lose my number? It better be a damn good reason.”

Grimacing, Phainon recalled the night that occurred many months ago. “To be completely honest, I don't know.”

He would've thought Mydei was going to throw a fit at that. How could he lose a celebrity’s number of all numbers? But the man continued to stay silent, so Phainon continued to explain.

“I left the club that night to carry my friend home, as you know. She's a really rowdy person, so she is extra… annoying when drunk. I was trying to carry her into the car, but she kept beating me up.”

Mydei coughed in an attempt to cover his laugh.

“Anyway,” Phainon continued, trying hard not to smile at the fact that Mydei found his unfortunate situation so amusing, “she kept punching and kicking me, but I finally managed to get her into the car. The next morning, I tried to text you to tell you everything, but I didn't have the napkin anymore.”

Mydei continued to stay silent at his explanation, but it seemed like he wanted to hear more of Phainon’s side of the story.

Obliging, Phainon attempted to recall the aftermath. “Because I couldn't really figure out how I could lose the napkin, I thought I was just so drunk I imagined you entirely. But when I–”

“You thought I was just an imagination?” Mydei raised an accusatory eyebrow.

“Well–That's–I–” Phainon just realized how bad that sounded. “You're… um… extremely… well… exactly…”

“Just spit it out.”

“You're exactly my dream man.” Phainon's face was bright red as he blurted out the first explanation he could think of. It was true, but he didn't want to word it so creepily to the object of his affection.

Mydei fell silent. Phainon didn't even want to look at the man anymore, and his eyes fell back to his black dress shoes. "So… um… I went to go ask my friend, Castorice, the one who found me with you, if she remembered you, and–”

“I'm your *dream man?”*

“Can we please forget about that?” Phainon's face was going to explode at how much he was overheating. He was wringing his fingers together and trying to focus on literally anything else except for the sheer embarrassment that was filling his entire being. Why did he have to word it like that? He could've said he was just so drunk he thought it was a dream, or that Mydei seemed too good to be true. But his *dream man?* Really?

The man in front of him scoffed. “So, you went to ask your friend if this *dream man* you met at the club the night before was real.”

Phainon rigidly nodded. Mydei was never going to let him live that down. “She said she remembered you and even remembered that you wrote my number down. We tried to find it, and it was then that my other friend said that Cipher–*err*, my drunk friend–probably knocked it out of my pocket when I was trying to throw her… uh… *put* her into the car.” He sighed

exasperatedly at the recalled memory. He still couldn't believe that it even happened to him. What a stroke of bad luck.

“So my friend had the suggestion to look you up online, since I remembered your name,” Phainon continued the story. “He thought, maybe I could just message you online or something. Except… we… “

“Ended up finding out I was a celebrity?”

“Ended up finding out you were a celebrity.” Phainon's shoulders dropped, another sigh escaping him. “I… went back to the club. Every week, hoping that you would come back. One of the bartenders said you used to go there a lot, so I was just hoping you would be there. But, after a few months, I stopped–”

“Wait, you were visiting that club for me for *months?”*

Phainon jumped, and he felt the back of his foot hitting the door behind him. Shit, was that weird? Was that crazy stalker level? Did he say *months?*

“Not–Not *months*.” Phainon swore he could feel nervous sweat running down his back. “It was… It was just like... A couple of weeks?”

“How many weeks?”

“Um…” Phainon furrowed his eyebrows. He bought an Old Fashioned almost every time he went, so he could probably just check his credit card statement to see how many times he bought a drink there. To be honest, though, he didn't want to see how much money he spent waiting for someone to mock him again for his drink order. “Maybe… eight? Nine? It wasn't more than fifteen weeks or so?”

“So you visited the bar for about two or three months after we met.”

Phainon fell silent.

“Maybe… Maybe…” Phainon was laughing like a maniac. He was just an extreme bundle of nerves at this point. “Maybe it was only like two

weeks?” Phainon clearly remembered ordering way more than two Old Fashioneds.

Mydei narrowed his eyes. He definitely wasn't buying Phainon's obvious lie. “So was it two *weeks* or was it two *months?”*

“Anyway!” Phainon needed to move on from this conversation *right now*. “I never saw you again, and that was it. I was job hunting because I just graduated, and I got hired here. I found out you were working here when I looked up the company name after I got hired, but I didn't think we would… run into each other here. I'm sorry; if I knew, I would've asked to fly for someone else.”

“And why would you have asked for someone else?”

“Sorry?”

“If you knew the client was going to be me–” Mydei took a step forward, and Phainon tried to give him more space. But his back hit the wall, and he was suddenly pinned between the door and Mydei's piercing glare. “–you would have asked for someone else? Even after visiting the club, just to find me, for months?”

“Weeks!” Phainon squeaked. He was so dangerously close to the rockstar, and he wasn't sure if he could take much longer of this. If anything, he could twist the doorknob and bolt out of the room to escape back to the cockpit. Maybe Herklas will save him from the rockstar’s wrath; wait, no, he was in this situation in the first place *because* of his co-pilot. “It was just a few weeks!”

“Fine, whatever.” The golden-haired man rolled his eyes. “Let's just go with that stupid lie for now. You waited for me for… *weeks*, and now that you have an opportunity to see me again, you were just going to leave?”

“I…” It wasn't as if Phainon *wanted* to leave, but he knew Mydei wasn't going to be the least bit pleased to see him. And he was right, judging by his reaction when they saw each other for the first time in months before takeoff. Although he did resolve to beg for Mydei to listen to his story at

least once if he happened to run into him at headquarters, he didn't want to *work* for the guy in case Mydei really did want to kill him.

“Answer me,” Mydei growled. “Were you, or were you not, going to leave if you saw my name in your contract?”

“I… was.” Phainon really felt like he was being punched in the gut at his admittance. His heart twisted in his chest at his own words, but he continued despite how hard it became to breathe. “I… definitely… wanted to see you at least once, just so that I could explain my side of the story to you. And, I actually told myself I would knock on your hotel room later tonight and beg for you on my knees to listen to me, even if that was selfish of me.”

Phainon laughed weakly, swiping the bangs that were falling into his eyes at how much he kept glancing downward. “But, I knew you wouldn't appreciate it if I were here, so I just thought I would explain myself and then be on my way. I… I can definitely ask Krateros after the tour to switch me with someone else. But, for now, for the schedule, I'll have to stick around. I'm sorry, Mydei. Just, please bear with me for a little while longer, then you won't have to see me anymore, okay?”

The man in front of him clicked his tongue, but Phainon didn't know what expression he wore as he refused to look up at him. “You would voluntarily leave your dream man behind?”

Phainon laughed at the nickname that had somehow cemented its place. “I can't exactly do anything if my dream man hates me.”

“When did he say he hated you?”

“*Err.*.. just now? And before takeoff?”

“When did he *specifically* say he hated you?”

Furrowing his eyebrows, Phainon gazed at the man to see if he was joking, but there stood an unreadable expression before him. “Well… you didn't *exactly* say it, but–”

“Then why do you think I hate you?” The man tilted his head to the side.

Was he joking? Or, maybe this was a trick question?

“Well, I mean…” Phainon frowned. “Just… the way you've been treating me, I guess. You don't seem the least bit pleased to see me.”

“I'm not.”

Phainon flinched, but another weak chuckle left his throat. That was the typical response after all.

“Exactly.” Phainon offered the man the best smile that he could muster, but the rockstar didn't react in the slightest. “So, um… are we done here? I should probably get back to Herklas so he doesn't have to manage the plane for too long by himself.” Without turning around, Phainon found the doorknob a little to his side. “It was really nice to see you, Mydei. Even if you don't think the same, I…” Phainon mentally shook his head. He should just shut up now. Why was he trying to linger in front of a man who hated the mere sight of him? Phainon accomplished what he wanted to do with the rockstar, so it was time to go, whether he liked it or not. “Yeah, it was nice to see you. I can talk to Krateros later. Goodb–”

A hand slammed against the door before Phainon could even open it, and Phainon jumped back, equally slamming his back against the closed door. The rockstar in front of him was *glowering*, and Phainon wasn't exactly sure what he had done wrong this time.

“M–Mydei?!” Phainon's voice was barely even above a whisper. Was there anything he could protect himself with before he got beaten up by a celebrity? The only thing that was within his line of reach was the guy’s coffee.

“You would *voluntarily* leave your dream man behind?” Mydei scoffed incredulously. “Where do you think you're going?”

“To… To the cockpit?”

“For what?”

“To… To do my job? That I'm being paid to do?”

“And you're going to leave me here?”

Phainon's eyes widened. “I… Well… I–”

“Your dream man is standing right in front of you before your very eyes, and you're going to leave?”

“...Yes?”

Mydei laughed, but it was more of a mocking laugh than an amused or entertained one. But his next words made Phainon's brain short-circuit and his heart drop, and he wasn't sure if he even heard the man correctly. Maybe his brain was in fight-or-flight mode, and it was doing everything it could to mentally save Phainon from shutting down entirely.

“Shut up and just kiss me.”

Phainon paused, his eyes as wide as saucers. There was no way he heard him correctly, right? There was genuinely, absolutely no way, right?
“Sorry?”

“Kiss me, HKS.”

“*Me?!*” What did that word mean? And, was he misunderstanding the rockstar, or why was he asking Phainon to kiss him? Kiss him where? He didn't actually mean on the mouth, right?

“Who else is standing in this room?”

Phainon actually took the time to scan the room behind Mydei's back. He just really wanted to make sure he wasn't making a fool of himself; what if there really was someone standing in this room with them? It wouldn't be the first time an outsider heard his private conversation in this exact plane today.

A laugh resounded in the room, but before Phainon could glance at the man once more, a fist had pulled him by his tie, and he stumbled forward, tripping over his own feet and barely catching himself with his hands flat against the divan. His eyes widened at the position he was in, hovering over the rockstar, with Mydei glaring up at him while sitting on the divan; somehow, Phainon had pushed him down while he was floundering about trying to save himself.

“I–I'm so sorry!” Phainon tried to stand back up to give the man some space, but Mydei's hand on his tie wouldn't budge.

“I can't believe you actually looked around the room when I asked.” Mydei laughed lowly, and Phainon’s face flushed red with every warm breath that brushed against his lips. When had they gotten so close? Why was Mydei's breath so hot? Why was he so good-looking? Fuck, was Phainon staring? He was definitely staring, right? Holy Hell, his eyes looked so good. Did he just redo the red dye at the ends of his hair for the tour? The color was so vibrant. It looked so good on him; the color suited him so well. Everything suited Mydei. Mydei was perfect. God, he was fucking gorgeous. Was Mydei blushing too, or was Phainon just seeing red? No, no, wait, stop, he needed to get out of here. This was dangerous. The alarm bells were blaring in his head. This room was too small, and there were two grown men being shoved into here. But Mydei just looked so fucking hot and pretty and perfect sitting on that divan just for him–no! No, it wasn't for him! It wasn't for him at all! Phainon, get out of there! Get out of there! Get out of–

A deep voice broke his panicking thoughts. “What a damn good boy.”

Lips crashed into each other in a completely tangled mess, with Phainon shoving the guy so hard that Mydei's back hit the cushions he was sitting on. Fingers rushed into Phainon's hair, tugging and grasping his roots. Phainon couldn't breathe. He couldn't even think either. The lips against his were so soft–that devious tongue that still tasted like sweet, sweet pomegranate. The moans that filled his ears and the pants that filled his lungs. Fuck, everything about Mydei felt *so good*. Mydei just felt *so good* against him–felt so good against his body. His body just belonged there, sliding and thrusting against Phainon's, and Phainon refused to believe his body belonged anywhere else except for right below Phainon's.

His wandering hands that travelled through Phainon's hair, his neck, his shoulders, his *everywhere*. Mydei needed more hands because his two hands weren't enough to satisfy how much Phainon had been *craving* his touch since all those months ago. Phainon was shoving his tongue inside, sliding against Mydei's perfectly white teeth and the roof of his mouth, feeling every inch and crevice there was to feel deep inside. Their noses were crushing into each other as they exchanged hot, desperate breaths, as they took turns sucking and slurping at each other's tongues. Teeth were clinking against each other, saliva dribbled from their mouths, clothes were being pulled, and Phainon had slotted himself in between open legs only God knows when. Their crotches slammed against each other when open legs had wrapped around Phainon's waist, pulling him closer, and the pain and pleasure that shot through his veins almost made him cum right into his pilot uniform.

A loud moan left Phainon's lips, and he pushed himself deeper, slamming Mydei into the bed and thrusting hard in search of his heat. He felt his shirt being pulled in an attempt to tear it off of his body, and a button flew from Phainon's shirt, ricocheting off the airplane wall and hitting Mydei's abandoned coffee cup. The sound jolted Phainon out of his lust-filled stupor, and his eyes shot open at the realization of his situation. He tore his tongue away, pushing himself up and staring down at the hand that had clawed its way down his torso where a button used to exist.

“I'm…” Phainon was sure his hair was a giant rat's nest, and he was sure his lips didn't look any better. His clothes were all wrinkled in an unsalvageable disarray, with his tie in the midst of already slipping off his neck, and his shirt, which was barely hanging off his shoulders, was even missing a button now.

What did Phainon just do?!

Did he really just push his boss down to the fucking bed?! After they had established that the man hated his presence?! Why did Phainon kiss him?! Did that even count as a kiss?! He was practically eating the guy alive! Oh God, he was getting fired! Was his record going to be permanently marred with sexual assault and neglect of duties?! Right on his first day?!

Phainon shot his hands back to his side as if the man underneath him were on fire, and his hands floundered about in the air, unsure of whether he should pull Mydei up from the divan first, straighten his blonde hair, or close his legs. “Oh fuck, I… fuck, Mydei, I–”

“Why did you get up?” Mydei’s throat bobbed, and holy shit, his voice was so deep and raspy. His words went straight down Phainon's body toward the warmth that was already stirring in his slacks.

“I… I'm… I… I should be heading back.” Phainon's bruised lips were flapping like a fish out of water. How the Hell was he supposed to save himself in this situation? *While* Mydei's legs were still tightly wrapped around his waist?

A fist pulled him back down, and Phainon barely slammed his hands against the cushions once more to catch himself. But his breath got lodged in his throat when he saw golden eyes staring directly from below him.

“You *really* thought I was going to let you go back to the cockpit?” Mydei sneered. “With *this?*”

A hard thrust against Phainon's hips, and a gasp slipped out of Phainon. He threw his head forward, biting his bottom lip to stop any more weird noses from escaping, but his face had landed right into the crook of Mydei's neck. His trembling fists were clenched so tightly next to Mydei's head that his knuckles were turning white, and his fingernails were digging into the palm of his hands. His tensed shoulders were quivering from trying to stop himself from exploding in his pants, and he could feel his dress shirt slipping down his back, with the cool air conditioning that circulated in the plane brushing against his hot skin. His tie was probably already on the floor.

“You were really going to go back and show Herklas all of this?” A deep, husky laugh vibrated next to Phainon's ear, and Phainon's stomach clenched in ecstasy. “You seriously thought I would let you do that? That's sexual harassment, you know.”

Then, what the *fuck* would you count this position he was in with his own boss?! He had his boss pinned to the bed!

“I… I was…” Phainon's lips were shaking against Mydei's skin, his face still buried into his neck. Holy fuck, Mydei smelled *so good*. “I was just… gonna use the restroom.”

Legs tightened around his waist once more, and Phainon had to stifle another moan when their clothed dicks pressed more deeply against each other. Phainon couldn't take it anymore; if Mydei so much as breathed too deeply, Phainon was going to cum for sure.

“The bathroom is right behind me, Phainon. You think I would let you walk away from me to get yourself off?”

“Um… Yes?”

“Take off your shirt.”

Phainon pushed himself off of Mydei, but before he could get very far, strong arms wrapped around his shoulders and pulled him down once more.

“*Take it off*.” Mydei's glowing golden eyes bore straight into Phainon's being, and it whisked all the breath away from his lungs.

Before he could do anything, two hands had torn his shirt down his arms, discarding it somewhere onto the floor. The cold air sent goosebumps along Phainon's arms, but it did little to cool Phainon's burning face.

“That wasn't so hard, was it?” Gentle fingers swiped the bangs from Phainon's eyes, and it was then that Phainon could truly take in Mydei's appearance. His hair was equally just as much of a mess as Phainon's, with his golden bangs tangled this way and that and sticking to his forehead. His shirt rode halfway up his torso. His lips were red and bruised, with a track of saliva that had dried down his chin. Phainon couldn't stop his eyes from gluing themselves to Mydei's sculpted abdomen that was peeking out from underneath his shirt.

He unconsciously gulped at the delicious meal being served in front of him. How was he supposed to deny such a delectable sight?

A scoff came from the man below him, interrupting his thoughts. “You seem to be enjoying the view, or am I wrong?”

Phainon flinched as his blush crept down his neck. He was staring so blatantly at the man below him, and Phainon wouldn't have been surprised if he were drooling. “Sorry! Oh fuck, I'm so sorry!” He tried to push himself up once more, but the arms around his neck held him back.

“Phainon,” the beautiful, gorgeous, perfect, lovely, ethereal man underneath him breathed out, “if this were still the club–if we had more time, what would you do to me?”

“What… I would do to you?”

Mydei hummed. “Do you remember the position we were in?”

A loud gulp echoed in Phainon's ears. Of course, he remembered; he remembered so clearly that he had touched himself to that same scene so many times over: Him pinning Mydei to the wall, sliding his knee all over Mydei's clothed erection, Mydei moaning against his lips and grinding himself against Phainon’s thigh. Phainon could tell even back then how close the man was to cumming in his pants, and he wanted so badly to rip the pants from his legs and slurp up everything that man released from his tip. Phainon wanted to taste him, feel him, smell him, fill him up entirely with his–

“I was going to ask you to come home with me,” Phainon was panting heavily just from his own imagination. It was taking every fiber of his being not to tear Mydei's clothes off his body right at that moment, and his dick strained in his pants at the memory.

The man underneath him chuckled. “Funny. I was going to ask you to come home with me too.”

Phainon wasn't sure if he leaned down or if Mydei had pulled him down, but what mattered the most was that their lips were connected again, sucking and biting at each other's lips, snaking inside for the other's tongue. Phainon tugged at Mydei's bottom lip to rub his tongue right underneath his, and Mydei's body trembled in Phainon's arms as moans spewed from his parted, drooling lips. He had begun dragging his hips against Mydei's once more, feeling the zippers of their pants clashing against each other, pressing against both of their hard, clothed dicks that were pulsing to be freed.

Mydei was bouncing up and down in the divan with every harsh thrust, clawing at Phainon's naked back and leaving red marks that matched his tattoos. A hand reached down, tugging at the waistband of Phainon's slacks, and it was then that he felt the front of his pants completely stained with his own precum. Ignoring the cooling stain, Phainon rushed his hands to Mydei's side, grasping and groping at his hot skin and pushing his shirt up to reveal more of his sculpted muscles, all the while fighting against Mydei's vicious tongue and teeth.

He couldn't breathe, and his chest was desperately panting for breath against Mydei's lips as he rolled two nipples between his thumbs. The man underneath him jolted, arching his back as Phainon continued to grind against his crotch.

“*Mmph!* Phainon, right there!” Mydei's head was thrown back as he grabbed Phainon's wrists, moving Phainon's hands against his chest in circles that rolled his hard buds between Phainon's fingers. Phainon practically salivated, pushing his hips upwards and latching his lips to Mydei's exposed neck, biting and sucking and lapping at the unmarred skin while twisting and pinching his hardened nipples. His saliva was staining the collar of Mydei's shirt the more he ventured lower, and he clicked his tongue at the disturbance.

Releasing Mydei’s chest, Phainon impatiently tugged at Mydei's shirt, who understood the message and threw his shirt somewhere into the room. They latched onto each other once more, teeth hitting each other and tongues lapping against their lips as if they were dogs in heat, with Mydei pulling

Phainon to join him on the bed. Phainon happily obliged, sliding in between Mydei's legs once more without once parting from his lips.

A rough shove almost made Phainon fly backwards, but a weight settled on top of Phainon's lap along with the sound of zippers being pulled down.

“Shit,” Mydei cursed. One hand was grasping Phainon's shoulder, but the other one was behind him, out of Phainon's line of sight.

It was then that Phainon realized: he didn't actually bring a condom. Or any sort of protection, really, because *he was at fucking work right now and didn't think he would ever need one while on the job.*

“I could… uh… I could suck you off?” Phainon suggested, but the nastiest glare shot in Phainon's direction.

“What are you talking about?” Mydei snapped. “You're not leaving this room until you rail the fuck out of me.”

Phainon swallowed dryly. Mydei was so damn hot when he was angry.

“Then… Well… I didn't bring a condom or anything…” Phainon sheepishly admitted, but Mydei didn't seem the least bit concerned about that.

“You think I give a shit?” Mydei clicked his tongue. “Just go raw.”

“*What?!”* Phainon practically screamed. “But… I…” How was Phainon supposed to explain this was his first time having sex in his life?

“Are you infected?”

“No...”

“Then I don't see the problem.”

Phainon's hands continued to flounder in the air. “I… But I… What if I… inside?”

The man sitting in his lap raised an eyebrow. “Why do you think I don't want you to cum inside? How long do you think I've been waiting for your cum to fill my hole?”

Phainon's face burned red. What was with his lewd way of speaking?!

“Then… Then why were you cursing before?” Phainon furrowed his eyebrows. If it wasn't due to the lack of a condom, then what was he thinking about?

Mydei sighed exasperatedly. “I haven't been stretched out. It's… been a while since I've been busy with work. Give me a second.”

The hand that Phainon couldn't see before finally resurfaced into Phainon's view, but it wasn't for very long before they slipped right past Mydei’s lips.

What… was he doing?

Phainon had to admit: He had no sexual knowledge in the slightest. Everything he somewhat learned was from movies, which was a terrible place to learn. And there was barely any media that covered gay relationships in the first place, so Phainon was pretty much lost in whatever Mydei was doing.

The man had his face scrunched as he sucked the fingers in his mouth. Phainon's body was rigid, his eyes glued to watching Mydei's digits get coated in a thick slick of saliva, and his fingers dug into Mydei's hips the longer he watched his tongue weaving in and out between his fingers. It was then that his eyes shot open, making Phainon jump.

Golden eyes narrowed at him as he released his drenched fingers with a *pop*. “Come here.”

Phainon blinked at him blankly. Where else could he possibly go? Wasn't Mydei sitting in his lap in the first place?

The man rolled his eyes at seeing Phainon unmoving, and he removed his hand from Phainon's shoulder to grasp one of Phainon's hands that was

digging into his hip. Phainon's wrist sat limply in Mydei's grasp, but his eyes almost popped out of his skull when a warm breath circulated his fingers before being enclosed in a moist warmth.

Phainon's body was frozen solid, feeling the tongue that he had just been sucking begin to lap between his fingers, swirling along his knuckles, and sucking along his fingertips. Mydei released his wrist, returning his hand to Phainon's shoulder, and lifted himself off of Phainon's lap. A loud moan vibrated along Phainon's fingers, but Phainon hadn't even the slightest clue what he was doing. Was he just getting off to sucking Phainon's fingers? What was happening? His wide eyes searched around, grazing Mydei's body, and it was then that he saw Mydei's drenched fingers were in his pants. With the way the fabric was being pushed up and down at a specific spot, it didn't take a genius for Phainon to figure out the man was fingering himself.

Mydei's back arched from his own fingers, and Phainon had a better view of the curve of his behind being prodded by Mydei's digits. His ass was quivering in the air as his knees trembled to keep him up. Phainon unconsciously licked his lips at the sight, his own dick straining in his unzipped pants. Was it wrong for him to pull Mydei's pants down just a little? Just to watch Mydei fingering himself?

He gulped at the tempting idea, his eyes glued to the fabric that kept being pushed up and down from Mydei's thrusting fingers as his delectable moans, muffled by Phainon's own fingers, filled the air. He was bobbing his head up and down his knuckles, and Phainon couldn't help but imagine his fingers were something else that was much hotter and bigger filling his deep cavern. He took a mental note later to have Mydei give him a blowjob. Mydei would look absolutely gorgeous with his face covered in Phainon's cum, but that was a thought for another time.

Phainon reached his unused hand out, and with trembling fingers, he hooked them into the waistband of Mydei's pants and underwear, pulling them down and watching the red lines of his tattoos become exposed to the cold air. His throat bobbed at seeing Mydei's naked, shaking behind, and he had a much better view of Mydei’s fingers that disappeared and reappeared over and over inside of him. The revealed sounds that came from his

entrance resounded off the walls of the room, and his ears burned at the squelching noises that joined Mydei's muffled moans.

A pressure pushed against Phainon's shoulders as Mydei released Phainon's fingers. Three of Phainon's digits glistened from his saliva, but Phainon didn't have much time to admire the beautiful sight. With a tug against his wrist, Phainon eventually followed where Mydei was taking him until it hit the fingers that were still submerged in his entrance.

Phainon's heart beat wildly in his chest, and he could feel the deepest parts of his stomach clenching in pleasure with every twitch of Mydei's hole that brushed against Phainon's fingertips. This… was where he was going to be?

“Inside,” Mydei panted, returning his hand back to Phainon's shoulder.

His eyes stared at the curve of Mydei's ass, but the fingers that were already filling his hole had no intention of leaving.

“At… At the same time?”

Mydei hummed. “You're big, so my fingers won't be enough.”

Okay, Phainon figured out that Mydei was trying to stretch himself to accommodate Phainon's size, but he wasn't *that* big to warrant so many fingers inside! He was sure just two fingers were fine, but the guy already had three in there!

“Um… Are you sure? I'm really not that big,” Phainon stammered. “I really think two fingers is just fine–”

“Shove your fingers inside, Phainon,” Mydei harshly cut him off. “I will go insane if you make me wait any longer.” The man paused suddenly, furrowing his eyebrows. “Phainon, you're a lot bigger than two.”

“You've never even seen it before!”

“I felt enough of it to know you would kill me if I only stretched myself out with two fingers.”

“Okay, but *six* fingers?!”

“Just put them inside.”

With the rest of his arguments dying in his throat and with his heart thrumming in his chest, Phainon grazed his fingertips along the filled entrance. It really didn't seem like there was any more room for him to fit, yet the hole underneath his touch pulsed as if trying to suck him in. Phainon's breath hitched, feeling the filled entrance twitching against him. Does he just… push them in? He didn't want to hurt Mydei. Maybe he should just go one by one?

Hesitantly, he pushed against the hole, and his breath stopped in his chest when he felt the ring of muscle part to swallow up one of his digits. It was warm and tight inside, with muscles pulsing around his finger as if he could feel Mydei's heartbeat from all the way down here. Mydei's fingers that were already inside wrapped around Phainon's single digit.

“Another one,” Mydei gasped. “And you're going too slow.”

Phainon was flabbergasted. He wanted him to go *faster?!* Was that even safe?!

Struggling to take a deep breath and fighting against his rattling ribcage from his pounding heart, he obliged to Mydei's request and shoved the rest of his two fingers inside. But Mydei slammed his forehead against Phainon's shoulder, with his other hand clawing at Phainon's other shoulder.

“*Fuck!* Fuck–wait, I meant to put your fingers in faster, not to put them all in at once!”

Oh shoot, did Phainon mess up already?

“Sorry! Wait, I'll take them out.”

“Don't you fucking–*AHHH!”*

Mydei screamed at the top of his lungs when Phainon tore his fingers out, and he felt his shoulder being ripped to shreds as the body that hovered over

him jolted and trembled. Moans, screams, and cries cut through the air as Mydei's hips shook and convulsed uncontrollably, his back arching so sharply Phainon didn't know if that was good for him.

The screams finally silenced, with the man panting heavily into Phainon's shoulder and sweat dripping down his body as he collapsed against Phainon, his fingers still deep inside his entrance. Now that Mydei was lying down, Phainon could see a clear view of his filled entrance that was fluttering wildly around his three digits.

Mydei's breath and his shoulders were shaking as he pushed himself off of Phainon, and his face was bright red as he gasped for breath. His red, bruised lips were quivering, and his golden bangs were sticking to the sweat that ran down his forehead.

“Have you ever fingered a man before?” Mydei was swallowing in between deep breaths in an attempt to moisten his hoarse, scratchy throat. “Why… Why would you do that?”

Phainon's eyes trailed down Mydei's beautifully glowing features, lowering down until he could see the dick that Phainon had unveiled from trying to get a good look at Mydei fingering his own ass. With wide eyes, Phainon saw the streams of cum that littered their bare abdomens.

“You… came from that?”

“Who wouldn't?!”

Phainon coughed, trying to hold down his blush but to no avail, and Mydei clicked his tongue.

“Don't look so proud of yourself.”

Phainon couldn't help but laugh. “I just really thought I hurt you, so I'm just relieved.” He set his hands upon Mydei's thighs and began massaging into his skin. “I can clean up for you if you just want to lay down.”

“What are you talking about?”

“What do you mean?”

Both men were furrowing their eyebrows at each other. Mydei came, right? Didn't that mean they were done?

“You're *leaving?”*

Phainon wasn't sure why Mydei looked so offended. Was it because he didn't get off yet? He really didn't mind so long as Mydei was satisfied. Phainon could just get off in the restroom or something.

“Well, you came, right?” Phainon searched Mydei's face as if he could find the answers written on his forehead. “That means we're done?”

Mydei squinted at him. “Don't you remember my previous words? You're not leaving this room until you rail me.” He pushed himself off of Phainon, and he jolted when he felt a hand grasp his length tightly in his pants. “Still hard. Good.”

Phainon swore he was seeing red when Mydei pulled his pants down to his ankles in one sweeping motion, exposing him to the open air. His dick was standing tall and proud, swaying and pulsing in the air-conditioned room, and Phainon almost wanted to cover his eyes at his own unashamed dick that didn't wilt in the slightest at being in full view.

“What are you embarrassed about? What happened to that man who shoved me down earlier?” A chuckle sounded from above him, and Mydei had slotted himself back into Phainon's lap, gasping at the feeling of his bare cheeks brushing against Phainon's dick. Mydei had discarded the rest of his clothing and was now sitting completely naked in Phainon's lap, with his dick brushing against their abdomens.

Phainon couldn't help but gulp once again, his eyes trailing all over Mydei's naked body. He had love marks riddling his neck underneath his golden hair, and his chest was bruised from how much Phainon had played with his nipples earlier. He felt his dick twitch against Mydei's ample behind; he just wanted to cover Mydei’s entire body with his marks.

But those thoughts were quickly forgotten when a hand grasped Phainon's hard length, and it wasn't long until he felt that same hot ring of muscle enveloping his tip. With wide eyes, Phainon trembled, the pit of his stomach flaring in heat as the head of his dick was slowly submerged in that tight, melting warmth, and his hands shot to Mydei's thighs once more, clawing and leaving scratch marks all over his skin. He couldn't stop his hips from thrusting right into that delicious cavern as he sprayed his cum right inside of Mydei, the pleasure overtaking all five of his senses. His jaw was agape as he barely registered himself moaning Mydei's name, squeezing his eyes shut, and feeling his hips convulsing against Mydei's behind that was now flush against his lap. He filled Mydei to the brim with his cum as he threw his head back, filling the air with his wanton moans and whimpers from the hole that continually clenched around his pulsing length. He was gasping for breath, his vision turning white, and his chest hurt from how much he was breathing but not breathing all at the same time from cumming the hardest he ever had in his life.

Before he was even done spilling his seed inside of Mydei, a laugh filled the air above Phainon's whines.

“You came from that?” Mydei tauntingly repeated Phainon's previous words. He lifted himself up before dropping down onto Phainon's lap, and Phainon's back arched at being enveloped in his hot cavern once more, digging his fingernails into Mydei's thighs.

“Fuck! Mydei–wait–I'm still cumming–*OHH!*”

With two arms wrapped around Phainon's shoulders, the man in his lap began bouncing up and down, shaking the divan underneath them from their activities. Phainon's dick felt like it was on fire from the overstimulation of just cumming, but Mydei had no intention of slowing down in the slightest. The sound of their slapping skin echoed through Phainon's brain, and he had to clench his teeth together to focus on not cumming immediately again inside of Mydei's warmth.

What was this feeling?!

His entire length felt like it was melting in pleasure. His toes were clenching in his dress shoes, and his fingers were going numb from how hard he was digging into Mydei's thighs that were jiggling in his grasp from bouncing on his cock. He was flexing his abdomen to stave away yet another orgasm, but his dick was absolutely greedy and wanted more of Mydei's warmth. His hips were automatically thrusting upwards, and he couldn't stop himself or slow himself down from tasting more of Mydei's hole.

“Mydei, Mydei!” Phainon was moaning uncontrollably, filling the air with noises that Phainon had never heard himself make before. “*Mmm! Ahh!* I can't stop! I can't stop, Mydei!”

His hands had moved to tightly grasp Mydei's waist, pulling the man down onto his dick to venture even more deeply inside. A loud moan slipped past Mydei's beautiful lips as he threw his head back, arching his back and pushing himself up to steady himself on Phainon's shoulders.

“*Ohh! Ohh*, Phainon! Just like that! Right there!”

Fuck, Mydei's moans were *beautiful*. It made Phainon want to hear even more of his voice until the entire cabin was filled with it. He wanted to hear more of their slapping skin, of the cushions that were falling off the divan, of the squelching that was coming from their connection, and of Mydei's moans and gasps that sliced through the air. Phainon continued drilling himself inside of his warmth, thrusting and pummeling as if there was no tomorrow. It was wet and sticky inside due to Phainon's cum, and it was so easy to slide himself in and out of his hole. Mydei was stretched so beautifully around Phainon's dick, and he couldn't get enough of how much his walls were pulsing and clenching around Phainon.

He couldn't get enough of this feeling; he could *never* get over this feeling. Mydei's hole was twitching against Phainon's cock, and Phainon could feel himself quivering inside of him. Sweat was dripping down both of their bodies, making their skin stick together and the slapping of their skinship even louder. Was it even possible to get Phainon even deeper inside Mydei's hole? He wanted to reach so far inside that even Mydei himself had never touched himself there.

Tucking his hands underneath Mydei's thighs, he stood up, carrying the man and slamming his back against the door. Mydei's eyes flew open, and he gasped, moaning at the feeling of Phainon piercing the deepest parts of him. Phainon moaned equally as loud at feeling Mydei tighten around his length, and he leaned the man against the door. Mydei's legs were spread wide open around Phainon, bouncing in the air every time Phainon drove himself inside.

“Put–Put me down–*AHH!*” Mydei threw his head back with another sharp thrust, banging his head against the door and feeling it rattle on its hinges every time Phainon pummeled into him.

“Mydei, this feels so good. Fuck, you feel so good.” Phainon was moaning into Mydei's shoulders, driving his dick at an uncontrollable speed into Mydei's clenching hole. The friction was just so addicting. The heat was just so addicting. The tightness was just so addicting. And Mydei's taste and scent and touch were just *so* addicting. “Mydei, please let me fuck you forever. Please let me stay inside you. I'll be good, okay? I'll be a good boy, Mydei.”

“Fuck! FUCK! Phainon, put me down!” Mydei was whining, clawing at Phainon's back, and feeling himself sliding against the door behind him. But all his words were lost in Phainon's ears, as he was too far gone with the pleasure that was shooting through each and every one of his limbs. Phainon swore he was cumming, his knees shaking as his hips convulsed, but his hips wouldn't stop thrusting into Mydei's drenched hole. He latched his lips into the crook of Mydei's neck, sucking and biting at his skin and tasting the sweat that dripped down his body.

The position was making Mydei sink even deeper onto Phainon's length, and the guy was fucking huge. Tears were sliding down Mydei's cheeks, and the position made Phainon's cum leak out of his hole that was being spread wide as he was fucked deeply by his pilot. He really thought he was only two fingers wide? His girth was already knocking the breath out of Mydei's lungs, and he was so big that Phainon didn't even have to aim for his prostate. Mydei was still struggling for breath, being squeezed between Phainon and the shaking door, but his hole was fluttering in pleasure, loving

every single thrust of Phainon's outrageously large cock. Seriously, *two* fingers? Was the guy blind?

Phainon felt Mydei pushing against his shoulders, but he pushed right back, pressing Mydei against the door and sinking his length inside of Mydei over and over again. His leg felt cold, and he realized that his cum was dripping down his thighs from Mydei's entrance. Phainon frowned at the feeling of his own cum. Was he just not filling Mydei enough? Why was it coming out? Was it because they were standing that it was leaking out?

That wasn't good at all. He didn't want a single drop to leave Mydei's hole. With one last, hard thrust, Phainon stilled himself as deeply as he could, rooting himself inside to plug up his spilling cum, and Mydei screamed. He threw his head forward, muffling his moans and sobs into his arms that were tightly bound around Phainon's head. His spread legs trembled in the air, his toes clenching around nothing as cum splattered between their abdomens once more. Phainon's back was all scratched up by Mydei, and Phainon was loving every single dig of his fingernails into his skin. He moaned at the thought of Mydei marking him up, and he pressed a kiss to the man's shoulders as his body continued to jolt in Phainon’s arms.

Mydei's shoulders were trembling as Phainon spun them around, pressing Mydei’s back into the divan and pushing down on his ankles until his feet almost hit the divan. He saw the rockstar's face burn red at their position, with Mydei’s filled entrance completely exposed to the air, and he attempted to push Phainon away.

“Phainon, I just came.” Mydei’s voice was hoarse from all the moaning that was lovingly filling Phainon's ears. Although that did make Phainon slightly pause, all the blood in Phainon's body was rushing to his cock, and his dick was too busy being clenched and massaged by Mydei’s pulsing insides. He pulled his dick out, leaving only the tip inside, before slamming his hips back into Mydei. The man underneath him shook, whining as Phainon continued snapping his hips against Mydei’s behind, slowly increasing the speed until he was back at that same breaking pace.

Mydei was being folded like a pretzel under Phainon's uncontrollable pace, their skin slapping against each other and echoing in the room once more.

Phainon had his hands grasping so tightly around Mydei's ankles that he was sure he was going to leave bruises, but Phainon couldn't think about anything else except for relishing in Mydei’s wet and squelching hole. This was dangerous; Phainon actually couldn't stop his hips from fucking into Mydei, and it felt like his entire body was a slave to the electricity rushing through his veins.

He slammed his hips, feeling his stomach tighten as he spilled his cum inside for a third time, and Phainon bit his bottom lip as a loud moan pierced the air. He watched Mydei's face twist in utter ecstasy at being filled to the brim, with his pulsing dick spraying all over himself. Phainon couldn't believe it; did he cum from being pumped with Phainon's cum?

“Phainon, wait.” Mydei shot his hands up, and his fingertips faintly brushed against Phainon’s abdomen. “This… This is too much. I'm going to die, Phainon.”

Phainon stared down at the rockstar, whose golden hair was tangled in a mess, with bangs sitting flush against his burning face and the dried tear tracks that trailed down his cheeks. Sweat lined each and every one of his muscles, and bite marks and bruises were running along his neck and shoulders. Phainon felt his dick twitch back to life inside of Mydei the longer his eyes trailed down his perfect, naked body that was covered in his own cum. Cum that was only there because he felt pleasure from Phainon's cock.

“Mydei,” Phainon whispered, bending down and pressing a gentle kiss upon the man's lips. He brushed his lips against Mydei's, pouting up at golden eyes that were so dilated they were almost black. “I'll be a good boy, so please, one more time?”

Mydei grimaced with a sharp gasp at feeling the dick inside of him stir back to life. Again?! How many times has Phainon cum inside already?! He had a concert tomorrow!

He threw his head back with another long moan, and he could barely see the blush behind silver bangs and the soft smile that was completely opposite to

the harsh thrusts that were piercing his insides, pressing right up against his overstimulated prostate.

“Please, Mydei, please?” Despite his words and despite Mydei's lack of answer, Phainon increased his pace, their skin sticking to each other from all the cum and sweat that mixed between them. Two hands grasped Mydei's waist, sinking him deeper onto Phainon's cock that was already hard again, and Mydei began bouncing in the bed once more. “Please? I'll be gentle, Mydei. Just one more time, okay? I'll be a good boy, so just one more time, please? You just feel so good around me, Mydei.”

Phainon and Mydei went for another three rounds.

# Chapter 8: Phainon

“You're actually a demon.”

Phainon couldn't help but laugh at his comment, wiping a damp towel along Mydei's legs. Mydei finally snapped Phainon out of his lust-filled craze after their sixth round by reminding him that the rockstar needed to perform on stage the next day. Phainon, in a panic, pulled himself right back out of Mydei during their sixth round. But Mydei wasn't going to stop until they both came one last time. Now here they were, with Mydei lying in the divan getting wiped down, and Phainon had already dressed himself back into his pilot uniform, no matter how disheveled Mydei had made it become. The man said he would take a shower by himself later, but Phainon insisted he at least do this. He didn't want to return to the cockpit and leave Mydei covered in a mixture of cum, tears, and sweat.

“Your past partners must've been drained.” Mydei's head was thrown back in the cushions, his vision phasing in and out. “How in Hell am I supposed to perform tomorrow? I don't even think I can walk to my own hotel room.”

“I can carry you.”

“Do not carry me.”

Phainon laughed once more, moving onto his other leg. Phainon had no idea what he was going to be like in bed either, so this was surely a surprise for both of them. He didn't realize it would make him lose all inhibitions and restraint, and he was a little afraid that he was too rough on Mydei for their first time together. But, he still wasn't really sure what "normal" sex was. Was that something he should tell Mydei, though? He wasn't sure if that would freak the man out. Maybe he would tell him after his tour, when he had less to worry about?

Wait, were they even actually *together?*

They technically only just slept together. He wasn't even sure if Mydei accepted Phainon's apology for losing his number, as he didn't exactly outright say it. Phainon's hand froze at Mydei’s ankles, and true to his previous thoughts, they were developing bruises from how tightly Phainon had held them.

Did Phainon just have a one-night stand?!

What if Mydei was still mad at him? What if Mydei just got satisfied with Phainon right now and then continued being angry with him tomorrow and for the rest of the tour? Was Mydei going to tell his company the moment they returned that Phainon basically jumped him like an animal in heat?

“HKS.”

Phainon jumped at the sound of his voice and continued swiping the damp towel along Mydei’s legs once more to lightly clean him as if he were not just panicking in his thoughts. “What does that word mean? You called me that earlier.”

“Hyena.”

Yep, Phainon was finished.

That was basically all the confirmation he needed. His boss literally just called him an animal–twice, in fact, and right to his face! He couldn't even imagine what he would say to the higher-ups in the company when Phainon *wasn't* present! Phainon was doomed. He might as well start finding a new job when they land. At least he packed his laptop so he can actually job hunt again while flying around the country for the tour. He inwardly sighed at the idea of job hunting once more. It already took him a couple of months to land this job; who knew how many more months he would need to search for another job?

“...Can I say some final words before you fire me?”

“What the fuck are you talking about?”

Phainon was still swiping the damp towel along Mydei’s bare body, but now in a much more dejected manner. He had moved on from his legs and was now at his torso, which was where most of his body was riddled with cum. He should probably rinse this towel. “Well… I just jumped my boss…”

“Said boss basically pulled you down to bed with him.”

Phainon pouted, his gaze still fixed upon Mydei's abdomen. “Yeah, but said subordinate fucked him six times.”

Mydei groaned, relaxing his body into the bed. “Don't remind me. My back already hurts.”

Not only did Phainon neglect his pilot duties and jump his boss within an hour of his first assignment, but he also injured the guy, the guy who also happened to be a high-profile star within the company. Yeah, Phainon was finished. He was sure headquarters didn't need any more excuses to fire him. “So can I say some final words before you fire me?”

“I'm not firing you, Phainon.”

“*Really?!”* Phainon's head shot up from where he had been focusing on wiping cum off his abdomen.

“You seriously thought I was going to fire you?” Mydei squinted in his direction. “Contrary to what you would do, I'm not going to voluntarily leave my dream man.”

Phainon pouted once more. "That's unfair. I just thought you didn't like me.”

The man lying in bed laughed. “So, what do you think now?”

“Um…” Phainon broke out into a cold sweat, his hands stilling once more as his gaze sank back down. Oh no. What was the right answer? *Did* Mydei like him? Plenty of people slept together without *actually* liking each other, right? Was Mydei the type of guy to do that, though? Phainon didn't think

so, but he could also be totally, completely, and utterly wrong in that thinking. Wait.

“*Dream man?!”* Phainon's head shot up once more. “*Me?* You called *me* that?”

The rockstar rolled his eyes. “What a delayed reaction. Who else is in this room, HKS?”

Phainon actually had to resist the urge to check around the room again. “Just me.”

“That's right. So who is my dream man?”

“Just… me…”

Mydei chuckled. “That's a good boy.”

Phainon's ears burned red, but he continued focusing all of his attention on cleaning Mydei’s body as best as he could. He already grabbed another clean towel from the bathroom and had begun wiping down the rest of his torso. There was… too much to clean with just one towel unless he just wanted to keep pushing the cum and sweat around Mydei's body with a dirtied towel.

He couldn't believe Mydei was also calling Phainon his “dream man". It really felt like his ears weren't working today. Did they really feel about each other in the same way? It wasn't just a one-sided feeling? Mydei liked him? Was Mydei thinking of Phainon when they were apart too? How much did Mydei think of him? Every week? Every day? Every hour? Every second, even?

“So what were you doing at the club that day?” Mydei had already picked up his phone and was languidly scrolling through whatever he was looking at before dragging Phainon over to his room.

“I was celebrating graduating from pilot school.” Phainon smiled softly at the fond memory as he was ripped from his previously overly enthusiastic

thoughts. “My friends took me out to dinner and the club.”

Mydei hummed without tearing his eyes from his phone. “You have quite a lot of friends.”

Phainon nodded in agreement. “One of my closest friends was my next-door neighbor growing up, but she doesn't really live nearby anymore. So I don't really see her anymore. Most of my other friends I met when I was an undergrad–” Phainon paused as his brain processed Mydei’s words, his hands still holding the damp towel. “Wait, how do you know that?”

It seemed that the man underneath his hands grew rigid, and he roughly managed, “You just seem like the type of guy to have a lot of friends.”

“Really?” Phainon raised an eyebrow. He never really thought about that before.

“You're quite the… caring and friendly type of guy. I would be surprised if you didn't have a lot of friends.”

Phainon felt like Mydei was hiding something from him, but he couldn't deny that the compliment made his heart full. “Mydei, I love you too!” He jumped into Mydei’s arms with a grin, with the man grunting from the weight that was suddenly being pressed down onto him.

“How did that equate to me confessing my love to you?!” Mydei shouted, trying to tear himself away from Phainon's limbs.

“I love you, Mydei! I love you!”

He was still holding that towel as he tightly wrapped his arms around Mydei’s torso. Thankfully, he had already wiped off a majority of the cum and sweat that was on his body, so he had no qualms with sticking himself to Mydei like glue and burying his face into Mydei’s hair, chanting his love for the rockstar.

The man seemed to sigh in defeat, his body growing limp in Phainon's grasp. “You went from trying to leave me alone to confessing to me all in a

span of an hour.”

“I don't know what you're talking about,” Phainon adamantly denied, rubbing his nose along the shell of Mydei’s ear.

“You better not be seeing anyone else.”

“Only you, Mydei! Only you!”

A hand buried itself into Phainon's hair and began massaging his scalp. And so they lay together in the dirtied bed just like that, with Phainon grinning into Mydei’s ear, and Mydei running his fingers through Phainon's silver hair. But, although Phainon had adamantly confessed his love and didn't get rejected, he still wanted to hear it come straight from Mydei’s mouth too. Even if they just slept together, were cuddling together after sex, and were calling each other their “dream man”, Phainon still wanted to hear those exact words.

“Do you like me, Mydei?”

“What kind of question is that?”

“I want to hear it with my own ears.”

A silence pierced the air, but the hand in his hair never ceased its ministrations. “I like you, Phainon,” Mydei’s voice vibrated against Phainon's ear. “Didn't I call you my dream man already?”

Phainon blushed, his smile never ceasing. “I really like you too, Mydei.” It was then that an idea popped into his head. It was just the next step after confessing their feelings, right? “Are we allowed to date? Am I allowed to date a rockstar?”

“Why wouldn't you be able to?” Mydei furrowed his eyebrows at the question.

“I just didn't know if you had any sort of rules like that.” Phainon couldn't even begin to imagine how difficult it was having every single part of your life being scrutinized by millions of eyes.

Mydei scoffed. “I wouldn't have signed the contract with my current company otherwise if there was a clause like that.” He shifted in Phainon's arms, turning onto his side and burying Phainon's face into his chest. “If you don't call me your boyfriend, I *will* be pissed.”

“Yes, Mydei!” Phainon laughed. How many people were going to believe he was dating a rockstar? His childhood friend, Cyrene, was going to throw a fit. Even *he* still couldn't believe that this man, who was currently in his arms, was a well-renowned rockstar with millions of fans. No matter how many times he had watched his music videos and streamed his songs, Phainon still couldn't believe that Mydeimos was now his boyfriend.

“So why were you at the club that day?” Phainon asked, pushing his face into the soft skin of Mydei’s chest. Mydei’s earlier question to him only made Phainon all the more curious. “*You* were definitely alone that day. Why were you at the club by yourself?”

Since his face was buried into Mydei’s chest, he could feel a deep breath escape from his lungs. Phainon tried to glance upwards, but he couldn't really see from the angle he was at and how tightly Mydei was holding onto him.

“It's a long story.” Mydei’s voice vibrated against him. “How much do you know about Mydeimos?”

Phainon furrowed his eyebrows, leaning into Mydei’s embrace. “He's a world-renowned rockstar who plays the guitar. Leader of a band with a really good voice and a really good face.”

Mydei scoffed at the ending. “Have you been looking me up at all after we met?”

“Um…” Phainon hid his blush into Mydei’s chest, mumbling into his skin. “Maybe. But once I stopped going to the club, I stopped trying to look for you.”

The man in his arms hummed. “I went to the club that day to forget my name.”

Phainon instinctively tightened his arms around the man with a frown. Who would dare hurt his Mydeimos?

Mydei continued. “I had a falling out with my band.” His fingers sifted through silver hair. “We had a disagreement on the direction the band was going in, so I left.”

“So, this tour you're going on–”

"It's just for me.” Mydei let out another breath. “This is the tour for my solo debut.”

Phainon stayed silent as his story digested in his mind. It made sense why only Mydei was in this private jet and not the rest of the band. He didn't really question it much before, as most of his brain was too busy trying to deal with the fact that he was meeting Mydei again after so many months apart, and the other part of his brain was driving the plane. He had no idea Mydei was going through so much when he took a sip of his vodka pomegranate cocktail that night. Was Mydei using Phainon to forget his name too, like he wanted to do?

“Did you know your bandmates well?” Phainon asked another question. He didn't watch too many interviews of the whole band to really know, and many bands actually didn't get along with each other behind the cameras.

It was then that Mydei let out a shaky breath, and Phainon realized that it was a sensitive topic.

He quickly scrambled. “Mydei, you don't have to–”

“I knew them almost my whole life.” The hand in Phainon's hair stilled. “We made the band together and wrote songs together while we were still in school. We… didn't mean to become famous at all.”

Phainon couldn't even imagine the things Mydei had gone through. Banding together with his best friends, performing and writing songs just for fun, and ending up on a grand stage filled with millions of fans, only to leave those same people who saw everything right at your side for years. If

Phainon were Mydei, he also would've wanted to forget his own name just for one night.

“I'm sorry, Mydei.”

“Why are you apologizing?” Mydei chuckled lowly, and the hand in Phainon's hair began its ministrations.

“I just… can't imagine having to leave your friends.” Phainon’s eyes searched in front of him, but his face was still being squished into Mydei’s chest. “Do you still talk to them at all?”

“Not really,” Mydei admitted. “But I would like to think we are still on good terms. I definitely… don't talk to my ex-boyfriend anymore.”

Phainon's eyes shot wide open. His *what?!*

He swallowed thickly, trying hard to act nonchalantly, but he couldn't stop the feeling of his heart clenching in his chest. Phainon just really hoped his voice wasn't shaking when he hesitantly opened his mouth. “Who was your boyfriend in the band?”

“Hephaestion, the drummer. I think he deserves someone better than me who won't do whatever the Hell he wants now.”

Phainon's arms instinctively tightened around Mydei once again. “I don't know what you're talking about. You're perfect, Mydei.”

The man's chest rumbled in laughter, but now Phainon’s mind could only think of one thing.

Who was Hephaestion? Phainon wasn't really looking at anyone else in the band interviews except for Mydei. Did they break up because of the falling out with the band? Or was it something else entirely? Would they still be together if the band were together? How often did Mydei still think about that guy? Did he miss him? Were there things that still reminded him of his ex? Mydei still definitely thought about his band a lot, and it was clear that he missed them. Did that include his ex too?

Did Mydei go to the club to forget about him?

His heart dropped into his stomach at the thought. Was Phainon just a rebound? Mydei said he was going to ask Phainon to go home with him that day, right? Was it just to forget about this guy? How alike was Phainon to his ex? Did he resemble him at all? Did Mydei even see Phainon for Phainon, or was Mydei seeing someone else entirely?

“I should…” Phainon untangled his arms from the other man, who raised an eyebrow. “I should probably get back to the cockpit. Who knows how long I left Herklas out there?” He let out a laugh, running a hand through his hair. Did he sound natural at all? Was his voice shaking? Were his hands shaking? Phainon couldn't feel anything at all, but he just hoped that Mydei would let him go.

Mydei scoffed, a smile on his face. “Go. And give my apologies to Herklas for pulling you away for so long.”

With a nod, Phainon stumbled out of the room, closing the door behind him. He was sure Krateros was staring right through him, but Phainon couldn't lift his gaze off the floor.

*Who was Hephaestion?*

He darted back to the cockpit, slamming himself right back down into the chair and earning himself a raised eyebrow from the other pilot. Ignoring the inquisitive stare, Phainon whipped out his phone to pull up the fastest search engine he could get his hands on. But he didn't get very far, as his body was thrust forward when two hands slammed on the back of his seat.

“Phainon! You sure had a fun time in there. I'm assuming you guys made up? Or was that break-up sex I was hearing in there? You should've seen the look on Krateros’s face!”

Phainon didn't have the space in his mind to even feel embarrassed at all, and his silence left both the newly-entered flight attendant and the other pilot confused. They exchanged a glance with each other before Empousa turned back to Phainon.

“Hello, Phainon? Did you even hear me at all?”

“Hi, Empousa,” were the only words that came out of Phainon's mouth. His fingers were too busy typing the name “Hephaestion The Detachment” into the search bar.

“Hi, Phainon,” Empousa huffed. She crossed her arms impatiently at the man's lack of response. “What are you doing?”

“Sorry?” He could barely even hear what the woman was saying.

She frowned. “What–are–you–doing?”

Before Phainon could even respond, the phone was snatched right out of his hand. He instinctively shot his hand out to try and grab it, but Empousa had already settled by Herklas's side while he watched her scroll through Phainon's phone.

“Hephaestion?” Empousa squinted at the phone screen. “Why are you looking him up?”

Phainon, who still had his hand raised in the air from trying to reach his phone, froze in place. “I don't know what you're talking about.”

“Phainon, we are literally staring at your phone.”

A blush slowly crept onto his face. Wow, was Phainon really caught trying to look up his boyfriend's ex? He was caught before he could actually find anything!

He laughed awkwardly, snatching his raised hand back to his side. “I was just… uh… curious about his past bandmates… is all…”

“And you started with his ex?”

Phainon could not answer that question.

With a heavy sigh, Empousa tossed the phone back into Phainon's lap. “Was there something you wanted to know about him? Something you can't even

ask the man you just had screaming in the back?”

“Okay, can you not word it like that?!” Phainon's face was now fully a bright, crimson red, and Empousa doubled over in laughter, slapping Herklas on the way down as she attempted to grab something to keep her from falling to the floor. Which didn't work, by the way; the woman was already on her knees, clutching her stomach and wheezing for laughter.

“That's–That's the Phainon I know!” She managed words in between her full-on howling.

“Wait, did *everyone* hear us?” Phainon's gaze flitted between Herklas and Empousa, where one man silently stared right back at the sky ahead of them, and the other was still on her knees, wiping tears from her eyes.

Grasping for breath, Empousa shakily pushed herself from the floor using Herklas’s shoulder. “You… How big do you think this plane is? You can see the entirety of the plane just from standing in the middle.”

Phainon turned in his chair to face the sky, burying his burning face in his hands. “Okay, can we just pretend the last few minutes didn't exist?”

“You guys were going at it for way longer than a few minutes.”

“Can we forget the past hour then?!”

Empousa howled in laughter once more, slapping Herklas's shoulder as if he had just told the greatest joke her ears had ever heard, even though he hadn't opened his mouth once since Empousa had stepped into the cockpit.

“So.” Empousa loudly cleared her throat and started brushing her fingertips along the corners of her eyes, blinking the tears away. “Why are you looking up Hephaestion? Did Mydei say something about him?”

“He didn't really say anything.” Phainon's voice was muffled in his hands. “That's why I'm looking him up.”

“I'm sure Mydei would answer any questions you have about him.”

Phainon silently shook his head. What would that make Phainon if he straight-up asked Mydei questions about his past relationship? Jealous? Possessive? Phainon didn't want to mess up what he had with Mydei five minutes into their relationship.

A sigh came from the flight attendant. “I'll tell you right now; I'm positive Mydei likes you more than Hephaestion, if that's what you're concerned about.”

“You don't know that.”

“I do know that.”

“No, you don't.”

“I'm the flight attendant for their band too, and I can confidently say they have never had sex on the plane before.”

Phainon fell silent.

Empousa lightly punched Herklas's shoulder and hissed, “*Say something!*”

Herklas let out a deep breath, turning to Phainon, who still had his face buried in his hands. “What are you so concerned about?”

The question sank in Phainon's mind. What *was* he worried about? Was he worried about *everything* regarding Hephaestion and Mydei? Was it just killing him that he knew nothing about their past relationship? Or was it that Phainon wasn't sure if Hephaestion still lingered in his mind while he was with Phainon? They must've… been together a long time, right? Especially since Mydei said they had known each other since they were in school.

“Everything,” Phainon eventually mumbled.

“Let's start with something concrete.” Herklas shifted in his chair, relaxing his back into the seat and crossing his arms. “Ask a question.”

“How close were they?”

Empousa and Herklas fell silent.

“They–They're not close anymore!” Empousa started waving her arms in the air as she rushed to Phainon's side. “They don't talk anymore! Hephaestion told me himself!”

That still didn't really make Phainon feel much better.

“They were close back in the day,” Herklas admitted, and Empousa punched him in the shoulder once more.

*“Why would you say that?!”*

“You could tell just from looking at them. Anyone could tell those two were the closest out of everyone in the band,” Herklas continued, but Empousa looked ready to just choke the guy out. Swatting her feisty hands away, Herklas kept talking. “So it is also equally as obvious to see that Mydei doesn't think about him anymore.”

“How do you know that?” Phainon mumbled into his palms.

“Because Mydei isn't the type of person to linger on one person while having thoughts for another person.” Herklas was confident in his words. “If anything, Mydei would call you a dumbass for even having these sorts of thoughts.”

“Herklas!”

He ignored Empousa. “Mydei is the type of person to know what he wants, and he will do exactly that. If he still wanted Hephaestion or even thought about him at all, he wouldn't be with you.”

That last sentence really settled with Phainon. He was right; although there was more to Mydei that Phainon *didn't* know of, what he *did* know was that Mydei was a straightforward man who didn't overcomplicate himself or his feelings. If he liked one person, he was going to stay with that person, and if he needed to move on from one person, he would. He was just that sort of man who knew what he wanted, whether it came to himself or to the people

around him, and he was never one to second-guess or overthink. It was a trait that Phainon was envious of, as someone who was constantly overthinking things and berating himself over those thoughts–like right now.

“You're right.” A sigh escaped Phainon's chest as he finally parted ways with the palms of his hands. “He *is* that type of guy.”

Empousa beamed and whipped her head toward Herklas. “You did it!”

“Despite your mumbling and grumbling.” Herklas rolled his eyes, and that earned him another punch.

“Was there…” Phainon grunted. There was still one other thing that kept rapping on his mind. “Was there anything similar between me and him? Does Mydei… see him in me?”

“No,” Herklas immediately answered. “Even if you two are similar, Mydei sees you as two separate people.”

“What similarities are there?”

Herklas sighed loudly; that was probably the most emotion he had shown this entire flight. “*Why* do you want to know that?”

“I'm just curious!”

“The curiosity will kill you.”

“And it will, if I don't know!” Phainon wailed, dropping his shoulders. “Just please answer me this question?”

Another sigh from his co-pilot, resigning to his fate. “You're both whiny.”

“Whiny?!”

“Were you not just whining for me to answer your question?”

Phainon could not answer that question.

At his silence, Herklas droned on. “Whiny, constantly teasing Mydei, always hiding things from him, loud.”

“I'm not–!”

At the looks both Herklas and Empousa gave him, Phainon fell silent. Was that really how people saw him? He literally just met these two about two hours ago.

“You're both very… How should I put this?” Empousa frowned, jumping into the conversation. “The life of the party? You both attract people's attention and draw crowds. Is charismatic the word for that? And you both pull Mydei into things or situations he would never dream of even doing, but he still has fun doing those things.”

It was Phainon's turn to frown. “When have I ever done that?”

“When you pulled him into the mile-high club.”

“Again, can we stop mentioning what happened an hour ago?! And wait, Mydei started it! ”

Empousa laughed once more at Phainon's burning face, and she quickly cleared her throat. “Okay, okay, anything else on your mind?”

“Is there… anything different between us?” At the words of the other two, they just sounded like the exact same person. Phainon wasn't sure if he exactly liked that now that he was dating Mydei.

“For one, you're definitely more built than him,” Herklas immediately answered. “Hephaestion is skinny.”

“Yeah, Phainon, you're *huge!*”

Phainon's face bloomed red once more. “Okay, thanks, guys,” he stiffly replied. “Anything else?”

“You seem more like a mess than Hephaestion.”

His mouth dropped open. Was that an insult? “What does that mean?”

Phainon was surprised to see Herklas laughing at him after his statement, but he didn't bother explaining what he meant. Somehow, Empousa was nodding right beside Herklas, and Phainon turned with pleading eyes over to her, silently begging for her to explain.

“Phainon, you're like… really chaotic to be around.”

“What does that mean?!”

Phainon couldn't possibly fathom what they were talking about. He had always thought of himself as a pillar, or at least, a reliable figure to be around–someone who others could depend upon. Did he have the wrong impression about himself this entire time?

But Empousa seemed to confirm his thoughts about himself: “You're very reliable and dependable, Phainon, but you also have a lot going on at the same time. Your mind seems to be filled with a lot of things all at once.”

“Wrong,” Herklas immediately butted in. “He only thinks of Mydei. What I meant by ‘mess’ was that you are very expressive. I think Hephaestion just laughs off most of his problems, but you seem to think a little too hard about your problems.”

“Okay, but *I* think he thinks about a lot of things at once!” Empousa retorted. “Sure, they're all about Mydei at the end of the day, but it's a lot of *different* things about Mydei.”

“Guys, I don't just think about Mydei.” Phainon received two very dubious stares, and he looked around at the two of them exasperatedly. “I don't *just* think about Mydei… Right?”

“Anything else you want to ask?” Empousa immediately moved on from the question with a too-pleasant smile across her lips.

Why did Phainon feel like he was just getting berated the entire conversation?

He frowned, trying to think if there was anything else he wanted to ask, but after the extreme roasting session he just received from two coworkers whom he literally just met, he wasn't sure if he wanted to ask anything more.

“Do you think… I'm a rebound?” Phainon hesitately glanced up at the two of them, but none of their expressions seemed to change in response to his question.

“Phainon…” Empousa furrowed her eyebrows. “Are you serious?”

“It's a genuine question!”

“Definitely, definitely not,” Empousa sternly replied. She approached Phainon's side, landing a hand upon his slumped shoulder. “Mydei isn't that type of person. We told you, didn't we? He's a straightforward type of guy. And it's been a few months now; I'm sure Mydei was over that guy a long, long time ago.”

“Still…” Phainon's eyes were downcast at their feet, and his eyes trailed over how pristine everyone's leather shoes were. “Is there the slightest chance he could be using me to forget about Hephaestion? They must've been together for, what? For years? There's no way he could get over his first love that quickly, right?” He still couldn't get over the fact that Mydei had said he went to the club that day to forget his name, and it also didn't settle well in Phainon’s mind that he would never be Mydei’s first. Did he see Phainon there and think that it was a good opportunity to forget about his ex-boyfriend too?

“Not even the slightest,” Empousa answered. “I promise you, Mydei really likes you.”

“But you've only ever seen him yelling at me.”

“Yeah, but I also heard you guys going at it for the past hour.”

Phainon really felt like he was going through tribulations in this conversation.

“If you're really worried, then just ask Mydei yourself.” Empousa grinned. “Mydei would have no problem answering any of your questions.”

With a heavy sigh, he unlocked his phone and exited the search results about Hephaestion, earning cheers and claps from Empousa next to him. There was no point in thinking in circles, and Empousa was right; if he really couldn't stop thinking about Hephaestion, he should just go to Mydei himself for answers, even if it made him look like a crazy, possessive maniac.

Empousa exited the cockpit, mumbling about now having to clean Mydei's room, and Phainon was left in the cockpit with Herklas and his own swirling thoughts. He sat back in his seat, watching the clouds below them in silence. They still had about a few hours left before they landed at their first destination, and Phainon wasn't sure how he was going to last with all of these deprecating thoughts in his head.

# Chapter 9: Phainon

A heavy sigh left Phainon's chest once the private jet was finally still. They had just landed at the airport at their destination and pulled into a private hangar to stop the plane. Of course, the company was wealthy enough to rent out a private hangar; why was Phainon even surprised at this point?

Phainon and Herklas were parking the plane, while Empousa conducted last-minute checks inside the jet, ensuring everything was clean and in order. Phainon offered to help her clean Mydei's room for… certain reasons, but she denied and told him to just focus on flying the plane like he was supposed to be doing. Krateros had already called a chauffeur to drive them from the parked plane to the airport, where they could be on their way to their hotel.

Taking their suitcases and exiting the plane, Phainon was about ready to crash for the day–him, not the plane. He was exhausted, and he was just about ready to stretch and lie down in a nice, plush hotel bed. There were a total of five people, and Phainon wasn't sure if he would be sharing a room with Herklas or not. Then again, he probably wouldn't have been surprised if the company could afford to give every single person their own hotel room. Though he didn't mind sharing a room with Herklas, since the man was quiet and kept to himself most of the time. Phainon forgot the guy was even with him in the cockpit for a majority of the flight.

They climbed into the black minivan that had pulled up at their hangar, with the chauffeur helping to stack their bags into the car. Phainon felt his body slump in the seat upon hearing all the car doors close; it wasn't as if he wasn't relaxed on the plane or anything, but now he could stop thinking about work for the next three days.

According to the schedule, Mydei was performing tomorrow night and the night after that, and he had one rest day for himself once those two concerts were finished. They would fly to their next destination at the end of their third day here. That also meant Phainon could do whatever he wanted for the next three days. Well, two and a half days, if he didn't count having to

prepare for their next flight. But Phainon wasn't going to think about that right now. He was way too tired to continue thinking about work.

It wasn't as if Phainon hated his job; he went to pilot school for a reason, after all. Phainon absolutely loved his job. Being able to travel to new places, meet new people, and experience different sights and cultures was something that he could never tire of. Even just being able to soar through the clouds and take in the vast sky in front of him was a view that Phainon lived to see, and if it wasn't for this profession, he wouldn't even be sitting next to his boyfriend in this car either.

Venturing through the airport and climbing into a black van with tinted windows, Phainon watched the streets pass by before him as they made their way to the hotel, which was quite the luxury hotel that was a little way from the concert venue where Mydei would be performing. As this was a major city within the country, Phainon had flown to this destination before, but he still enjoyed watching the nightlife play before his eyes as they traveled through the streets.

Exiting the van and entering the hotel, it seemed that Krateros was quite the busy man, who checked them in and met up with the rest of the staff who traveled in a separate commercial airliner. Even though it was the evening when they landed, he was still finalizing the logistics for the concert tomorrow, and from what Phainon could hear from where he was standing, he was talking about everything with their team: hair, makeup, costuming, and stage positioning and lighting, despite being nowhere near the stage.

Although he had lunch on the plane, it was dinner time now, and Phainon wasn't sure if he could leave to eat while Krateros was so preoccupied. But just when he was about to ask, Mydei approached him holding a hotel room key.

“Let's go.” He jutted his head toward the elevator and left before Phainon could even raise an eyebrow. Glancing between Krateros and Mydei, who had already called for the elevator, Phainon decided to follow his boss.

He scurried after Mydei while eyeing the key in his hand. Where was Phainon's key?

“Do you have my room key, or should I ask Krateros for it?” Phainon tried another glance in Krateros's direction, but he was just as busy as ever. It was then that he remembered that there was a possibility he was sharing a room. “Oh, wait, where's Herklas? Am I with him?”

“You're with me,” Mydei huffed right when the elevator doors opened with a *ding*.

Jaw dropping open, he quickly regained his composure and stepped inside before the elevator, and Mydei, left without him.

“I'm with you?” Phainon stared incredulously at the room key that Mydei was fiddling with in his hand.

“The other room key is in my pocket, if that's what you're asking.”

Oh. Phainon's shoulders, which he didn't even know were tense, relaxed. For a second there, he thought Mydei was saying that they were sharing a hotel room together. Not that he didn't want to share a room with Mydei; the problem was that it was the exact opposite. Phainon might go crazy if he shared a room with Mydei, and he wasn't sure if he, his brain, or his dick would last sharing a room with the man. They could barely last one single flight.

With another sharp chime, the elevator doors parted open, and Mydei stepped out into the hallway. Phainon followed closely behind, watching every door that held the same appearance as the last door pass his eyes, until they eventually stopped in front of Room 550.

Phainon scanned the other nearby rooms that didn't seem disturbed at all; weird, did Empousa and Herklas already go into their rooms, or did they not come up here at all?

Wait, which one was Phainon's room?

“Mydei?” Phainon peeked over Mydei's shoulder right when he had gotten the door unlocked. “Can you hand me my room key?”

Raising an eyebrow, Mydei dug into his back pocket and tossed it behind him in Phainon's direction. He scrambled to catch it as Mydei disappeared into his room, but when he finally held the key in the palm of his hands, his jaw dropped once more.

Room 550 was written in the key.

It felt like Phainon was in a sitcom, staring up and down between the door plate and the key that sat in his hand. Room 550 on the door plate and… Room 550 on the room key in his hand.

*Was he actually sharing a room with Mydei?!*

No, no, no, that was impossible. They booked these rooms even before Phainon's first day. There was no possible way they had planned to make their rockstar share a room with the pilot. Did they change the rooms when they got here? That was unlikely too, unless they paid hundreds of dollars to change their booking at the last minute. Damn, if that were true, then this company was *wealthy*. It wasn't like Phainon didn't know it already, but it just kept hitting him every single time something like this happened.

He unlocked the door, swinging it wide open and rolling his suitcase inside. It was a beautiful room, with a door leading to the balcony on the far wall, an ornate dresser that acted as a television stand on the wall to his right, and a flat screen television hanging right above it. It was a very modern room, with two beds to his left, and the bathroom and walk-in closet would be right behind him after stepping into the room. There was also a desk area near the balcony door and an armchair to relax in.

“I didn't realize I was sharing a room with you,” Phainon admired the space before turning to Mydei, who was already opening his suitcase.

Mydei furrowed his eyebrows, but his hands rummaging through his suitcase never ceased. “What did you think I meant by ‘you're with me’?”

“Well–That's–I just assumed I would be with Herklas. And then, you said my room key was in your pocket, so I just assumed the room was for whichever room was Herklas's room.”

“This *is* Herklas's room.” Mydei finally glanced up at Phainon, who was still in quite the stupor at sharing a room with the rockstar. “The pilots were supposed to room together, but I took his key instead and gave him my single room.”

“Why did you do that?”

Mydei laughed. “Why else?”

Phainon was in such a daze that he barely registered Mydei moving from his suitcase until two arms had swung over his shoulders, pulling him toward the most beautiful man he had ever laid eyes on.

“Is it wrong that I want to share a room with you?” Mydei whispered, and it didn't escape Phainon's eyes upon seeing Mydei's gaze flicker between his eyes and lips.

“Of course not…” Great, Phainon was hard already. This was exactly what he was afraid of. But how could you blame him? He had been yearning for the man standing in front of him for *months*. And after having his first taste of sex, especially with this absolutely delectable and drop-dead gorgeous man, there was no way Phainon could stay calm, or sane, for that matter.

A smile came from the other man. “Good. From now on, for the rest of the tour, then, we'll be taking Herklas's room key.”

Phainon gulped loudly. The *entire* tour? He felt his dick ache in his slacks at the thought–the same disheveled slacks from earlier today. There was absolutely no way he was going to last this entire tour.

“Are you… sure that's a good idea?” Phainon couldn't help but mumble his concerns out loud. He was already hard, and they literally just went at it like animals in heat a few hours ago.

Mydei innocently tilted his head to the side. If only he knew what was running through Phainon's head right now.

“You don't want to share a room with me?”

“Of course I do.”

“Then, why aren't you looking at me?”

Phainon's hands balled into fists right beside him. The front of his pants was going to tighten for sure if he looked into his golden eyes again.

“I just…” Phainon's eyes were glued to the intricate pattern on the carpeted floor. He muttered the rest of his thoughts, but his voice was barely above a whisper.

“What did you say?”

Oh no, he had to repeat himself? His face was already burning red, and his fingernails were digging into his skin over Mydei's scent that continually wafted through Phainon's nose. True to his word, Mydei took a shower while they were on the private jet, and he smelled way too good for Phainon's sanity to handle.

He took a deep breath, and his throat was closing up over the embarrassment that was running through his body. “I don't know if I can last.”

“If you can… last?”

A silence surrounded the two men, with Phainon refusing to tear his gaze away from their shoes. Wow, Mydei's combat boots sure looked great. They looked expensive too. They were probably real leather. That would mean that he couldn't wear them in the rain, which Phainon felt kind of defeated the whole purpose of wearing boots. Shouldn't boots be wearable in the rain? Surely these boots could be covered in a protective coating that would make them more durable for water. That would also make them resistant to scratching, which would help the overall longevity of the boots. Knowing Mydei, he probably already covered his boots in that protective coating. Either that, or these boots were brand new, considering that Phainon couldn't find a single scuff on the soles of the boots. That would mean he should remind Mydei to coat them in–

“Phainon, are you *hard?”*

Darn, that entire mantra about Mydei's boots didn't do anything for his erection?

He grimaced, lowering his chin even more until it was practically against his chest. Phainon felt like his face was so hot he could heat food. “Mydei… I have something to tell you.”

“Something other than your bulge?”

“No!” Phainon's face shot up, and two hands held his cheeks, holding his head in place.

The man in front of him was extremely amused with Phainon's unfortunate situation, with his golden eyes sparkling and a small smirk across his lips, lips that were really plump and full and shiny and red–

“This isn't fair,” Phainon grumbled. His chin was held in Mydei's palms, so it was hard to move his jaw to speak properly.

Mydei laughed. “So, what did you want to tell me?”

Phainon pouted. He didn't want to tell him while looking directly into his eyes. “Nothing.”

“Just tell me.”

“You're being unfair.”

“How am I being unfair? You're the one who's hard.”

Phainon's ears grew hot, which didn't escape Mydei's notice. But he didn't seem the least intent on letting go of Phainon, so Phainon just had to resort to trying to look at literally anything in the room except for Mydei's face, which was hard because he was right in front of him.

“I'm… hard,” Phainon mumbled, who finally settled on staring at the dresser underneath the hanging television behind Mydei.

Mydei raised an amused eyebrow, his smirk growing. “Is that actually what you wanted to tell me?”

“It's because…”

Phainon mumbled under his breath, his blush creeping all the way down to his neck. Mydei frowned, furrowing his eyebrows once more and leaning in to hear Phainon, but that didn’t do wonders for Phainon’s pounding heartbeat or his aching dick.

“Phainon, I cannot hear–”

“You’re my first time!” Phainon cried and squeezed his eyes shut. This was the only way he could ensure not to see Mydei’s reaction at all.

He didn’t know what Mydei was doing or what expression could possibly be all over his face, but Phainon didn’t want to know. If given a choice, he wanted to hide in the bathroom and try to calm his erection that was, somehow, still flaring in this embarrassing situation he was in. If talking about Mydei’s combat boots didn’t calm him down, then maybe something that made him mad or annoyed would work?

His mind suddenly thought of drunk Cipher, particularly that night at the club a few months ago, and his erection died immediately.

“Phainon.”

His deep voice roused Phainon from his thoughts. His face was still bright red, so he stubbornly refused to open his eyes. But the deep voice coming from in front of him continued, pronouncing every word slowly and clearly. “Our time on the plane was your first?”

Grimacing once more, Phainon slowly nodded his head that was still in Mydei’s grasp.

“I’m really sorry I didn’t tell you, Mydei.” Phainon’s eyes were still squeezed shut. “I just didn’t want to worry you during your first tour by yourself.”

The man in front of him was still silent, making Phainon's quickening heartbeat fill the entire space between the two. Why wasn't he saying anything?! It was just making Phainon more anxious, and the fact that he refused to open his eyes to see how Mydei felt about the whole situation didn't help Phainon either. Was it that Mydei wanted to be with someone more experienced? Did Mydei not like inexperienced people? Was Mydei fuming over the fact that Phainon did not reveal this information until after their first time? Despite his spiraling thoughts, Phainon still didn't want to open his eyes.

"Are you…okay?"

Those were probably the last words Phainon was expecting to come out of Mydei's mouth as a response. He was so shocked, in fact, that he actually opened his eyes upon hearing those words.

Mydei was standing in front of him with furrowed eyebrows and downturned lips, staring worriedly at the man he held in his hands. A faint blush could be found across his cheeks, unless Phainon was imagining things. No, Phainon was definitely imagining things. It was more believable that Phainon was going crazy rather than believing Mydei was blushing in this situation.

"Okay?" Phainon breathed out in utter confusion.

Golden eyes searched in front of him; what was Mydei looking at? "I guess all of your previous behavior makes sense," Mydei muttered, glancing toward the side as he became deep in thought. "No wonder…No, that makes sense now…"

"Mydei?"

His eyes shot back to Phainon, who became startled at his sharp gaze. "Phainon, are you okay?"

"What are you talking about?"

“If I had known…” Mydei shook his head. “Was I, perhaps, too rough on you today? I didn’t know it was your first time. I’m sorry.”

Phainon’s mouth dropped open. He thought *he* was rough?! And he was apologizing for it?! Then, what was Phainon?! If anything, Phainon should be on his knees and pleading for Mydei’s mercy after what he had done to him on the plane!

“N–No, Mydei,” Phainon stammered incredulously. “Mydei, if anything, I was the rough one.”

“I know,” Mydei immediately agreed, which made Phainon slightly offended that he agreed so readily to the truth. “But that’s why it makes sense now why you were so wild today. I didn’t realize that was your first time. I pulled you down into bed, pinned you to the wall, stripped you, and basically seduced you to sleep with me on a moving plane when you should’ve been working. I didn’t even let you leave until you thrust your dick inside of me.”

“Mydei, you didn’t have to word it like that–”

“I wouldn’t have done all that if I knew.” Mydei sighed heavily, his eyes wandering around the room once more.

Phainon tilted his head to the side with a frown. “Mydei, I really enjoyed it. I’m fine. If anything, *I* should be apologizing.”

The rockstar scoffed. “Apologize? You should go harder next time.”

“*Harder?!*”

Mydei finally released his grip on Phainon’s cheeks, laughing to himself. “I wouldn’t mind if you went harder, Phainon, but only if you want to.”

Phainon swore his jaw was on the floor. Mydei wanted him to go *harder?!* What was he, indestructible?! The man could barely move after today! Wasn’t he just complaining about his back hurting and not being able to perform at his concert tomorrow?!

It was as if Mydei could read his mind because he elaborated further: “I may be on tour right now, but when I’m not, I wouldn’t mind you going harder than today.”

*This guy was crazy!* Actually, Phainon couldn’t say anything either; he got hard just from realizing he was sharing a room with his boyfriend.

Mydei settled back on the edge of the nearest bed, plucking up a menu that was set upon the nightstand. “Was that all you wanted to say?”

Phainon was still frozen in place, his mind wondering how he could possibly go harder to appease the man. “Yes…”

“Then come here. I’m ordering room service, so let’s eat dinner together.”

He bounded over to Mydei’s side, settling in the space next to him on the bed and resting his chin on Mydei’s shoulder to read the menu. But the longer he scanned the menu being held up in front of his eyes, the more he didn’t want to order a single item. Why was everything so expensive?! Even water cost money!

“Um, Mydei–”

“I’m paying, so pick whatever you want.”

His eyes continued to search the menu, but to no avail. “That just makes me want to buy even less.”

“Phainon, I make millions. Just pick something, or I’m picking the most expensive thing on this menu for you.”

Phainon’s finger automatically pointed at a salad.

Mydei immediately scowled. “A *salad?*”

“What’s wrong with a salad?”

Sighing exasperatedly, Mydei picked up the phone to dial room service.

During the time of waiting for their food to arrive, they had each taken a shower and unpacked some of their belongings, such as toiletries and electronics. After grabbing the food from the hotel staff, Phainon thanked them and shut the door, approaching Mydei with their food. The rockstar was sitting on the edge of his bed and tuning his guitar. It was a sleek, black guitar that looked to be in pristine condition. Knowing Mydei, it was probably an expensive guitar.

“It’s a Fender guitar,” Mydei answered without glancing up from his guitar. He was fiddling with the ends of his guitar, strumming it with his other hand to ensure it sounded right to his ears for the concert tomorrow. Mydei previously explained to him that guitars could go out of tune during flights when he unpacked his guitar right after his shower.

Phainon settled on the floor at Mydei’s feet, separating their food and setting his portion next to him. “A Fender guitar? How much is it?”

“It’s a custom one, so…tens of thousands of dollars?”

Phainon scooted back from the guitar. He was not about to get a single drop of salad dressing on that shining black guitar. Could you even imagine the news? “Fans Find Salad Dressing on Mydeimos’s Guitar. He is a Messy Eater!”

“Are you sure you just wanted a salad?” Mydei eyed him as Phainon began digging into his salad from a couple of paces away. “And why are you so far?”

“Don’t worry; salads are my favorite.” Phainon was actually quite happy that he could order a salad from the menu. It was Phainon’s tradition to order every salad at every restaurant he ever went to. There was something about salads that was so refreshing, consisting of different textures that danced across his tongue, and they could taste so drastically different depending on what was added in. They were both versatile and healthy, so how could Phainon complain?

“Do you even get full from salads?”

“They’re filling with protein.”

“Is there protein in that salad?”

Phainon shoved his mouth full of greens.

A sigh came from the man on the bed as he continued strumming his guitar. “You’re coming tomorrow, right?” At the silence that settled in the air, Mydei narrowed his eyes at the silver-haired man who was still chowing down on his salad that clearly lacked protein. “To the concert?”

Phainon immediately coughed, choking on a crouton that lodged in his throat. Gasping for air and reaching desperately for his water that cost an outrageous amount of money, he took one giant breath and stared with wide eyes at the other man. Phainon had plans for tomorrow?! “I’m going?!”

Mydei scoffed. “You were thinking of *not* going? To your own boyfriend’s concert?”

“B–But–” Phainon floundered wildly. “I don’t have a ticket.”

“You think you need a ticket to get into your *own boyfriend’s* concert?”

“But, where would I sit if I don’t have a ticket?”

“Backstage? Where else?”

Phainon’s mouth dropped open. This was the power he now wielded with a mega-famous rockstar boyfriend. Phainon still couldn’t believe it. No wonder Cipher was so obsessed with meeting a celebrity.

“I’m going… backstage? Is that even allowed?”

Mydei laughed at Phainon’s daze, setting his guitar down next to him. “Phainon, whose concert is this?”

“... Yours.”

With a chuckle, Mydei began pulling out his own food. He had ordered chicken slathered in a sweet barbecue sauce. “So why do you think I wouldn’t allow you into my own concert? I already let Krateros know earlier. You only need to arrive tomorrow, and he’ll take care of everything.”

Phainon slowly returned to eating his food. He couldn’t believe he was just getting to attend a concert for free. To watch *his own boyfriend* perform at *his own concert*. He already looked perfect in the concert clips Phainon had seen before; he couldn’t even begin to imagine what it was like to actually watch Mydei perform right in front of him.

“Is there a specific time you want me there?”

Mydei hummed. “The concert starts at 8 PM. Come a little before then. I don’t want you to see the rehearsal just yet. I want you to experience the concert first.” He began digging into his own food, lavishing in the sweet flavor. “You can come to the next rehearsal.”

With a small smile and an enthusiastic nod, Phainon finished the rest of his food in a contented silence. It was a peaceful night, with the crickets chirping quietly outside and the clear night sky beautifully displaying the stars above. They had opened the balcony door earlier, and a cool breeze would sweep into the room every now and then. They were still in the city but were far enough away to not be disturbed by the hustle and bustle of the downtown area, so they had quite a breathtaking view of the city skyline in tranquility. While washing his hands after throwing away his trash, a voice came from the sleeping area.

“Phainon, you’re sleeping in the same bed as me tonight.”

It was not going to be a peaceful night for Phainon.

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Phainon roused from his slumber quite late into the day. He had trouble falling asleep next to a certain someone, and he didn't lose consciousness until it was the depths of the night. Blearily blinking the sleep out of his eyes, he looked around the room, which was dimly lit due to the curtains

that were still closed, giving the whole room a gentle glow. Mydei had already left for rehearsal in the morning, which left Phainon alone for the day until it was time for the concert.

Plucking his phone from the nightstand, he saw that it was quite late into the afternoon. He had notifications of unread messages on his phone, asking him about the flight and work. It was then that he realized he had never told his friends that the client he was flying for really *was* Mydeimos, the rockstar. He was so in shock over seeing that it was actually Mydei that he had forgotten to message them before the plane took off, and he obviously didn't have service while in the air. And when they landed, well, by this point, he was too preoccupied with Mydei himself. He messaged them all back, letting them know the flight was fine and he was just resting in the hotel for now. Well, they'll find out eventually when they return a couple of months from now. He already received the flight schedule beforehand, so his friends already knew he would be out for work for a while.

The rest of his day, leading up to the concert, was quite peaceful. He called Aglaea to help him put a nice outfit together, which mostly consisted of just her berating most of the clothing options he decided to pack. Phainon also dined at one of the hotel restaurants for lunch, and it was still crazy to him that a restaurant was part of the hotel. He had never experienced a five-star hotel before, and it was overwhelming to him at how many amenities were included. With his spare time, he went out and explored the city, running into many Mydeimos fans who were excitedly awaiting the concert. He could tell from all the rock T-shirts and merchandise, and it made his heart full seeing Mydei so loved.

About an hour before the concert, the front desk of the hotel arranged a car for him that would take him to the concert venue. Phainon was quite literally fiddling with his phone in the middle of calling for a car in the lobby when one of the staff ran up to him and informed him they could take Phainon instead. He was baffled; he didn't realize car services were a part of fancy hotels either, but he happily accepted and was on his way. Someone really needed to tell Phainon everything that was included in typical five-star hotels so that he could take advantage of all their amenities and

services, because his humble upbringing could not begin to fathom what could be included.

And then it was time. When he climbed out of the car, he was overwhelmed by the sheer crowd that was already waiting for Mydeimos outside. Phainon didn't actually know where he was supposed to go; Mydei just told him that Krateros would take care of everything, so it was just up to Phainon to reach out to someone to take him backstage.

He reached for his phone in his pocket, and the truth suddenly hit him: he *still* didn't have Mydei's number! They had basically been together the entire time, so there was no need to exchange numbers! Phainon seriously could not believe that wasn't the first thing they did after they made up. Wait, the first thing they did was sleep together; no wonder they still didn't have each other's numbers.

Phainon, in a panic, dug through the list of recently called phone numbers until he found the date when he was offered a job by Kremnos Entertainment. Dialing the number, he just really hoped it was Krateros's actual cell phone and not a desk phone he had at headquarters. His other worry was that Krateros didn't save his number, and he may not pick up a phone call from a random number while he was busy trying to finalize the last few details for the concert.

The call was immediately picked up. “Phainon?”

Thank God Krateros saved Phainon's number!

“Hey, I'm here, but I don't know where to go.”

A grunt sounded from the other line. “Find someone with a Mydeimos staff shirt. They will bring you back; just tell them you know my name.”

The call was hung up, leaving Phainon to his own devices. Why were his phone calls with Krateros always exactly two seconds long?

Weaving through the excited crowd to try and locate a single staff member, he could hear all the conversations surrounding Mydeimos. People were

talking about his new album, his new debut, where he was going to take this new career, his old band, and how hot he looked in the new music video. Phainon frowned at that; he agreed for sure, but he didn't want *other* people to agree. Some of them were even talking about how they hoped Mydeimos would rip his shirt off for this concert! Did that imply he has done it before?! He made a mental note to confront Mydei about that later.

Different lines were waiting for different things, and Phainon quickly approached the staff who were selling merchandise. Waving apologetically to the person who was in the middle of telling the staff what they wanted to buy, Phainon quickly blurted out his question.

“Can you help bring me to Krateros?”

The staff member appeared slightly shocked at his question, but they relaxed just as quickly. “What's your name?”

“Phainon.”

The staff member nodded and produced a walkie-talkie in their hand, muttering something into the receiver. It wasn't long before the staff nodded in Phainon's direction before turning back to the fan that was still trying to buy from them. Phainon wasn't sure if he was supposed to just stand here and wait, but as he was trying to figure out if he should go somewhere else, that was out of the way of the merchandise line, Krateros appeared himself.

“Krateros?” Phainon did not think the manager was going to personally get him.

It seemed the manager also didn't think so either, as he clicked his tongue in annoyance. “I have so many things to do, yet that bastard still wants me to come get you myself.”

With a laugh, Phainon hurriedly followed Krateros backstage. It seemed that many of the fans even recognized Krateros as Mydeimos’s manager, as he started hearing whispers and murmurs about who Phainon was and why he was being personally escorted by Mydeimos’s manager as they passed

by crowds of fans. Some of them even pulled out their phones to take pictures of the two of them as they scurried backstage.

It was only a couple of minutes now before the concert was starting, and he could see that the waiting crowd was finally allowed into the venue as they went to their assigned seating. Krateros just wildly waved his hand at some part near the front of the stage before leaving Phainon, but thankfully, he made eye contact with Herklas and Empousa, who were sitting near the staff at the side of the stage.

“Phainon!” Empousa exclaimed as he settled near them. “Nice of you to join us today.”

“Have you guys been here all day?” Phainon took in the chanting crowd, the full seats, and the grand stage before them. Phainon still couldn't believe he had somehow gotten wrapped up with the man they were all waiting to see.

Empousa nodded. “We usually come just to hang out and give an extra hand when the staff need one, but Mydei told us he wanted you to see the concert first.”

Phainon laughed, but before he could say anything, screams pierced the air as the venue lighting began to dim. Everyone, including Phainon, turned their attention toward the stage. With wide eyes and a pounding heart, a loud strum of an electric guitar reverberated through his entire body, overtaking even his own heartbeat and echoing through the venue. Cheers and cries from the fans sitting behind him followed shortly behind as the scene began to play out right in front of his very eyes.

The concert had begun.

# Chapter 10: Phainon / Mydei

Phainon has been to a concert before. He's been to many concerts before. But this concert was something Phainon could've never imagined.

The moment the concert started with that strum of his guitar echoing throughout the venue, Phainon waited anxiously with bated breath, sitting at the edge of his seat. His heart was pounding in his ears as if he were the one about to perform in front of a crowd of thousands, but nothing would ever beat the sight of Mydeimos finally being revealed to everyone in that venue that night. With his trusty black guitar hanging from his shoulders, the show was about to begin.

The chanting crowd, the pounding of the drums that rattled his ribcage. The blaring, flashing lights, and the strums of guitars that vibrated in his brain. The raw emotion and power that echoed from the stage was unlike anything Phainon had ever experienced before, as everything in that entire venue centered around one specific golden-haired man. Everything was perfect, from the stage lighting to the positioning of the backup band that played the instrumentals to the main character himself, who could be found no matter where one's eyes flickered amongst the stage.

It was something that didn't compare to watching the concert clips on his phone screen all those months ago. He couldn't feel the music physically hitting his body in waves, thrumming against his eardrums. He couldn't experience the goosebumps that rose on his skin with every powerful vocal that resounded from the stage. He couldn't feel the energy of the crowd, chanting the lyrics to every song along with the man who engaged with the crowd, calling for them and returning their energy tenfold.

Phainon could tell it was hot on that stage with how brightly the lights were shining down on everything and everyone below, and he was so close to the stage that he could see the sweat dripping down his body in rivulets. But despite all of that, Mydeimos was still running around the stage and shining even by himself, with that stupidly handsome smirk and his stupidly gorgeous golden hair. He learned from the crowds chanting and screaming

that they call him “King Mydeimos,” or just “King” for short, and he didn’t doubt it with the way the man basically commanded everyone’s attention, commanded everyone on stage, and commanded the whole show himself under his leering, sharp gaze and his dominating vocals.

It didn’t even feel like this man, who had thousands of eyes watching him shred his guitar that Phainon was too afraid of getting salad dressing on, was the same man who hated the taste of whiskey so much that he called a stranger out for it. Mydeimos was a man who belonged on stage, and it would have felt like a crime if he could never stand on stage again. Phainon understood just why Mydeimos had so many fans and so many pairs of eyes watching him. He also understood why those fans continued to support him even after leaving his own band. It wasn’t right to rip this glory and fame from Mydeimos’s hands, because this was right where he belonged, and the public knew it just as well as him, if not even better than Phainon.

Each and every song that echoed throughout the concert venue sounded better than Phainon could’ve ever imagined. He has heard his music and his singing many, many times on his phone and on streaming services, but Mydeimos sounded so much better in person than any microphone or studio equipment could capture. In fact, Phainon would argue that the recording studio was holding him back, because Phainon was convinced Mydeimos would have so many more fans if more people could hear him live.

His songs were so full of emotion and passion; Phainon could tell just from listening to his songs on his phone. But the feelings of every song were almost emphasized by the way the man performed in front of him, and that raw emotion was what the microphones and studio equipment could not capture. Anyone in this concert venue could just *feel* what Mydeimos was feeling, and every song resonated so deeply inside of Phainon that it hurt his chest and his brain. He had songs about longing, loss, sadness, and anger, and after the past few months of Mydeimos leaving his band and venturing on to a new path all by himself, it was as if he were taking everyone along with them and showing everyone exactly what he had gone through.

Even between intermissions, the crowd’s energy did not dissipate, as they chanted, yelled, and cried for the King, even with no one on stage. They

stomped their feet against the floor, with the vibrations pounding in Phainon’s brain. And every time Mydeimos reappeared in a new stage outfit and hair, it was like the King was reborn again and again. It was a sight that Phainon never tired of, seeing his golden eyes sparkle upon facing the crowd once more, and his smile that was adored by millions of people. Phainon understood why he was such a beloved rockstar; no, this man was more like the Sun than just any other star, as if the whole world revolved around him for this night. Even with the actual sun well below the horizon, Mydeimos was glowing in his own radiance.

He had faintly heard Empousa asking him something at one point, most likely related to Mydeimos or the concert, but Phainon was too hypnotized by the stage and the man who commandeered it to even reply. Mydeimos was a sight to behold, and he couldn't tear his eyes away from this shining light even if Phainon tried. Mydei was beautiful, Phainon couldn't deny that fact, but he was absolutely flourishing on that stage. A confident smirk was flashed his way by none other than the main character of tonight when he had approached their side of the stage, and Phainon's face erupted in a flush of red. With a silent laugh and a cheeky smile from the performing man, Mydeimos continued with his perfect song and his perfect concert.

It was a perfect night for Phainon, up until his very last song.

There were no fancy lights or stage effects during this song. It was just Mydeimos, alone on that giant stage, when he had announced that this would be the last and final song of the night.

Boos echoed throughout the stands, much to Phainon's amusement, and the main character laughed at their reactions. “Haven't you seen enough of me? I've been the only one here for the past three hours.” The King smirked.

“Never!” One voice cried from the stands, earning laughs and praises from the other fans.

The King laughed along with their antics, shifting the guitar on his shoulders until he was holding it in his hands. “Then you'd better watch carefully. This song is very special to me, and I'm sure you all know it too.

Even though this song is not what I usually write, I hope you all still take the time to listen. Good night, everyone."

It was then that the lyrics completely slammed into Phainon's head, so hard that it made his head and his heart pound.

Phainon had never actually specifically heard his newest album. Back when Phainon was still searching for the man, he would play Mydeimos's songs. But by the time his new album was released, Phainon had already stopped trying to contact the rockstar and completely abandoned all noise of the man. Because of that, Phainon heard many new songs during this concert, but this particular song, which Mydeimos specifically said meant a lot to him, struck Phainon in his core.

The slower song, which was so dramatic yet so beautifully sung, was a song that poured out deep passion and yearning. It was almost as if the singer were crying desperately for something or *someone*. It was a song that asked and begged for attention, not commanded it, and it was a song that sounded almost like a plea. Mydeimos was still for this song; he wasn't running around the stage like he was in his other songs, nor was he stripping his clothing like he was for the more excitable songs. The man was completely still in the center of the stage, putting his all into singing this song about someone that he strongly craved–someone that he wanted the attention of, and someone he wanted so desperately to remember him.

And Phainon knew the song wasn't about him.

Why would the song be about him? They literally reunited yesterday. If the song was part of his newest album, which dropped before he had met with Phainon, then it obviously was not about Phainon. No matter how much Phainon wanted it to be about him, the timeline didn't make any sense at all.

Who was the song about? Who was swirling in Mydei's mind as he wrote this song and poured everything into this song? Who was swirling in his mind right at this very moment? Mydeimos wasn't particularly looking at anyone; he was more preoccupied with pronouncing every word with the most love and passion Phainon had ever heard from any human being.

Mydeimos had specifically said he usually didn't write this type of song; then, what person had made Mydei feel so much that he *had* to write this type of song?

And why wasn't it Phainon?

The crowd was completely silent as they listened to this powerful, last song, waving their phone flashlights in the air to create a beautiful array of lights cascading throughout the stands. Mydeimos was surrounded by stars, and Phainon couldn't handle looking at the sun anymore. It was… much too bright for him now.

With the longest three to four minutes of his life coming to an end, the concert finally came to a close. The lights in the venue flashed on as the fans began filing out of the stands, murmuring about his great performance even without The Detachment. Phainon was left completely empty and still in his chair, feeling as if he weren't even in his own body anymore, to the point that he wasn't awakened until someone had tugged on his arm.

“Phainon?” Empousa covered the view of the stage that was in his sight, and he blinked blankly at the woman.

He managed a weak laugh, pushing himself to his feet. “Sorry, the concert was just…” He swallowed thickly. “Really good.”

“Right?!” Empousa enthusiastically nodded her head. “I could never get over his concerts! I wondered what he would be like without his bandmates, but I see now that he was still just as good as ever.”

Phainon nodded slightly. It felt like his head was pounding with the biggest migraine he had ever experienced, and he just wanted to go to sleep and forget he even existed for just a night. Why did Mydei have to end with that song? He was having such a good time until that song was performed.

The three of them returned to the hotel, as Mydei still had some work to finalize for the night and prepare for the concert tomorrow. Phainon barely registered Herklas calling for a car, he barely registered climbing into said

car, and he barely registered willing his feet forward into the hotel until he was back in front of Room 550.

He stared at the door plate, wondering if he should even step inside in the first place. If he went into this room, it would be a guarantee that he would see Mydei again. Maybe he could fall asleep before he came back? That was easier said than done; Phainon's head was pounding, and his brain was too busy repeating every single lyric from that song. Why must he remember it so well?

Maybe there was a chance he could hang around with Empousa and Herklas. Maybe he could pretend that he was having such a fun and enjoyable night that he didn't want the night to end, so he didn't return to his room immediately. That sounded like a plausible reason for not going back, but there was no way he could avoid Mydei forever.

Phainon knew he wasn't Mydei’s first love, and it hurt him so much it was hard to breathe at the thought that continually seared his brain. Phainon couldn't rewind time to be Mydei's first love, and he couldn't change that at all. It was something that Phainon had to accept. No matter how much his head pounded, how much his heart clenched tightly in his chest, or how much his tears burned the corner of his eyes, it was a fact that Phainon had to accept.

Mydei was a beautiful man, and he couldn't be mad that someone else was also in love with him at one point in time. In fact, it wouldn't make any sense at all if someone as beautiful as him didn't have any previous lovers.

Phainon would have to accept that he wouldn't be Mydei's first in anything. He wasn't Mydei's first kiss, his first date, his first cuddle, or even his first time in bed. It was normal for people to have previous partners; his brain obviously knew that, but his heart didn't want to accept it at all.

Phainon was possessive. Sure, he's had short flings and relationships before when he was young and in school, but it was nothing compared to what he felt with Mydei. He had never felt this way before, and he didn't realize how possessive, jealous, and disgusting of a man he could become. He wanted to covet Mydei all to himself, but it was already too late for that.

Shaking his head and subsequently irritating his pounding head, Phainon decided to just turn around and go for a walk in the city. He'd rather take in the sights of the beautiful nighttime city while having these terrible thoughts instead of holing himself up in his room and waiting for the source of his awful emotions to return. He wanted to greet Mydei with a smile on his face. He wanted to kiss him all over and tell him how amazing and breathtaking his concert was. But right now, Phainon couldn't bring himself to even look at the color gold, and he didn't want to greet Mydei after his concert with these abhorrent thoughts eating their way into his very soul. It was clear that Mydei had a fantastic night, and he didn't want to ruin it for him.

With a deep breath, Phainon whirled around on his feet, strolling down the orderly corridor and back where he came from. He raised a hand to press the elevator button, and it almost didn't even feel like he was existing in his own body. Phainon truly felt like just an empty shell that was just existing in this space and in this time.

He stepped into the parted elevator doors with another deep breath, watching the floor numbers above his head slowly count down. He wasn't surprised in the slightest that the company had booked the top floor in the hotel since those were always the most expensive rooms. Phainon let out another weak chuckle. This company just had way too much money to itself.

The elevator chime woke him up once more, and he stepped out into the lobby. It was empty as it was quite late into the night now. There was probably nothing open in the city where he could go to forget about himself and his stubborn thoughts, but at least he wouldn't have to be in that room that he shared with Mydei. And that was all Phainon wanted right at this moment.

Once he was feeling better, he could act as that perfect, excited boyfriend for his rockstar. Once these negative feelings were left behind, Phainon could rave about how beautiful and lovely and perfect Mydei was standing on that stage. Phainon promised himself that he would praise the man all the way up to the moon for his performance, but that had to be at a later time.

The city was absolutely beautiful. Phainon had already walked through the streets during his spare time earlier that day, but it was quite the sight to behold at night. The stars twinkled above his head, and the silent tranquility was exactly what his pounding head needed. He almost just wanted to stay out here for the rest of the night, just him and by himself. Should he call one of his friends just to distract himself? Though he wasn't sure what they were doing, especially with the time difference with him being almost across the country, and he didn't want to disturb them.

Phainon decided to just stroll through the silent city by himself.

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“Phainon?”

Mydei returned quite late to his hotel room after taking care of everything he needed to do after the concert, and he wasn't expecting Phainon to be awake or anything since it was 2 AM. However, Mydei didn't expect to return to an empty hotel room. A completely empty hotel room. Which wasn't possible at all, as he had specifically changed his room so that it *wouldn't* be empty. He was quite exhausted from the concert and had wanted to return to his room, take a shower, and fall asleep between two strong arms. But, the man of said arms was nowhere to be found.

“Phainon?” Mydei repeated again. He dropped his bags and guitar case to the floor, hesitantly stepping into the untouched hotel room. There wasn't a single sign that someone had returned; in fact, it looked almost like the hotel was being completely unused. Besides their suitcases, which were still open and strewn on the floor, Mydei would've thought that he had stepped into the wrong hotel room entirely.

The silence was permeating his brain as his footsteps echoed loudly in his ears. Mydei’s eyes scanned the room as his heartbeat began to quicken in the still hotel room.

“Phainon?”

Only silence continued to answer him, and he whirled on his feet to check the bathroom. But no one was there. Actually, the bathroom was completely

untouched too, with not a single stray droplet of water to be found either in the bath or by the sink.

His heartbeat was ringing in his ears as his hands grew clammy. Mydei was about ready to collapse in bed exactly three seconds ago until the panic started to settle in his veins.

“Phainon!”

His panic-stricken mind made him check *everywhere*. And by everywhere, Mydei truly meant everywhere. Other than checking the bath and the standing shower, he checked both walk-in closets, ripped the sheets off both beds, got onto his knees to check under the bed, stepped out onto the balcony, and even tried checking each individual drawer of the dresser. As if a well-built, grown adult man could fit into a tiny dresser, but Mydei's panicking mind didn't care a single bit.

“Phai…non?”

Mydei was standing in the middle of a completely empty hotel room that now looked like a tornado had run through it, with no one still responding back to him. Where did he go? What was he doing? Why wasn't he here?

*Where else could he go?*

“Phainon?” Mydei's blurring vision was scanning the walls behind him as if they held some clue as to Phainon’s current location. His throat was tightening up, and his chest was rising and falling in ragged breaths.

*Did he leave him again?*

Not right after Mydei had finally reunited with him. Not after Mydei had finally sorted out their misunderstanding with him. Was Phainon really just going to leave him again, just like that?

Mydei rapidly shook his head despite his spiraling brain or his twisting heart. No, that was impossible. Phainon was still his pilot. Phainon couldn't just up and disappear, unless he wanted to get fired, and from Phainon's

earlier actions of wanting to say his last words on the plane, it was clear that the man didn't want to lose his job.

*Then, where the Hell was he?!*

Taking deep breaths to remind himself that Phainon was still around, and that it was a very, very low chance that he really did just disappear and drop his job, his brain tried to rack for another solution. If he couldn't find Phainon, then could he just contact him?

Mydei sank his hand into his pocket, and upon feeling his phone in his fingers, he immediately grew rigid at the realization.

*How did he still not have that bastard's number?!*

With his panic quickly turning into exasperated anger, his fuming brain thought of another plausible solution. His only option now was to run to Empousa and Herklas for answers. Weren't they sitting with him during the concert? Mydei clearly locked eyes with Phainon during the concert, and he saw that he was sitting with them. Then they had to have returned together, right? Unless Phainon decided to go elsewhere after the concert? But what the fuck would be open after 2 AM?

Mydei dashed out of his room and hurriedly banged on both of their hotel doors, almost knocking them off their hinges, in the depths of the night, to ask if they knew where Phainon was. Both of them, who were in the middle of sleeping, could not answer his question, as their last memory of Phainon was when they all returned to their hotel together immediately following the concert.

"Where the *fuck* is he?!"

"Mydei, calm down! We'll find him!"

Unfortunately, neither Empousa nor Herklas knew where Phainon was, and neither of the two had his phone number either. They were all now crowded in Mydei's room while the man panic-called Krateros, who wasn't picking up his phone. Herklas had the bright idea to ask Krateros if he had

Phainon's phone number, since he had hired Phainon in the first place, but now his damn manager wasn't answering his phone. Mydei had already gone to angrily punch his door, but he could faintly hear water running. They were now impatiently waiting for Krateros to finish his shower.

“Does anyone have this man's damn number?!” Mydei couldn't sit still and was pacing back and forth, with Empousa trying desperately to calm the man.

“Krateros must have it since he hired him! Once he answers, we'll be able to call Phainon. So please just sit still, Mydei.” Empousa and Herklas were trailing the man with worried eyes as he continually paced up and down the room. While Mydei was panicking to himself, Empousa and Herklas took the liberty of straightening the hotel room, setting the sheets and pillows back onto the two beds where they belonged.

“Why isn't he picking up his damn phone?!” Mydei wanted to tear his hair out of his own scalp. Mydei and Krateros had returned to the hotel together but had parted ways since they resided in different hotel rooms. Mydei literally just saw his manager, so why wasn't he picking up his phone?!

Empousa hesitantly opened her mouth. “I guess he's still showering?”

“What kind of fuck ass shower takes this long?!” Mydei groaned and ran a furious hand through his hair. The *one* person who had the slightest chance of having this stupid bastard’s phone number just had to be currently unreachable. Absolutely zero sanity was left in Mydei's brain, and no matter Empousa’s sound words, it didn't calm Mydei down in the slightest. In fact, it only made him even angrier. What kind of evil stars aligned that made both his pilot and his manager unreachable at the same time?! And why did Mydei not exchange numbers with Phainon earlier when their whole misunderstanding was because of that?!

Phainon was *not* going to slip past his fingers ever again. Not when he had finally found the bastard again.

He had been through quite the whirlwind of emotions tonight. Mydei had quite a successful concert. He saw how dumbstruck Phainon looked at his

performance too, which filled Mydei with an extreme sense of pride. Then, he felt absolute exhaustion and an absolute longing to be held by said man. Upon returning to his empty hotel room, he had felt absolute shock that shifted into abandonment, which quickly became panic, turning into anger, and now he was at frustration.

Both the flight attendant and the pilot were amazed at how much emotion the rockstar was showing in the span of a single day. Mydei was known to be very grounded and rational, and that hadn't changed throughout the years they had worked for him. It was why he made such a good leader for the band and why the band relied on him as their anchor. And yet, they had watched this man's fuse snap at least twice in one day. All because of the exact same man.

At the first slight beat of his ringtone, Mydei slammed the answer button.

“Krateros?!”

“Why the Hell did you call me 33 times?” Understandably, Krateros was half-awake at 2 AM.

Mydei was really trying his hardest to sound calm over the phone, which wasn't really working at all. “Phainon isn't in his hotel room. Do you have his number?”

“He didn't tell you where he went?”

Mydei was going to explode. Why was he asking him questions instead of just doing what Mydei asked for?! “I haven't seen him since the concert when I was performing, so hurry up and give me his fucking number,” he snapped.

The manager didn't seem the least affected by his harsh words. “Okay, give me a second.”

The call hung up, but Mydei was already quite accustomed to how short his phone calls were with his manager. It was actually very appreciated, as

neither party wasted time. And soon after the end of the call, he received a very simple message consisting only of numbers.

# Chapter 11: Phainon

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Who was calling him in the middle of the night?

Phainon had paused in his nighttime stroll, staring inquisitively down at his phone that had been ringing for quite a while. Considering that it was the middle of the night, he had assumed it was a spam call and let it ring until the end. But now that the same mysterious number was calling him again, Phainon figured that it was either a very persistent spam caller or he should probably answer this phone call.

Hesitantly pressing the answer button, he raised the receiver to his ear, but he couldn't even get a single word out as the other person at the other end of the line had beaten him to it.

"*HKS*."

Phainon's eyes widened at the familiar, deep voice, and his heart began to pound in his chest despite the menacing tone and the menacing word. His voice was definitely the last voice that he was expecting on the other end, especially since he knew he didn't have his number.

He hesitantly opened his mouth, as he was unsure if his ears were working properly. "Mydei?"

"Get your ass back to the hotel. *Now*."

The call hung up just as abruptly as it started, with Phainon being left in a confused and silent daze all by himself in the middle of a random city. Did he actually hear Mydei on the other end, or was it just so late into the night that he just completely hallucinated Mydei's voice? There was no way that was actually Mydei; wasn't he still taking care of work at the concert venue? He wouldn't return that quickly, right?

The phone screen flashed in his face once more as Phainon checked the time to confirm, and *holy shit it was 2 AM?!* First of all, how did Mydei even call him in the first place? Did Mydei just have Phainon's phone number this entire time?

Whirling his head around at the nearby buildings, Phainon had no clue as to where he was in the city. His feet had ventured all by themselves as Phainon had sunk deep into his thoughts, and he didn't even realize where he had ended up and how long he had been out until that phone call awoke him from his stupor.

He had to actually pull out a navigation application on his phone to travel back to the hotel, as Phainon had no idea where he was. It was about a thirty-minute walk back to the hotel, so Phainon really did go on quite the adventure by himself. And now he had to face the wrath of a certain golden-haired man.

Phainon didn't originally plan on staying out so late, but his deprecating thoughts and depressing emotions just didn't go away, no matter how long Phainon had tried to clear his head. Although his head did feel slightly better, his chest didn't improve at all. Even though he hurried back to the hotel to not worry Mydei, he also wasn't sure what he was going to say to the man once he saw him again.

*Happy thoughts, Phainon. Happy thoughts.*

He had exactly thirty minutes now to rehearse the lines in his head. He had exactly thirty minutes now to rehearse his smile, his laugh, and his hug to Mydei.

*“The concert was great, Mydei!”*

*“Mydei, you were amazing up there!”*

*“You were so cool, Mydei!”*

Phainon continued with these thoughts over and over in his head as he followed the directions back to the hotel. He was going to forget that last

song ever existed and just focus on the feelings and emotions he felt right before the concert ended. He was going to remember everything else that he saw and heard, and he was going to praise Mydei to the moon for it. He was going to be a good and supportive boyfriend for Mydei, and tomorrow, he would help out wherever he could with his dress rehearsal and sound check. Then, they could have their rest day, and Phainon will no longer worry about Mydei's first love anymore.

Mydei's first love… The person Mydei first smiled so sweetly at. The person Mydei had first wrapped his arms around. Phainon took a deep breath, his throat tightening once more. In a few days time, Phainon would forget about him. Phainon would forget about him.

*Phainon would forget about him.*

He only had to live like this for another few days! Phainon could do it, right? He could act as the perfect and supportive boyfriend for Mydei, right? *Right?* He just needed to put a huge grin on his face and continually compliment his boyfriend. He just needed to let him know how amazing and jaw-dropping he was on stage. Which were all true, by the way. That last song never changed how Phainon felt about Mydei’s performance, but it just changed how Phainon acted around the man.

The luxury hotel was finally in view, and Phainon crossed the street and was about to enter the lobby. Until he saw the figure of a very well-built man sitting outside and waiting for him.

“Mydei!” Ignoring his clenching heart at seeing the color gold again, he rushed over and immediately draped his coat around the man's broad shoulders. Despite how much he didn't want to talk to him, Phainon's instincts overpowered those feelings. It was cold outside! Why was he just waiting out here instead of in the lobby?

The man glanced up from his feet with an unreadable expression in his eyes. Contrary to the menacing tone he had used over the phone with Phainon, he didn't seem as furious as Phainon had expected. But Phainon wasn't about to be fooled just yet, and he silently waited for whatever judgment or reprimand Mydei was about to give him.

He held out his hand with his palm facing upward. “Give me your phone.”

“Huh?”

“*Unlock your phone and give it to me.*”

Phainon quickly swiped the phone open for him, handing it over to Mydei, whose face was immediately illuminated by the phone screen. He seemed to be clicking through things on his phone that Phainon couldn't see, but when the phone was handed back to him, it was displaying a new contact in his phone.

“That's my number. Save it this time.” Pushing himself up from the planter's edge, he strolled through the opened glass doors and into the fancy hotel lobby. Phainon, who was still in a daze over Mydei's lack of anger, quickly scurried after him through the doors until they silently arrived at Room 550 once more. It was an ominous silence the entire way up the elevator and through the corridor, with Phainon continually fidgeting to himself while bracing himself for Mydei's scolding voice. It seemed that all his worries of not wanting to see the golden-haired man vanished away and were replaced with guilt over staying out so late without a single word.

The heavy hotel door slammed shut behind him, with Phainon having to stop himself from jumping at the sound that was somehow louder than Mydei's anger. Was Mydei angry? He had to be; this silence could only mean that Mydei was so furious that he couldn't even bring himself to say anything.

“What were you doing out there?” With his back facing Phainon, Mydei's voice was unwavering, yet unsettling still.

“Just… enjoying the sights.” A rehearsed smile graced Phainon's lips. “You were amazing out there, My–”

“*Drop it.*”

Phainon immediately shut his mouth, with his smile also faltering.

With a heavy sigh, the man pivoted on his feet to face Phainon, who was still fidgeting in front of the room door. “I don't want to hear that right now. I want to hear why you were out there.”

“I really was just enjoying–”

“Don't lie to me, Phainon. I'm not in the mood right now.”

Under his cracking mask, Phainon was beginning to understand what emotions were swirling in Mydei's heart. Anger and exasperation were self-explanatory, but why did his gorgeous golden eyes look so guilty?

With two heavy steps forward, Phainon reached for Mydei's freezing cold hands. He shouldn't have waited so long for Phainon outside. With him being at least thirty minutes away, was Mydei just going to wait out there the entire time until he returned? Was he out there since the call ended, or was he out there even before the call started?

“We should go to sleep.” A small smile was offered in Mydei's way. “It's late, and you have to get up early tomorrow too.”

“Why were you out there?”

“We can talk about that later, okay?” Phainon's perfect smile graced his lips. “If you're too tired to hear me out now, then we can do it another day.”

He tried to tug on the man's hands, but his cold fingertips did not budge.

“Why were you out there, Phainon?”

“Let's go to sleep, okay?”

“*Tell me.*”

Phainon's chest throbbed at his cracking voice, but he couldn't understand why Mydei was feeling this way right now. Shouldn't Phainon be the one feeling that way? Mydei didn't do anything wrong at all.

His perfect smile didn't falter this time. “Why do you sound like you're about to cry, Mydei?” A weak laugh as Phainon's cold hands caressed a soft cheek. “Shouldn't I be the sad one and apologizing for staying out so late?”

Shattered gold shakily locked with Phainon's blue eyes, and Phainon almost broke himself. He wanted to wrap this beautiful man into his arms, whisper sweet praises into his ear, and have him fall asleep in his arms. Wasn't he tired after the concert? Why was Mydei stubbornly refusing to return to bed now that Phainon had returned?

“Why are you lying to me?” Mydei's breath was trembling as if the cold had suddenly seared its way into his skin. “What did I do?”

“You didn't do anything!” Phainon's eyes widened at the completely false statement. His heart dropped into his stomach at how broken the man looked before him. Why were his beautiful lips quivering like that? Mydei didn't deserve these feelings and emotions at all. Why was he the one feeling guilty when it was all Phainon's fault?

*It was all Phainon's fault.*

“Then why are you lying to me?”

“I'm really not lying, Mydei, I was really just–”

“*Drop it*, Phainon.” The shivering man in front of him swallowed thickly, and Phainon wrapped his coat tighter around his shaking frame. “If you say one more time that you were just *enjoying the sights*, I'm going to fire you.”

“I really was just…”

Under the threatening glare that pierced into his soul, Phainon did not finish the rest of his lie.

Another ominous silence settled upon the two men, with neither one of them willing to back down in the face of the other. Mydei was not going to return to bed without an answer, and Phainon stubbornly refused to grant him the truth.

“It's… really my fault, Mydei.” His perfect boyfriend smile returned. “So, can we please return to bed? You have an early day tomorrow.”

Mydei's eyes flickered over Phainon's face, as if trying to discern if he had uttered the truth or a lie. “What did you do?”

“I…” Phainon's voice wavered. How was he supposed to explain his complicated thoughts in the first place? Where could he even possibly start? “Don't you need to get some sleep for tomorrow? I can tell you all about it after you wrap up your last concert for this city.”

“Phainon.” Mydei clicked his tongue. “I'm going to keep worrying about it for the entirety of tomorrow if you don't tell me. If you're trying to spare me the truth by waiting until after I'm done to tell me, I'm only going to waste all my time thinking about what I've done.”

“You didn't do anything!” Phainon repeated exasperatedly, locking his fingers with Mydei's once more. “You're… so cold. Please, let's just go to bed.” His eyes scanned Mydei's appearance, and it was then that he realized he could still see remnants of makeup around his sharp eyes, and his golden hair was in disarray. “Did you even take a shower? Why don't you take a warm shower first?”

The rockstar's glare only grew. “Phainon, just tell me, or I'm going to cancel tomorrow’s concert.”

“Wha–” Phainon's heart froze. “*What?!* You… You wouldn't do that.” He internally shook his head. This threat wasn't going to work on Phainon; he knew how much Mydei cared about his work, and he wouldn't disappoint himself, his staff, or his fans by canceling a scheduled concert date literally the night before.

“I can't think about anything else but you right now. The concert tomorrow will be a complete disaster if you don't tell me.”

“Are–Are you *threatening* me?!” Thousands of fans bought his tickets for tomorrow! He was just going to cancel it all because Phainon didn't want to tell him right now?!

“It won't be a threat if you just tell me.”

“That's what a threat means!”

It was as if everything had returned to normal with their usual bickering, and the golden-haired man scoffed. Phainon's shoulders slightly relaxed at seeing the traces of a smile upon his beautiful lips.

Phainon's chest throbbed at the truth that echoed in his mind, and he couldn't help but cave to those lips, to those golden eyes, and the quiet remnants of a smile that Phainon so badly wanted to see again. With a voice barely above a murmur, Phainon's eyes dropped down to his hands that had intertwined with Mydei's once more. His heart was full of feeling the warmth that was slowly beginning to radiate from his body. “I'm just trying to be perfect for you, Mydei.”

“Perfect?”

Phainon slowly nodded, refusing to look up at the man.

A brief silence enveloped the two once more, but Mydei broke the silence this time. “When were you ever perfect?”

“Wha–” Phainon shot his head up at the incredulous statement, and his head was locked into place when two large hands, that were now hot again, had anchored themselves to Phainon's cheeks.

Mydei narrowed his eyes at Phainon, who could do nothing but accept. “You lost my number, ghosted me, tried to leave when you had a chance to be with me again, tried to get out of working with me, almost broke my back in bed when I had a concert the next day, didn't tell me you were a virgin until after we slept with each other, and left without a single word until two in the morning until I had to call you back and wait for you outside in the freezing cold.”

“I–”

“You also like whiskey.”

“That's *really* one of my flaws?! Up there with *ghosting* you?! And that wasn't on purpose!”

“How in the world did you even think you were perfect?” Mydei scoffed loudly. “Just tell me why you were out there, so I can take a hot shower.”

“I…” It was as if all of his previous worries of trying to be the perfect boyfriend for Mydei disappeared upon hearing Mydei's words, but Phainon still couldn't help the sheer embarrassment at the feelings he still held over his last song. Phainon's eyes shot downward as best as he could, locking eyes with Mydei's shoelaces. With how he was now in a headlock between Mydei's perfect hands, there was no way he could escape now. And there was no way Mydei was going to let him go until he finally revealed the truth. With a hesitant breath, Phainon opened his mouth. “I'm… jealous…”

“... What?”

“You're… song.” Phainon wanted to squeeze his eyes to no longer look at Mydei once again, similarly to how he did last night. He knew his feelings were disgusting, awful, and unnecessary, but he still couldn't stop himself from feeling this way. He was cringing at his own self over his own emotions.

“Which song?”

“Do I really have to say it?” Phainon would've thought it was completely obvious, especially since it was literally Mydei’s only passionately slow love song.

“Tell me, Phainon,” Mydei's commanding voice resounded. “*Which song?*”

“I just… really think it's obvious.”

“*Which fucking song*, Phainon?”

“The… last one.” His shoulders slumped now that the truth was revealed into the air between them, and his feet were rooted straight into the ground

at how heavy his limbs felt and how heavily his heart weighed in his chest. “The one… about your first love.”

Another silence settled between the two, but Phainon still refused to spare a single glance at the man right in front of him. Was he trying to word his explanation as gently as possible? Was he trying to let Phainon down easy? What possible explanation could Mydei give for singing a song about his first love and inviting Phainon to enjoy said song?

“My first love?”

Why did Mydei sound so confused?

Furrowing his eyebrows, Phainon couldn't help his curiosity, and he finally locked eyes with his golden ones. Surprisingly, Mydei appeared just as confused, if not even more confused, than Phainon.

“Your… ex? Hephaestion?”

“... Who?”

What? What did he mean by “who”? Did Phainon say his name wrong or something? There was no way Mydei forgot about him after just mentioning him the day before.

“Your ex? The drummer of your band?”

Mydei blinked incredulously at him as if that had awoken him from a stupor. “Hephaestion?”

Phainon equally blinked incredulously at Mydei. “Isn't that what I just said?”

“Hephaestion,” Mydei repeated in a much sterner voice, as if he were addressing the man himself.

“Yes, Hephaestion,” Phainon similarly repeated. “Your ex. The drummer of your band. Your first love. The one you sang the song about.” Surely, after that elaborate description, Mydei got the hint? Did he have to start pulling

out physical traits about the man too? Phainon couldn't remember what the man looked like from the few group interviews he had watched about Mydei's band since he was always too preoccupied admiring Mydei himself.  He could only remember Herklas's previous words on the plane when he said Hephaestion was skinny.

"I didn't sing a single song about him." Mydei furrowed his eyebrows.

"You did."

"I didn't."

"You did!" Phainon cried exasperatedly. "The last song?! The song about you passionately yearning for someone's attention?! The one where you specifically said the song meant a lot to you, and that you never usually wrote this type of song?! That song was so important to you that you ended the whole dang concert with that song!" What wasn't clicking in Mydei's head?! Phainon would've thought it was plenty obvious by now merely by mentioning his last song!

Mydei sank at his explanation, his shoulders wilting and his eyes lowering. "You didn't like the last song?"

"Of course I didn't!" Phainon shouted. "Why would I?! It was a song about begging for the attention of your first love and wanting that person to desperately remember you! Why would I want to hear a song about you and Hephaestion?!"

His chest was heaving from all the yelling, and it was especially difficult with the way Mydei continued holding his face in the palm of his warm hands. Phainon's feelings had turned from guilt and embarrassment to one of complete exasperation. Phainon thought *he* was the one who was in his first serious relationship! So why was Mydei acting like he didn't know what Phainon was spouting?!

"You thought that last song was about *Hephaestion?"*

“Who else would it be about?! Who else were you with when you wrote that song?!”

“*Twelve Days*? *That* song?”

Phainon truly didn't know what the song was named as, since he didn't actually listen to Mydeimos's new album. But his brain had retained the burning lyrics so well that he clearly remembered the chorus was counting down twelve repeating days. The whole song, after all, was about Mydei repeating the same twelve painful and empty days in anguish and desperation over being forgotten by his lover. It was the whole reason why Phainon knew the song wasn't about him, because they were never lovers until just yesterday.

“Y–Yes?” Phainon was hesitant in his answer simply because he still didn't actually know the official title of the last song. “The one where you sang about the same twelve days, right?”

“You thought that song was about *Hephaestion?!”* It was Mydei's turn to cry in exasperation, and Phainon winced at the sudden change in volume of his voice.

“Who else would it be about?!” Phainon felt this argument was running in circles. Didn't he just say this? “Who else were you with when you wrote that song?!”

“You–” Mydei groaned loudly, and Phainon’s cheeks brushed the cold hotel room air when his hands had dropped to grasp tightly onto Phainon's shoulders. “You didn't return to the hotel room, wandered the city at night all by yourself without telling anyone until two in the fucking morning, and lied straight to my face multiple times because of a song that was about *you?!”*

A silence had never been so deafeningly loud to Phainon ever in his life before. It shook Phainon so deeply in his core, with the silence somehow ringing in his eardrums as if he were back in that concert venue once again. He stood there in complete and utter shock until it felt as if his legs would crumple to the floor, and even moving his mouth felt like an arduous task.

“What?” Phainon barely managed to mutter a single syllable.

With a slow and deep breath, Mydei pronounced every single word clearly and with absolute assuredness. “That song, *Twelve Days*, the one about me wanting to be remembered by someone, was about *you*, Phainon. Who else fucking forgot about me?”

“I didn't forget about you!”

“I didn't know that when I wrote the damn song!” Mydei threw his hands up into the air, bringing a hand to exasperatedly brush through his disheveled hair. “I wrote that song while thinking back on the twelve days I was waiting for you to call me!”

Mydei's last words hung heavily in the air. They echoed in Phainon’s mind, permeating through his brain and merging with the previously burning lyrics that had been constantly echoing in Phainon's pounding head all night. That song of longing, passion, yearning, and desperation was all about *Phainon?* Those lyrics and those twelve painful, waiting days all revolved around *Phainon?* The *lover* that he had referred to in the song's lyrics was *Phainon?*

“... Me?” Phainon still couldn't believe it, no matter how much his brain tried to wrap around the truth, and he had hesitantly breathed out another syllable.

“Who else do I know is named ‘Phainon’?!”

Another silence settled in the space around the two arguing men as his words began to rattle through Phainon's spinning brain once again.

“... You wrote a song about me?”

Mydei scoffed. “How ridiculous. Why else did you think I wanted you at my concert so bad? I wanted…” His voice faltered, and Phainon saw the faintest splash of red blooming across his cheeks as the corner of his golden eyes glistened with the slightest moisture. “I wanted to hear what you thought about my song…”

Two arms suddenly crashed against Mydei, tightly wrapping around the rockstar until he could barely even breathe. He faintly saw a flash of silver hair that rushed against him as his feet almost gave way, and the two men almost toppled onto the hotel room floor. Stumbling, Mydei barely managed to catch himself, steadying his two arms around his wailing, pathetic pilot boyfriend. Seriously, how did he get wrapped up with such an annoying bastard?

“The song was so good, Mydei!” Phainon cried desperately into the crook of Mydei's neck, burying his nose into golden hair dyed with tips of crimson. “The song was perfect! The song was written so well! You're so talented, Mydei! You were so perfect on that stage! My beautiful, gorgeous, talented, perfect boyfriend!”

Mydei couldn't help the laugh that escaped him at the incredibly ridiculous shift in behavior, settling to wrap his arms around the man and running his fingertips through the hair on the back of his head. “So *now* you like the song?”

“The song was amazing, Mydei! It was everything I wanted to hear!”

“Oh, really?” Mydei hummed in amusement. “That wasn't what you were saying exactly two seconds ago.”

“Mydei, you were shining on that stage! You were such a star up there, and I couldn't take my eyes off of you!”

“Is that so?” Another laugh rumbled from Mydei's chest.

“You're so perfect and beautiful and gorgeous, Mydei! My Mydeimos! My beautiful and lovely king! I am just a humble follower of this glorious king!”

A soft smile danced across Mydei's lips as he breathed in the scent of the nighttime city from Phainon's soft hair. “You're actually a fucking idiot.”

“I am just a humble idiot follower of this glorious king.”

“You're stupid, Phainon.”

“I'm your stupid idiot, King Mydeimos.”

“Phainon.” Mydei shut his eyes, reveling in Phainon's scent once more. “Don't ever leave without saying anything again.”

“I won't,” Phainon mumbled against Mydei's warm skin. “I'm really sorry, Mydei.”

“*Hmph*. Good. Now kiss me.”

Phainon's eyes shot wide open, and his head flew upwards. “Did I hear you correctly?”

“I thought you were just a humble, stupid, idiot follower of King Mydeimos.” Mydei cocked his chin upwards. “So why are you questioning my orders?”

“I… just didn't know if I heard you correctly.”

A cheeky smirk grew upon Mydei. “What did you think I asked you to do?”

“Kiss me?”

Mydei leaned forward, pecking a kiss upon Phainon's lips. The silver-haired man immediately burned at the action, his arms instinctively tightening around the rockstar.

“So, what did I ask you to do, Phainon?” Mydei’s voice lowered as he murmured against Phainon's shivering lips.

“You… You have a concert tomorrow, Mydei.” Phainon was trembling terribly against the other man in the worst attempt at holding back. “I won't…” A shaky breath tingled against Mydei's lips. “I won't be able to stop, Mydei.”

“Did you think I wanted you to?” Mydei chuckled lowly, with his golden gaze flickering between Phainon's eyes and his lips. “You owe me for

putting me through so much stress tonight.”

“It's… late…”

“I know, Phainon.”

“You–” Phainon gulped loudly at the half-lidded gaze directed at him. “–have to wake up early tomorrow.”

“I know.”

“So… so we shouldn't be–”

“*Kiss me*, Phainon.” Golden, half-lidded eyes sparkled in mischief. “Your glorious king demands it.”

All it took were those commanding words and one shaky step before their lips pressed deeply against each other. With a soft moan, Phainon's eyes fluttered shut, reveling in that sweet taste that lingered upon Mydei's plump, red lips. Being this close to Mydei and feeling his nose brush against Mydei's cheek, he could smell his scent and the sweat from running around the concert all night, despite being freezing cold from waiting for Phainon outside for at least half an hour.

Mydei tilted his head, making the kiss even deeper, and Phainon gasped as his face heated up at the sensation. His stomach was tingling, and Phainon didn't really know where to put his hands. His arms were still wrapped around Mydei, so he kept them frozen in place. But his shoulders were tense, and he couldn't relax against Mydei's warm, sculpted, and perfect body that moved against him and sent butterflies into Phainon's stomach.

He was trying his best to breathe through his nose as he furrowed his eyebrows and tried to return the passionate kiss that Mydei was giving to him. But honestly, he was starting to run out of breath, yet he refused to let go of Mydei's soft lips that kept sending electricity down his body. All the pleasure pooled within his core, stirring the warmth between his legs to life.

They parted, much to Phainon's disappointment, but Mydei seemed to be looking down as if deep in thought. It seemed he stopped his ministrations because of something on his mind.

“Mydei? Phainon's shoulders finally relaxed somewhat, as he was still on guard to ensure his stirring erection didn't bump into Mydei.

“You called Hephaestion my first love.” Mydei narrowed his eyes, his golden eyes finally locking with Phainon.

“Isn't he?” Phainon let out a weak chuckle. Was Mydei really thinking about Hephaestion while kissing Phainon? Was it true that he was really a rebound? His erection died at the thought of that.

“No.”

Phainon blinked at Mydei's simple answer that lacked any sort of supportive evidence or explanation. “... No?”

“No.”

“What… What do you mean by ‘no’?”

“I neglected to answer before because… you made my mind go blank when you said that.” Mydei frowned. He rested his elbow on one of Phainon's shoulders and swept the silver bangs that had fallen into his eyes from the kiss. “Hephaestion wasn't my first love.”

“Wasn't he special to you? I heard from… literally everyone how close you guys were.” Phainon recalled the conversations he had on the plane, and both Empousa and Herklas, who had worked for The Detachment for many, many years, vouched for.

“We dated,” Mydei began to explain, his eyes searching across Phainon’s expression. “We held hands, we kissed, we went on dates, we slept together. But I wasn't in love with him.”

Phainon couldn't believe a single word from his last statement. “But you guys were together for *years*.”

“I never felt strongly for Hephaestion,” Mydei murmured. “We were very close; I cannot deny that. But my heart never fell for him in that way.”

“How could I even believe that?” Phainon scoffed. “There was no way you could be dating the same man for years and not feel so strongly for him.”

“It's your own choice whether you believe me or not.” Mydei's eyes flickered between Phainon's, and Phainon's heart squeezed in his chest at the saddened look that was reflected in his golden chambers. “I cannot bring you back in time to watch every single interaction between Hephaestion and me. I think of him often, but because I think of my band, not because of Hephaestion himself. And that is something you will have to choose to believe, as I cannot show you myself.”

Phainon felt his eyes burning at the thought. He wanted to believe him; of course, he did, but how could a man not fall for someone who was his first in *everything?* Phainon was feeling so strongly for Mydei because he had taken many of his firsts already. Mydei was his first serious relationship, the first man he had ever yearned for. He was the first person Phainon had ever fallen asleep with in bed, and he was the first person Phainon became one with. Mydei had made Phainon feel so many different emotions and experience so many things all in a span of a few days. How could Phainon not feel so strongly for him?

“What are you thinking of, Phainon?” The man in front of him whispered. “Is it so hard for you to believe me?”

“I just cannot think of how you cannot fall in love with someone over years of them taking your firsts in everything.”

Mydei's eyes slightly widened at his innermost thoughts. “My firsts in everything?”

Phainon stayed silent.

Mydei sighed, frowning. “Hephaestion… didn't take many of my firsts.”

“Okay, now I really don't believe you,” Phainon snapped. “Unless Hephaestion was your second boyfriend and you had a third, I don't see how that's plausible at all.” He shook his head with his arms falling from Mydei's body, ridding himself of his anger that was beginning to boil in his head. “It's… fine, Mydei. Plenty of people have had a first love before. I can't change that, and I'll just get used to it.”

“But Hephaestion *wasn't* my first love.”

“I…” Phainon couldn't utter the words, but they clung menacingly in the chilling air, almost as if a guillotine had sliced through the two of them.

*I can't believe you.*

Mydei stepped forward, pushing Phainon back into his arms. “Hephaestion was my first kiss, my first date, and the first time I ever held hands with a man. Hephaestion was not the first man I fell asleep within the arms of, and he wasn't the first man I waited outside for. Hephaestion wasn't the first man I wrote a song for, yearned for, stalked on social media for, and waited for. Hephaestion was never the first man I cried for. And Hephaestion… has never been… inside of me before.”

Phainon stayed silent, replaying Mydei's words tens of millions of times in his head, as if his brain had become an echo chamber of Mydei's voice. Every little thing from their last few days, and even the days at the club, flashed through Phainon's mind.

“You seriously…” Phainon could believe some of the things he said, as they were quite specific enough. But, seriously? They never cuddled in bed together? They never slept together or connected their bodies as one? “*Never* did you share a bed with him? And after all those years of dating him, you *never* had sex with him? Didn't you just say you slept with him?”

“That man was sick quite often. He never wanted to get me sick too, so we never shared a bed at night,” Mydei elaborated. “That's why he was the drummer, so he didn't have to strain himself and stand for long hours at concerts. And I… in bed… We did have sex, and he did take my virginity. But I wasn't the bottom.”

Phainon's jaw dropped open, as if the hinges had immediately fallen off and clattered to the carpeted floor. Although he was inexperienced, he, at least, knew of the different roles in bed. “You're a *top?!”*

Mydei glared in Phainon's direction. “Why are you so surprised? Do I *seem* like a bottom to you?”

“I–I just.” Phainon's mouth was flapping open and closed like a fish out of water. “You just… I don't know…” Phainon's cheeks flared. “You just seemed very… forward about being the bottom. Ever since we met.”

“You were the first man I ever wanted to offer up my body too.” Mydei cleared his throat at the end of his sentence, his own blush rising to his face. “Do you get it now, Phainon? *You* have taken more of my firsts than that man ever did. In fact, I think you think about Hephaestion more than I actually do, and you're a fucking dumbass for even thinking about him so much.”

Phainon immediately flinched. That was exactly what Herklas said that Mydei would say about his constant feelings of inferiority to Hephaestion. But now his mind was swirling with only one thought instead.

*Mydei was a top?!*

He was trying to imagine it, with much ferocity, and he couldn't help but admit that it was an extremely hot idea. Mydei topping him? He could tell immediately that he was quite the demanding and dominant top. But Phainon would either break under his grasp in bed or cum everywhere in bed. He wasn't sure if he liked either idea. No wonder Hephaestion was always sick, especially for a man who looked like he didn't work out much. Phainon wasn't sure if even *he* could deal with Mydei's infinite and indestructible stamina, and Phainon was quite proud of his built physique. Wait, if Mydei had asked Phainon to go harder in bed, did that mean that “harder” was always the pace that Mydei was going at?! Poor Hephaestion!

“Phainon, what are you thinking about right now?” Mydei squinted his eyes at Phainon. “Do you believe me now?”

“You're…” Phainon shakily breathed out. “A top?”

“How are you still thinking about that?!” A strong hand shoved Phainon into bed, and Phainon floundered in the air before feeling his back hit the soft mattress with its fresh, clean sheets. It was from being, quite literally, shoved out of his thoughts that another sentence had hit his brain like a truck.

“*I* was more of your firsts?!”

A scoff could be heard above him, and Phainon's body grew rigid when a weight had settled into his lap. “You *just* realized what I had said? Was me being a top really that surprising to you?”

“Well, no, but…” Phainon's eyes searched the man's torso that was now exactly in his point of view. “I was just… imagining it.”

“And?”

“And I kind of feel bad for Hephaestion.” Phainon couldn't help his own chest for blooming forth with warmth over the idea of being most of Mydei's firsts. It wasn't something that he should be so happy about, and it wasn't something he should be so proud of and wanted to be possessive of. And yet, Phainon couldn't control how happy and relieved he was. A rush of crimson flooded his features. Was Phainon *really* this type of possessive man while in love?

Wait, *in love?!*

*Was* Phainon in love?! He couldn't deny that Phainon felt extremely and very strongly for the man who was currently eyeing him suspiciously while straddling his lap. But, was this feeling love? Phainon couldn't say, as he had never been in love before. Nonetheless, if someone had come over to him and told him he was in love with Mydei, Phainon didn't think he would be the least surprised.

A deep sigh left Mydei's chest. “You're actually… infuriating.”

Phainon laughed weakly, his tense shoulders slumping. “I know. I'm sorry, Mydei.”

“If you're so sorry, then get hard again. I need you inside of me now as an apology.”

A quick peck landed against Phainon's lips, and he was sure his heart was going to explode at how fast it was pounding in his chest. “Wait, you *knew* I was hard earlier?!”

“I can't believe you got hard over a simple kiss.” Mydei's warm laugh brushed against his lips, and they tingled from the sensation. “Didn't I tell you that you were big, Phainon? You couldn't hide an erection from me even if you tried.”

With a sharp grind against Phainon's crotch, Phainon's hands flew to Mydei's jeans with a moan. He threw his head back as he scratched against the fabric that clung tightly to Mydei's thighs the more Mydei continued to drag his crotch against Phainon's, and Phainon quickly felt his body, and his dick, heating up under the man's full behind.

“That was quite fast.” Mydei laughed above him. “You really are inexperienced.”

Phainon's face and neck immediately turned red, and he turned his head to the side to try to cover his embarrassment. “I told you…” Phainon mumbled. His dick was clearly pulsing against Mydei now, almost as if it were trying to push out of his pants to follow the warmth that was emanating from between Mydei’s plump cheeks. His body so clearly remembered the pleasure that he had felt when he sank himself deep inside of Mydei, and the warmth and wetness that circulated inside the more he filled Mydei with his load. Phainon's stomach swirled in anticipation of experiencing that pleasure again.

“You listen to your king well.”

Another thrust, and another gasp escaped Phainon's throat, and he bit his lips to stop his needy moans. He was scratching his fingernails against

Mydei's jeans, but he could not lodge his grasp into the material. His fingers kept slipping from Mydei's thighs with each bounce of the man above him, and Phainon was going crazy that he could not anchor himself down in any way.

“What, *hah*, does your tattoo mean?” A tongue swiped along Phainon's neck, biting Phainon's choker out of the way from the outfit Aglaea had picked out for him earlier, and his ears burned at the saliva that was now cooling against his skin.

“I–*mmm!”* Phainon's eyes squeezed shut with another thrust. How was he supposed to answer under these conditions?! His brain was too busy focusing on the pleasure that was sparking from his dick and the tingling in his stomach from an approaching orgasm.

“Does it mean anything at all?” Mydei continued rutting into Phainon, biting and sucking along the sun's center and rays and leaving marks all over the sun. It was going to look more like the sun was about to set now, with how red the sun was beginning to appear.

“Mydei, *Mydei!* “ Phainon whined in between pants and moans. His brain had completely refused to process his question as it was now too busy with the precum that soaked the front of his pants. “I'm… I'm…” Phainon's body was trembling violently against the bed, with his quivering hands deciding to grasp the sheets below him as he could not dig into Mydei's thighs. His clenched toes were digging into the mattress as he tried to push his pulsing dick as far away from Mydei’s warmth as possible in an attempt to delay his orgasm.

“Were you not calling me a king earlier? I don't believe you should be addressing your king so formally.” He nibbled right underneath Phainon's ear with his hips never stopping their movements, and Phainon let out a needy whine.

“Mydei…Mydei… *My King…*” Phainon was panting, and his face burned in embarrassment at the title that left his tongue. He was really just shouting his love for King Mydeimos a few minutes ago? Phainon couldn't even believe himself.

“What do you want, Phainon?” Mydei pressed down against Phainon's crotch so roughly that Phainon's head was thrown back. His forehead was almost pressed into the mattress at how badly his back arched and how badly his hands fisted the sheets.

Phainon's stomach flared as the blood rushed to his dick. He could almost feel himself spilling right into his underwear. They were already drenched in precum, and he wanted to kick these pants off of his legs so badly to release his suffocating erection. “Cumming… Cumming, I'm–”

“You're cumming?” Another laugh and another hard thrust. And another thrust. And another thrust. “Right into your pants? Can't you hold it in for your king?”

“No, I–*AHH!* NO, MY KING! I CAN'T!” Phainon was writhing underneath Mydei's thrusts, kicking his legs and sobbing into the air. His stomach was clenching so tightly, trying his hardest not to explode in his pants. But with the way Mydei continued pressing down on him and grinding into him, Phainon was going to spill himself.

“What a disrespectful follower.” Mydei clicked his tongue in amusement as he continued riding Phainon's bulge. He spread his fingers along Phainon's abdomen, which had become bare with his shirt riding up with each thrust, and the light touch tingled across Phainon's skin and only made the pit of his stomach flare up with an extreme need and desperation. “Can't even follow one simple command.”

“Please, My King, *PLEASE!”* Tears were running down Phainon's face as his lips quivered with want. His hips were pushing up against Mydei's body and chasing that sweet, addicting friction that his dick so badly craved, and his mind completely disregarded the part where he did not want to soil his pants. “Please–*OHH!*–let me cum, *PLEASE*, MY KING!”

Mydei sucked underneath Phainon's chin, chuckling and muttering against his heated skin. “You’ve been such a good boy, Phainon, holding it in for this long. Cum for me, my devoted follower.”

Phainon's jaw dropped, his back arching off the bed, and a loud scream emitted from his throat as he came. His body spasmed violently under the golden-haired man as he felt his underwear filling up and soaking with his own thick streams of cum. Legs were tangling wildly in the sheets as all of Phainon's senses were blown out, and he was panting and screaming and moaning all at the same time, calling for his king as he dirtied his clothing and his vision went white. His abdomen clenched with every pump of his seed that spilled into his pants and every moan that left his parted lips and hung in the air, and soon, Phainon's body was a ragdoll that slumped into the mattress as he came down from his high, feeling the cooling tear tracks down his face and the wet mess that his recovering dick was now sitting in.

His ears faintly caught the sound of a zipper, but Phainon's limbs felt like steel that refused to move. He was too busy trying to catch his breath, and he blearily blinked his eyes that had locked themselves shut the entire time. With the hotel room returning to his vision, so did the scene that was unfolding before him. But as his pounding heart caught up to the sight, and he shot himself out of bed to push the man off of him, a whimper escaped his throat as his elbows buckled and he fell back into the sheets.

Mydei had unzipped Phainon's pants and was currently lapping at his cum, burying his nose into silver hair and sucking along his skin that was riddled with Phainon's seed. He dragged his tongue flat along the inside of Phainon's briefs, scooping up his thick load and gulping embarrassingly loudly–too loudly for Phainon's ears to handle. Mydei's golden hair was tickling and brushing against Phainon's twitching dick that soon rose high up into the air, and with a quiet laugh, Mydei grasped the base of Phainon's cock. Phainon jumped at the touch on his sensitive cock, the tingling in his core fast returning.

“My… My King–”

“Let me help you clean up, my guard.” A tongue lavished the base around Phainon's standing erection, sucking and clearing the area of his sweat and cum that accumulated in his underwear, and Phainon's face burned at the new role.

“G–Guard?”

Mydei hummed, attaching his lips to the space between Phainon's dick and scrotum and sucking hard. “'Follower’ was too long. This almighty king has granted you a new title.”

Phainon didn't even have time to laugh as a groan escaped his chest. Mydei's tongue had dragged itself up his entire length as if his cock were sweet like candy itself, and his tip pulsed and spilled precum all over itself and Mydei's tongue.

“My King… You… You have an audience to serve tomorrow.” Phainon gritted his teeth at the embarrassing script he was reading aloud, pushing to bury his burning face away to the side as much as he could. Was he supposed to be talking this way? He had never done this sort of thing before.

Mydei erupted in laughter, pushing his warm breath off of Phainon's dick. “This king needs to be served before he is satisfied enough to appear in front of guests.”

Phainon swallowed thickly, flinching at the lines that Mydei had returned with much fervor. “S–Served?” Phainon stammered.

“That's right. How could a king thoroughly entertain guests when he is hungry?” There was a dip in the bed by his sides, and Phainon finally glanced upward once again, only for his eyes to bulge out of their sockets at the sight of Mydei now completely naked, with his ass ghosting just above Phainon's desperate length that was crying to be submerged in his warmth. And its tears were just more precum that flowed down his length in rivulets.

“Mydei?!”

“That's ‘My King’ to you, guard.” A hand grasped Phainon's hard length once more, and his body jumped at being stimulated once more. At some point during Mydei's removing his clothes, he had also taken the liberty of ridding Phainon of his pants and underwear. “‘Your Majesty,’ will also do just fine, but that may be a bit long for bed.” Phainon felt the head of his dick being suffocated by Mydei's cheeks as he slowly lowered himself

down. The pit of his stomach was already flaring up in anticipation, and he swore he was already going to explode at the feeling of his hard length sliding between his ample cheeks.

Mydei was mumbling to himself, dragging his entrance along Phainon's twitching dick. “I think I should be fine after yesterday."

But before Phainon could say anything to that, he felt his tip breaching inside that sweltering, fluttering ring of muscle. They parted for Phainon's entry, latching onto every ridge of Phainon's girth and gobbling up the head of his cock and more of his pulsing dick as Mydei lowered himself down, and Phainon sharply gasped, panting heavily and trying his hardest to root his hips to the bed and forget about the heat that melted around his cock and greedily swallowed more of his length but to no avail. Before Mydei could even fully lower himself and have his behind flush with Phainon's hips, Phainon's vision went white before him as the pleasure pooling in his flaring stomach exploded with a scream ripping through the air. Phainon's hips convulsed, his back arching off the mattress and spilling his cum right into Mydei's cavernous warmth, and Mydei groaned at the sensation of being filled before he could even take in all of Phainon's girth. He pumped Mydei full as his dick spasmed inside, and Mydei's insides massaged his length as if trying to squeeze as much as possible right out of Phainon's dick.

“My guard is quite vulgar, don't you think?”

Phainon's ears could barely catch Mydei’s words as his body slumped back into the sheets. His vision was returning, and he barely felt the feeling of his cum leaking from Mydei's entrance now that the man had finished taking Phainon's entire size while he was too busy spilling himself deep inside. It was hot, sticky, and wet inside of Mydei, and Mydei's twitching insides that tightly surrounded Phainon's cock only emphasized how good and moist and slippery it felt inside.

“I–” Phainon swallowed dryly to try to moisten his scratchy throat. “–apologize, My King.”

“It is no matter.” King Mydeimos chuckled. “Just bring out another serving, and then I can be satiated.”

A slap of skin echoed along the walls of the entire hotel room as Mydei raised and dropped his lap right onto Phainon, and Phainon sobbed at the overstimulation. His dick was convulsing in Mydei's warmth as it was continually submerged in his moist insides, and a groan shuddered through Phainon's chest as he heaved over the pleasure that was permeating through his brain. The pleasure was just too much, and Phainon couldn't handle how much his abdomen was tightening over the continued sensations that wrapped around his overstimulated cock.

“My King, *AHH*, please!” Phainon was crying as the tears returned to the corners of his eyes, burning down his cheeks and dripping down to his collarbones.

“You–*mmm*–will have to do everything to appease this furious king.” A blush had grown on Mydei’s face as he rammed himself full with Phainon's length, bouncing up and down on Phainon's cock as their skinship resounded in their ears. “You, *ahhh*, made this king wait… *hah.*.. for you outside in the cold–*Ahh!*–for your unhurried arrival.”

“I apologize! *AHHH!”* Phainon's back was arching off the bed again, his legs violently trembling within the sheets as his toes clenched against the mattress at the overstimulation his body could not handle. It felt like his dick was being shredded apart inside of a wet, tightening cavern, and Phainon felt like he was going to pee. “I apologize, My King! *PLEASE! PLEASE STOP!”*

Mydei abruptly halted in his bounces, circling his hips in Phainon's lap and reveling in the feeling of Phainon's entire length filling him deeply. His eyes fluttered closed as quiet moans slipped past his beautiful lips the more Phainon's dick brushed against his inner walls, and his golden hair was sticking to his reddened forehead and shoulders. Phainon's dick was stirring to life right inside of that tight warmth at the delicious sight before him, despite the overwhelming stimulation he had just experienced; he couldn't even believe it.

Phainon's chest was shakily rising up and down, trying to calm his overstimulated dick during this calmer time and catch his own breath. “My King.” He grasped a handful of Mydei's bare thighs, rubbing circles into his skin. “Will you please let me apologize? Please let this humble, stupid, idiot, dumbass follower make it up to Your Majesty.”

Mydei's chest shook with laughter, his circling hips never ceasing their own pleasure. “You're getting good at this, Phainon. Are you sure this is only your second time being balls deep inside of someone?”

“Mydei!” Phainon's cheeks burned at the vulgar language.

“I only jest, *guard*.” Mydei's eyes sparkled in mischief, his lips curving upwards in a smirk. “Show me what you can do to appease Your Majesty. It better be good enough to lighten your punishment.”

“Punishment?!”

The man above him raised an eyebrow. “Did you think you were going to get out of leaving me alone in the cold and dark with no punishment?”

Phainon was flabbergasted, and his hands tightened against Mydei's skin at the feeling of his heart dropping into his stomach. “I'm not… getting fired after this, right?” He might as well use the night to pull out his dick and start packing his bags instead if that were the case.

Mydei blinked blankly at him, pausing his circling hips. “Phainon, you need to forget when I said that. I'm not going to fire my own dream man.”

“Fucking–” Phainon couldn't help the curse that slipped out of him over the abhorrent title as he clicked his tongue. “Is your dream man really someone that you bottom for? Wouldn't a top's dream man be a bottom and not another top?”

A chuckle came from the man still sitting on top of his dick. “I think you made me realize I'm a switch, Phainon. Or maybe, I will only spread my legs for my dream man and my dream man only.”

A dangerous heat sparked in Phainon's core over his last sentence, and he flipped their positions over until he had Mydei's back pressed against the bed. Mydei yelped, but it quickly turned into a groan when Phainon began pummeling his fluttering insides. That familiar pleasure rushed through Phainon's entire being, and he couldn't help joining Mydei's tandem of moans as his dick quivered inside of that delectable warmth.

Slotting his hands underneath Mydei's knees and spreading his legs, Phainon rammed himself deep inside and shoved his lips upon Mydei's parted ones, who quickly returned the messy kiss, tangling their tongues together and feeling Mydei's fingers running through Phainon's hair. Phainon was feeling his dick being suffocated, his hair getting pulled, his lips and tongue being bitten and sucked, and Mydei's own erection brushing against his swirling abdomen, and Phainon couldn't get enough of this feeling of sex with Mydei.

Mydei was moaning right into his mouth, panting his warm breath and spreading tingles down Phainon's spine. The man was jolting in bed with every deep thrust against his sweet spot as tears gathered in the corner of his eyes. Phainon's mind was melting to the pleasure as his dick was also equally melting inside Mydei's heat, and his hips were increasing in speed and slapping against Mydei's behind in a completely uncontrollable manner. He couldn't stop even if he wanted to, as if someone had taken control of his own snapping hips, and he was desperately chasing his orgasm as only one thought continually echoed in his brain.

*I love you, Mydei.*

*I love you, Mydei. I love you, Mydei. I love you, Mydei. I love you, Mydei. I love you, Mydei. I love you, Mydei. I love you, Mydei. I love you, Mydei. I love you, Mydei. I love you, Mydei. I love you, Mydei. I love you, Mydei. I love you, Mydei.*

*I love you, Mydei.*

Mydei was tearing his hair and his back apart the faster and harder Phainon was thrusting into his squelching hole and the more Phainon's wet tongue itched inside every corner of his mouth. He was leaving dark red scratches

all along his skin, but Phainon wasn't going to have it any other way. He *needed* Mydei to leave his mark all over him and cement his position as Phainon's boyfriend. He *needed* Mydei to leave his evidence all over Phainon. He *needed* the world to know who Phainon belonged to, and he wanted the whole world to know that Mydei was *his*.

Mydei's cries broke Phainon's thoughts as the man clung tightly to Phainon's shaking frame, ripping their tongues apart. “PHAINON! You're– You're–*MMM!* TOO FAST!”

The claw marks that were etched into Phainon's skin only spurred him faster, and he raised Mydei's legs over his shoulders, pressing his knees to the bed and increasing his thrusts, leaving little room for the man below him to breathe. With his toes clenching at nothing in the air, Mydei was screaming, moaning, and gasping into the air as his head was thrown back into the bed over the overwhelming pleasure that took control of his entire body. Golden eyes rolled into the back of his head as his legs shook on Phainon's shoulders, and he was scratching and clawing all over Phainon's body, which was exactly what the hypnotized man wanted.

He was drilling into Mydei's squelching hole, with the sounds reverberating in his brain and joining the creaking of the hotel bed frame that rattled against the wall it was pushed against. Pillows and blankets fell to the floor from their rough activities, but they were drowned out by the sound of their sweating skin sticking and slapping each other. Phainon's mind was filled with pleasure, the sounds of their skinship, and *Mydei*.

*Mydei, Mydei, and Mydei.*

“Phainon!” Mydei was whining as he was pushed repeatedly into the mattress with every hard thrust. “Too fast! TOO FAST!”

“You feel so good, Mydei.” Phainon opened his eyes and cursed at the gorgeous sight of Mydei folded into the bed and displaying his beautifully filled hole that was being ravaged by Phainon's selfish dick. All for Phainon to see all for himself. “You're so pretty, Mydei. I can't stop. I can't stop. You feel so good inside. So warm and tight and wet just for me. Please… please call me a good boy?”

Mydei was squirming against the bed with none of Phainon's words processing in his mind, his lips forever parted to release moan after moan. He was pinned so well that he could do nothing but be at the mercy of Phainon's thrusts, but his twitching hole was relishing in every single taste of Phainon's thick length filling him up, breaching his insides so much that he was gasping for breath, and pressing against his needy and desperate prostate as it fluttered in satisfaction with every fuck of Phainon's dick. Mydei's stomach was pooling in pleasure, swirling in that familiar warmth right before he was about to explode, and he felt electricity rushing through his veins at the oncoming orgasm that was about to rip through his entire body.

Phainon was approaching his third orgasm of the night, his stomach equally swirling in that familiar pleasure, and his snapping hips did not cease from filling Mydei up in his entirety. He pushed his face right into the crook of Mydei's neck, folding him further and feeling his dick sink even deeper than before. The scent of Mydei's sweat and precum was filling up Phainon’s nose, and he shut his eyes to revel in his scent and ingrain it into his head, brushing his nose into the dyed edges of Mydei's hair while enjoying the sweet taste of Mydei's wet hole clinging to his pounding, insatiable cock.

“Please, Mydei,” Phainon groaned into Mydei's skin. “You feel so good around me. I'll be a good boy, so please cancel your concert and let me fuck your hole all night. I promise I'll be good. I'll make you feel so good. I'll be perfect for you, okay? I'll be such a good boy for you, Mydei.”

“PHAINON!” Mydei screamed, digging his fingernails into Phainon's back at the feeling of his stomach flaring in that familiar heat. He was going to cum. He was going to cum– “I CAN'T! I–*AHH! AHH! AHHH! PHAINON!”*

Mydei's body spasmed violently between the mattress and Phainon's body as his vision turned white and his shoulders grew rigid. His back arched dangerously off the bed as he felt himself cumming, splattering himself all over his and Phainon's abdomens in thick streams. His hole tightened around Phainon as he rode out his orgasm, and the man groaned, continuing to push himself inside of his pulsing hole as Mydei came all over the two of them. Strings of curses scratched against Mydei's throat as he was

continually pummeled through his orgasm. His stomach was tightening, and his consciousness was waning in and out at the intense pleasure that punched his every being.

“Phainon, Phainon, *please*, I just–*MMM!*–came! Please… *OHHH!* Please slow down! PLEASE!”

“I know, Mydei, I know.” Phainon was whispering against Mydei's skin, planting reassuring kisses all along his neck. His thrusts did not cease or slow down in the slightest, and he continued drilling into Mydei's convulsing, overstimulated hole. “Just a little more, okay? Just a little more. I'm almost there. I promise. Just a little more.”

Phainon did not cum until Mydei had cum another two more times.

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The following day, well, later in the day, since Mydei and Phainon were going at it until the sun started peeking over the horizon, Mydei took a three-hour nap backstage on some random bench right before the concert.

Phainon's punishment?

To hold him for the entire duration of his nap in front of all the working staff while trying to hide his stiffening erection.

Chapter End Notes

disclaimer please do not be a lover like Phainon ty

# Chapter 12: Epilogue: Phainon

“Shoe game! Shoe game!”

“Isn't that a wedding game?! We're not getting married!”

“So who is more likely to–”

“Why are we playing?!”

A couple of months have passed since Phainon's first flight for the world-renowned rockstar, and his tour has finally reached its end. It was actually so successful that more dates were added towards the middle of his tour, so Phainon was flying for the rockstar for a little while longer than he anticipated. It didn't really matter to him anyway, since he got to spend so much time with his boyfriend.

On Mydei's rest days, they would go sightseeing, taking in the famous tourist attractions in each of the cities they visited. They went on so many dates together that it made Phainon's heart swell with love. They ate at restaurants together, visited cafes together, and tried new foods and activities together. Phainon learned that Mydei loved history, hence his ancient nickname “HKS” that Mydei had given him from a long forgotten civilization, and they visited numerous museums together; one of which was the largest museum in the country, and they were kicked out for how long they wanted to stay there.

They also visited famous libraries, sharing their love for immersing themselves in different adventures and stories, and learning about new ideas. They also visited amusement parks, which Phainon found weird since Mydei insisted that he wear a puppy headband at the amusement park. It wasn't until Phainon was languidly scrolling on social media after the fact that he remembered, after running into his own old post, that Mydei had admitted to stalking him on his social media account, and he had teased the rockstar all night about it. Phainon later learned that the social media account Phainon stalked Mydei on really was run by an employee from

headquarters, and Mydei used a completely blank account just to garner the media's opinion and trends for his job. Now that blank account had a single follower.

Phainon and Mydei were glued to each other's sides the entire tour. Mydei was never one for PDA, and Phainon respected that. But the media and the public quickly sprouted rumors of their relationship. Phainon first captured the media’s attention when he was following Krateros backstage for the first time, back when he still didn't have Mydei's number, and fans had taken pictures of Phainon and posted them online, asking who this man was as this “staff member” wasn't wearing any staff gear. The media was scary, and the media was fast, was what Phainon learned when news of him being Mydei's pilot immediately swept through online forums the next day. But from how often they were seen in the city together, they could not stop the rumors that spread about an even deeper relationship between the rockstar and the pilot. Mydei did not have a single intention of either addressing the rumors or stopping them.

Now, they had both returned home, and Mydei was on a month-long break before he resumed his rockstar activities once more. Because Mydei was on a break, that also meant Phainon was on a break, as there was no one he was supposed to be flying. There was the chance he would be called by headquarters as a backup pilot for their other talents in the company, but it seemed that Mydei had stubbornly demanded that Phainon would be a last resort if a backup pilot were ever needed. Mydei never fully admitted to that, but he had heard talks about it from Krateros. In fact, Mydei had actually tried to add a clause into Phainon's contract that Phainon would be the personal and private pilot of only Mydeimos, which Krateros immediately vetoed. The manager had actually tried to separate the two at night during the tour, as their… nightly activities were getting in the way of Mydei's rest, but Mydei just dragged Phainon back to his room anyway. Krateros quickly gave up.

During their month break, Phainon had brought Mydei to his apartment, and they were now crowded into the living room with the rest of his friends that Mydei was meeting for the first time. Well, he did meet Castorice before, but only briefly.

“*Because!”* Cipher drawled. She was already holding one of Phainon's shoes and one of Mydei's leather boots. “How else am I supposed to learn about the great rockstar, Mydeimos?”

“Just ask him questions!” Phainon was waving his arms exasperatedly in the air. “Like any normal person.”

“I am asking questions!” She retorted. “So, who is more likely to–”

“Cipher!” Phainon wailed, lunging at her to try to cover her mouth. “I'm *not* playing a wedding game!” His ears burned at the idea. Phainon was sure Mydei already thought all his friends were crazy. He should've left Cipher out of this; she was the whole reason Phainon lost Mydei's number, after all.

“Just don't think of it as a wedding game.” Cipher could barely even manage the words while in a headlock and with her mouth covered by Phainon's hand. “Think of it as… Asking questions like any normal person.”

Aglaea and Anaxa had to tear Phainon away from Cipher, or else he was actually going to choke her out.

“I don't mind playing.” Mydei shrugged. “They're just normal questions anyway. The only difference is I hold shoes.”

“See!” Cipher jumped out of Aglaea's arms, who had gone over to her after stopping Phainon. “Let's play! Let's play!”

“The fact that you're so eager to make us play makes me so worried.” Phainon sighed and rejoined Mydei on the floor.

“*Aww*, Phainon, I don't want to know a single thing about your nightly activities.” Cipher eagerly pushed shoes into both Mydei's and Phainon's hands, with Phainon's face burning red from her statement.

“That's–” Phainon stammered. “I didn't expect you to ask any of those questions anyway!”

“Castorice might.” Hyacine turned to the woman, who *actually* nodded without the slightest hesitation, much to Phainon's disbelief.

Castorice couldn't even hide her burning face even if she wanted to. “If you… were to answer, I would ask those questions.”

“I'm not answering!”

“I'll answer.” Mydei turned to the lavender-haired woman, who almost looked like she was going to jump from her seat on the couch and rush the rockstar.

“Mydei?!” Phainon cried.

Mydei shrugged nonchalantly. “I don't mind.”

“*I* mind!”

Mydei chuckled, leaning his head toward Phainon. “What? Afraid I'm going to say something bad?”

Phainon's face began to burn once more at his close proximity, and his eyes darted everywhere except for the gorgeous man seated next to him. “W–Well–”

“Is Phainon bad in bed?!” Cipher was inching closer and closer to the couple. “Wait, wait, wait, I have to think about what question to ask for the shoe game. Castorice, tell me if Phainon is bad in bed!”

“Castorice, don't tell her!” Phainon whirled his head around, desperately staring at the playwright. “Wait, *am* I bad in bed?!” He shot his eyes toward the golden-haired man, who neglected to answer and only shrugged.

“Save it for the shoe game,” were the only words Mydei spoke. Now Phainon was left wondering if he was terrible in bed. Mydei wouldn't drag him to sleep with him every night if he were, right? Right?

“Do we only get one question to ask them for the shoe game?” Hyacine pouted in the couple's direction. “Can we ask two each?”

“You want us to answer *twelve* questions?” Phainon counted all of his friends who were present in the room.

“Isn't that a normal shoe game?” Anaxa remarked. “You wanted to only answer six questions?”

“We should ask three each and make it eighteen questions.” Tribbie nodded to herself, with Cipher and Hyacine nodding in agreement.

“*Eighteen?!* What could you *possibly* want to ask us?! And why is the count going higher?!”

“If we each ask four questions–”

“Tribbie, I'm not answering *twenty-four* questions.” Phainon buried his face into his hands. Someone needed to remind Phainon why he even brought Mydei to meet his friends in the first place.

“So eighteen is the max. Got it.” Cipher pulled out her phone and began typing on its screen. “What… are… embarrassing… shoe… game… questions?”

“Are we seriously answering eighteen questions?” Phainon turned exasperatedly to Mydei, who was only watching everyone with amusement sparkling in his eyes.

“Is eighteen too much for you?” Mydei scoffed.

“Did you really want to answer eighteen questions about us?”

“If you can't handle eighteen measly questions, then I'll answer them for you.”

Phainon gawked at his taunting tone. “Wha–No, *I'll* answer them.”

“I thought eighteen was too much?” The rockstar raised a challenging eyebrow. “You can leave it all to your boyfriend if you want.”

“*Ooh*, Phainon, he called you his boyfriend. How does that make you feel?”

“He's called me his boyfriend plenty of times, Cipher.” Despite his words, Phainon's ears continued to burn as Mydei's words echoed in his mind. His mind still couldn't accept the fact that he was *actually* dating Mydei and that Mydei felt the same for him too.

“Okay! Eighteen questions!” Hyacine clapped her hands, attracting everyone’s attention in the room. “Everyone gets three questions to ask the couple. Do they actually have to be shoe game questions, or can we ask anything?”

“Let's make it everything.”

“Castorice, you answered that way too quickly. What the Hell do you even want to ask me?” Phainon couldn't help another sigh escape him as he rubbed the side of his head.

“Okay!” Hyacine clapped her hands once more. “Everything it is!”

Phainon and Mydei threw the shoes out of their hands and back where they came from while everyone thought of three questions to ask the new couple.

“Which order are we going in?” Hyacine glanced around the group of friends.

“Just start with the most eager person.” Aglaea let out a chuckle, her eyes darting between both Cipher and Castorice. “Who wants to start off?”

“I will actually let Castorice start.”

Aglaea's eyebrows shot up, her golden eyes widening. “Wow, Cipher, letting someone else go first?”

She shrugged with a knowing smirk. “Oh, you know me. I'm just very considerate. I think she's going to have *really* good questions.”

“They're all going to be questions about us in bed!” Phainon wailed.

Castorice cleared her throat, interrupting Phainon's complaints and intensely staring between Phainon and Mydei. “Are you ready, Phainon, Mydei?”

Phainon couldn't help but swallow dryly at how much she was staring at the two of them on the floor. He had never seen Castorice look so eager before in his entire life.

The woman cleared her throat, digging into her purse and retrieving her phone. Everyone in the living room watched her as she tapped through her phone before staring back at Phainon and Mydei on the floor. Did she have her questions written down or something?

“Question one.” Castorice shakily took a breath, as if this information were about to change the entire trajectory of her life. “Who is on the bottom?”

Phainon choked. Over his erratic coughing, he started seeing people jumping up and waving their hands in the corner of his eyes.

“Wait, wait!” Hyacine was one of those people, and her cotton candy pigtails were bouncing along with her. “Can we guess?!”

“It’s Phainon!” Cipher cut in, waving her hands from her seat on the couch’s armrest.

“Why is it me?!”

“I just think it would be funny if you were the one getting railed.”

Mydei coughed to cover his laugh, and Phainon shoved him roughly in the shoulder. “What if we haven't done anything in bed together yet?”

Aglaea raised an eyebrow. “You really want us to believe you both travelled together for more than half a year without anything happening? After you were already caught making out with each other upon the first meeting?”

Phainon stayed silent. They didn't need to know things had already happened within the first second of them becoming a couple.

“I think Phainon is the top.” It was scary how confident Aglaea looked in her statement. “That man is… possessive.”

“If Aglaea is saying that, I feel inclined to believe her.” Hyacine finally stilled her movements. “Do you think Phainon is possessive? I feel like he’s more like a…”

“Like a stupid, nice guy?”

“Exactly, Cipher! A stupid, nice guy.”

Phainon could only silently watch his friends debate their roles in bed with his mouth dropped to the floor. Were they really that eager to know?

It was then that Castorice began vehemently shaking her head. “I agree with Aglaea. You would never suspect a nice guy.”

“Well, *yeah*,” Cipher deadpanned. “Because he’s nice?”

“It’s *because* he is nice that you wouldn’t think there is another side to him.” Phainon did not appreciate the sparkle in Aglaea’s eyes. “Think of it this way: A nice guy who is *so* nice that he loves too much when it comes to that special person. Does that sound like Phainon?”

Why was Phainon being analyzed right now?

Cipher was mumbling to herself, repeating Aglaea's words. “Wait… That does make sense. A lover that loves too much…”

“Castorice, *why* do you want to know this?” Phainon finally brought their debate to a close. “Do you *really* want to know this about your friend?”

Castorice only stayed silent, with her face continuing to shine in a bright crimson. She was typing on her phone throughout their entire debate; was she taking notes on her phone?! What kind of plays were she possibly writing that she needed to take notes?!

“We only asked one question and went on a tangent,” Anaxa muttered. “At this rate, eighteen questions are going to take eighteen days.”

“Okay, okay! Just answer the question, Phainon,” Hyacine urged excitedly. “Top or bottom?”

“I–Does it count if we are both on top?”

Phainon's answer was immediately vetoed with a large amount of boos.

“*One* of you guys is getting railed. You cannot both be doing the railing at the same time.” Cipher tsked. “Unless you both switch, but your answer makes me think it's you, Phainon.”

“It's not me!”

“So is Mydei the bottom?”

Phainon stayed silent.

“Wow.” Hyacine stared at Aglaea with wide eyes. “You were right.”

“Okay, can we move on to someone else's question?!” Phainon's eyes desperately shot to all of his friends in front of them. He really did not want to know what Castorice’s other two questions were, if that was only her first one.

“I feel like Aglaea has to go because her guess was correct.” Hyacine was staring down at the floor as if deep in thought about something.

Aglaea smiled a little too unsettingly for Phainon. “Cipher, did you want to go first?”

Cipher adamantly shook her head. “You can go!”

Aglaea hummed, turning toward Mydei. “Mydei, can I ask you something?”

Mydei silently raised an eyebrow.

“How do you feel about Phainon?”

Phainon's head shot up at that answer. With wide eyes, he turned to Mydei, who had furrowed his eyebrows at the question.

“What did you want to know?”

“Well, you know.” Aglaea nonchalantly waved her hand. “You traveled with the man for more than half a year after he practically ghosted you for months.”

“It wasn't on purpose!”

“Despite what Phainon says, it is undeniable that he ghosted you,” Aglaea disregarded his exclamation. “He ghosted you and, subsequently, applied to the company that you work for and became your private pilot. After traveling with him for many, many months, I wanted to hear your thoughts about Phainon after everything that you went through. You even wrote quite the song about him.”

After Aglaea’s explanation, Mydei only narrowed his eyes at Phainon. “You're telling me your friend knew the song was about you, but you, yourself, didn't?"

“Phainon, I think it was very clear the song was about you.” Aglaea shifted her hand so that it covered the bottom half of her face, but he knew her long enough to know the woman was smirking at him.

“I–Just answer her question, Mydei.” Phainon resorted to impatiently running his hand through his hair. He wasn't about to start with his misunderstanding of that song again. Other than when they made up and had quite the time in bed, he refused to recall any other memories from that night.

“What I think of Phainon?” Mydei stared at him with a frown, deep in thought. In fact, he was staring for so long that Phainon started anxiously fidgeting in his seat right next to the other man. What could he possibly be thinking about for so long?

“We can move on to another question if you want to think about it,” Aglaea suggested as she started scanning the room. “Should we do Cipher next?”

At the sound of her name, the woman sitting on the armrest perked up. “Oh! Oh! Let me get my phone!” She started digging all over the couch for her phone; most likely, she lost it in all the excitement during their earlier debate over the couple’s roles in bed.

But while she was scavenging the small couch and making everyone sitting on it stand up, Mydei opened his mouth. “It's hard to describe someone like Phainon.”

“Just go with your gut.” Aglaea smiled.

“My first thought is to call him an idiot.”

Phainon shoved Mydei in the shoulder.

“He is an idiot, but he is smart. He is stupidly insecure, but he is reliable.”

“Are you… complimenting me or making fun of me right now?”

Mydei continued without paying any attention to Phainon's words. “He is strong and dependable. He is always pestering me to do things with him, but I don't mind. Phainon is…” He took a deep breath. “Someone I would trust to have my back. Who wouldn't leave at the slightest hint of danger. That is who Phainon is to me.”

The room was silent, with even Cipher pausing in trying to find her phone. Phainon glanced around the room to gauge everyone’s reactions, but he was too busy trying to calm his own erratic heartbeat over Mydei's words that continued to echo in his head.

*Someone I would trust to have my back*

“That truly meant a lot to you, Phainon.” Another smirk from Aglaea, and Phainon immediately turned red.

“Well–That's–I… Of course it did,” Phainon mumbled with his shoulders slumping. He buried his face in the palms of his hands to hide his burning cheeks, which only earned laughter from around the room.

“Cipher, have you found your phone yet?”

“Yes, Aglaea!” Phainon heard Cipher exclaiming, and he chose to keep his head buried in his hands. Whatever question Cipher had for them could not be good.

“I tried to look up embarrassing shoe game questions, but I feel like most of the answers are obvious.” Phainon could hear Cipher tapping through her phone. “Like ‘Who is the better kisser?’ It's obviously not Phainon.”

“What do you mean it's obviously not me?!” Phainon's head shot up once more at the accusation, and he could faintly hear Mydei trying to cover his laughter with coughs once more.

Cipher hummed, ignoring Phainon's cries. “I kept scrolling and scrolling, but I don't think any of these are fun. ‘Who is messier?’ Definitely Phainon. ‘Who is better at cooking?’ Definitely Mydei.”

“You don't even know if Mydei can cook.”

“I definitely know that *you* can't cook, Phainon, unless it involves salad.”

Phainon stayed silent. He couldn't even deny it himself that Mydei was great at cooking.

“You know what!” Cipher suddenly exclaimed, making most of the room jump. “How did you guys make up? I want to hear both of your reactions to seeing each other at work. I'm sure that's an embarrassing story.”

“That's a good one!” Hyacine agreed, with Castorice pulling up her phone once more and nodding enthusiastically beside her. “You guys *never* told us how you guys made up.”

Mydei scoffed, leaning back against the wall as he recalled the story. “Phainon didn't know his voice was being projected over the intercom in

the plane. He announced to the entire plane that he lost my number and didn't mean to ghost a celebrity."

Over howls of laughter, Phainon scrambled to defend himself. "That wasn't me! The co-pilot was projecting my conversation with the flight attendant!"

"The look on your face when I came to the cockpit was priceless." Mydei laughed to himself at the memory.

"How was I supposed to know my voice was being projected out there?!" Phainon was desperately clinging to Mydei's arm and shaking the man.

"So… So you found out Phainon lost your number… because of… *Pfft*." Cipher's entire frame was shaking in a poor attempt to disguise her laughter.

"It wasn't my fault!"

"Well, Phainon, you have your co-pilot to thank for making up with your boyfriend." Aglaea was trying to stifle her own laughter.

"Who's next?" It was Castorice's turn to scan the room. "Did you want to go, Hyacine?"

"Yes! Yes, I do!" She cleared her throat as her own laughter came to a halt. "I want to know who said 'I love you' first. If you guys did," Hyacine quickly added.

The two men stared at each other, with Phainon and Mydei furrowing their eyebrows at the same time. They definitely did, but who was first?

"Those exact words?" Mydei stared at the woman for clarification, who nodded fervently. "Then, I think it was you, Phainon."

Phainon raised his eyebrows. "Really? I think it was you, Mydei."

"It was definitely you."

"Do you even have any proof?! Wasn't it you at the amusement park?"

“It was you in bed.”

“Wasn't that after though?!”

“That happened before the amusement park.”

“No, it didn't! What about the library?”

“I didn't say it in the library. Why would I tell you that in a library?”

The entire room watched as the two men continued bickering on the floor, trying to bring up different instances in which the other said the three words first. It eventually became a challenge of memory over who could think of the most experiences first, as the two men started referencing the different dates that they went on together throughout the past half a year, and keeping count of who thought of what first.

“Hyacine.” Anaxa heavily sighed as the two continued to argue and talk over the other person. “What have you done?”

“I–I didn't mean to spark such a debate.” Hyacine was staring with wide eyes at the two men who had started standing up from the floor to continue their heated argument. “I thought it was a straightforward answer.”

Another heavy sigh. “Do you think *anything* is straightforward with those two?”

“Anaxa, that's such a mean thing to say about someone you just met.” Hyacine giggled.

Anaxa immediately clicked his tongue. “Do not call me that.”

It was safe to say that Phainon and Mydei could not get through all eighteen questions before the night ended.

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